

*Basics of Our Home Group
— Recovery, Unity and Service*

**THE FIFTY-FIFTH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

*2005
Final Report*

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members’ full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



55th GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE “Basics of Our Home Group—Recovery, Unity and Service”

Under the theme “Basics of Our Home Group—Recovery, Unity and Service” the 136 Conference members (delegates from the 93 areas in the U.S. and Canada, trustees of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff) of A.A.’s 55th General Service Conference met at the Crowne Plaza Times Square, April 17-23.

The Conference opened Sunday afternoon with the roll call, welcoming remarks, greetings from the delegate chair and the keynote address.

What is this annual closed meeting, often referred to as A.A.’s “annual business meeting,” about?

Delegate chairperson Jimmy Jack Bailey, of Kansas, speaking Sunday afternoon, said: “We are really the voice of Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. We need not forget the group conscience of our areas, but you may set those views aside long enough to listen like you have no opinion. This is a whole lot harder than it sounds. It allows me to levitate above the heat of the debate and to get a better look at Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. It removes my blinders, so to speak. It brings the importance of what we do into the light. Learn to trust the committee process, the Conference process. There will be times we will be given a new perspective that may not agree with how our respective area wants us to vote. Remember, we are here to decide what is best for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. Trust the group conscience of your committee; trust the Conference process. We will see spiritual principles in action and experience the unity of the Conference.”

This year’s Conference was chaired by Elaine McDowell, Ph.D., (nonalcoholic) chair of the board; Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Leonard Blumenthal, LL.D.; Greg Muth, G.S.O.’s general manager; and Jimmy Jack Bailey, delegate chairperson. Eva Sanchez, G.S.O. staff, was Conference coordinator.

Sunday evening Conference members and their guests gathered for the opening dinner. An open A.A. meeting followed, chaired by Laurie Emhe (Southern New Jersey), and led by Mike Young (Western Michigan). Speakers were Catherine Glosser (New Hampshire), Don Mollins (New Brunswick/PEI), Dorothy Hurley (GV director), Chuck Barta (trustee) and Mary Clare Lynch (G.S.O. staff).

Spaced throughout the week were reports, workshops, area service highlights, What’s on Your Mind? sharing sessions, and presentation/discussion sessions. Presentations addressed the three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service, and there was a Finance Powerpoint presentation. Conference members heard a report on the 18th World Service Meeting, as well as a summary of A.A. Around the World. The A.A. Grapevine presentations addressed “A Vision for the Future.”

For those who like to start their day with an A.A. meeting, the 2005 G.S.C. Serenity Group met at 7:30 a.m. Chaired by Buck Rose (Delaware), the daily topic was a reading from A.A. literature. Terry Whelan (Northern Illinois), served as secretary/treasurer.

New York City Intergroup hosted a hospitality suite Saturday, where early arrivals could have coffee, reconnect with old friends

and get to know the new Panel 55 delegates. Throughout the week, local A.A. and Al-Anon members met with the families and friends of delegates and accompanied them on a variety of trips around the city. They visited the United Nations, Brooklyn Botanic Gardens, Intrepid Sea/Air Museum, among other sites. Some went to a matinee Wednesday afternoon, or shopping, and, of course, some went to local A.A. and Al-Anon meetings. Tuesday afternoon, all Conference members and their guests took the subway uptown for a visit to the General Service Office and the Grapevine office.

The main focus of the Conference is on the deliberations of each of the 13 Conference committees, and it is during the committee meetings that the major work of the Conference is done. After a joint meeting with corresponding trustees' committees, the Conference committees review material and recommendations, weigh and discuss various issues and come up with recommendations which may result in Conference Advisory Actions.

Wednesday afternoon trustee elections were held. The new Southeast regional trustee, replacing Dick Gallagher, will be Howard Lowery of Columbia, Mississippi; East Central regional Dorothy May, will be followed by Bob Mayer of Ontonagon, Michigan; and the trustee-at-large/U.S. will be Dorothy Wilson of Indianapolis, filling the spot previously held by Charlie Bartell. New general service trustees are Paul Cleary, Oceanside, California, who will be a director on the A.A.W.S. Board, and Ray Massey of Western Canada on the Grapevine Board.

Also rotating at the end of Conference was Elaine McDowell, who has served the General Service Board well since 1992, and as board chair from 2001. Assuming the responsibilities of chairman of the board is Leonard Blumenthal,

LL.D. of Alberta, Canada, who has served as Class A trustee since 2000. Taking Leonard's place on the board will be new Class A trustee Jeanne Woodford of Benicia, California.

Delegate chairperson for the 2006 General Service Conference will be Mike Scott, North Florida; alternate chairperson will be Joyce Pettitt, Nevada.

With only two months until A.A.'s 70th Anniversary celebration, June 30 to July 3, in Toronto, excitement ran high. Friday morning a presentation/discussion session focused on the 2005 International Convention, chaired by Eastern Canada regional trustee Bob Pelot. The speakers were Doug Richardson, G.S.O.'s International Convention coordinator, and Barb Kelly, Eastern Ontario delegate. Then, as in previous Convention years, the 475 Players (G.S.O. staff members) presented their Conference skit, titled "No Theatre."

After the final committee reports had been given, the resulting Advisory Actions recorded and the final presentation delivered, the Conference was officially closed Friday afternoon with the Serenity Prayer in three languages, led by Donald Cusson., Northwest Quebec in French; Hernan Merea, La Viña editor, in Spanish; and Nancy Jensen, Mid-Southern California in English.

Saturday morning Conference members gathered for the last time at the closing brunch, with farewell talks by rotating trustees: Charlie Bartell, trustee-at-large/U.S.; David Every and John Koster, general service trustees; Dick Gallagher, Southeast regional; Dorothy May, East Central regional; and Elaine McDowell, chair of the General Service Board.

Lest we forget that "Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety": During the 2004 Conference, several delegates went to a 9:00 p.m. A.A. meeting at St. Malachy's Church, just a few blocks from the hotel. There they met a young lady on her first day of sobriety. The next day she came to the Conference's morning A.A. meeting.

Before they said goodbye, Jacki Perry, the delegate from Vermont, gave her phone number to the newcomer. Last week, that newcomer called Jacki to announce she was celebrating one year of sobriety. And Tuesday evening some of the delegates went to the A.A. Anniversary meeting. The name of the group at St. Malachy's—Believe It Or Not.

Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

It is truly an honor and a privilege to stand before you and welcome all of you to the 55th General Service Conference. I look forward to walking shoulder to shoulder with you this week on this very moving, spiritual journey. It will be a weary and tedious journey at times; we may not always see the God of our understanding in action. As the week moves along, you'll see the spiritual process, as through the informed group conscience we conduct the business of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Last year, as I sat here listening to the opening remarks, I felt like a deer in the headlights. I thought I didn't belong here. I told the trustee from my region on Saturday afternoon how I felt. He told me that he had the same feeling when he was a delegate,

and he shared with me what had been shared with him: "The best delegate ever sent here did not do that good, and the worst never did that bad." The simplicity of that advice made me feel that I did belong here. When I can remember how simple the program of Alcoholics Anonymous is—that selfishness and self-centeredness are the root of my problem, then I turn to what I can do to carry the message, not to what I'm going to get from Alcoholics Anonymous. So as we start this journey together, let's put the "WE" back in Alcoholics

Anonymous. The principles of our program will allow God to enter into the process this week and, through our informed group conscience, we'll do the work we've been asked to do.

When I came to you in the summer of 1985, I was on my way to the graveyard. I did not know what to expect. I cannot say that I even wanted to quit drinking. You kept telling me to come back; neither my family nor anyone else had not told me that in a long time. I fell in love with the oldtimers who had known Bill W., our co-founder. They asked me if I was willing to go to the same lengths to achieve sobriety as I was to drink. I remember my answer to them, that anything was better than what I have now. The journey started that day. I never thought I would have the gifts that have been given freely to me. I have to stand on the firing line of Alcoholics Anonymous and give the entire program back, not just the parts that I choose, but the whole program.

I was here last year when "Our Singleness of Purpose—The



Cornerstone of A.A.” was the theme. I remember how important it was to me when I joined Alcoholics Anonymous that they showed me we had but one purpose: To carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. How better to do that than by following with the theme of the 55th General Service Conference: “Basics of Our Home Group—Recovery, Unity and Service.” It started for me in my first home group, the We Do Not Know Yet Group. Through the study of the Big Book I began to understand the hopelessness and futility of our disease, to understand that we had a way out upon which we could absolutely agree, and that I was not alone anymore. They taught me through their actions how important it was to follow the program as it was laid out in the Big Book, and that I did not need to rewrite the book to suit myself. Thank God for their wisdom; they tolerated me and allowed me to stumble and fall. Then the oldtimers picked me up and asked me if I thought I wanted to follow the directions that had worked for 50 years. I remember them calling on the phone, “We’ll be by at seven,” and the click of the receiver.

They never asked if I had other plans. Thank God they were not as polite as we are today. They took the time and cared enough to offer me the whole program. They were never too busy to hold their hands out. The bottoms that alcoholics today hit are sometimes higher than when I came in, but I do not think we need to rewrite Alcoholics Anonymous to suit them. Through our home groups, we can tell them who we are and what we do so they can decide if they are alcoholic, and if they are, that we have a way out.

We are here this week as Conference members, some as delegates. Some of us may have been instructed on how to express our area’s views or even how to vote. We are really the voice of Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. We need not forget the group conscience of our areas, but you may set those views aside long enough to listen like you have no opinion. This is a whole lot harder than it sounds. It allows me to rise above the heat of the debate and to get a better look at Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. It removes my blinders, so to speak. It brings the importance of what we do into the light. Learn to trust the committee process, the Conference process. There will be times we will be given a new perspective that may not agree with how our area wants us to vote. Remember, we are here to decide what is best for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. Trust the group conscience of your committee; trust the Conference process. We will see spiritual principles in action and experience the unity of the Conference.

Remember the basics of recovery, which were laid out for us 70 years ago. We need to do our part to keep this program simple. Through the Steps, our lives are useful again. Through the Traditions, we can live in Alcoholics Anonymous, in our homes, our jobs and in society. Through the Concepts, we have a structure to work within, with a minimum of friction. We are not to rewrite these principles, but we can communicate them in a way that reaches the alcoholic who needs us. Nothing works better than one alcoholic working with another alcoholic. That works even when all the planning and changing of our magical minds fails us.

I would like to close with this from the General Service Conference in 1995: “Not one of us is given a torch big enough to lead the drunks of the world out of the darkness and into the light. Instead, each of us is given a candle to burn for a short while with a flickering flame. If we stand together, the light will outshine the brightest torch. If we argue and bicker and blow at each

other’s candle so that each of us starts shielding our own little flame, the alcoholics of the world will continue to suffer in darkness, and so will we.”

Thank you for allowing me to be a part of this great Fellowship; you have truly saved my life.

Jimmy Jack Bailey, Kansas

Keynote

My name is John Koster, and I am an alcoholic. I am honored and very grateful for the privilege of addressing you this afternoon at the start of the 55th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous, the theme of which is “Basics of Our Home Group—Recovery, Unity and Service.”

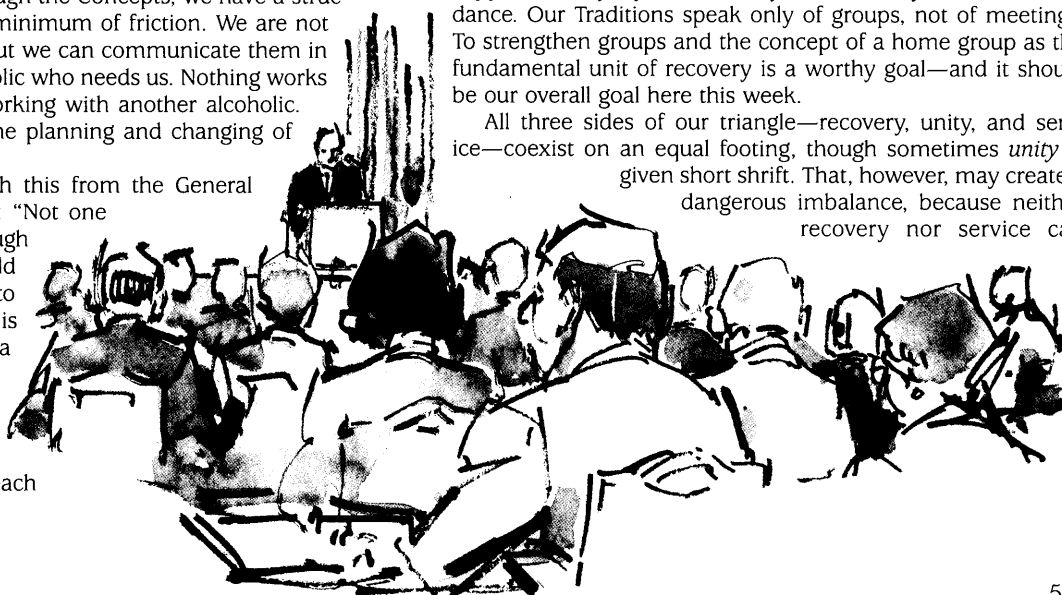
We gather today in a representative capacity. Our common constituency is all of Alcoholics Anonymous. We are, in some sense, like an A.A. group here this week, and our entire Conference one gigantic business meeting.

This week we will review some literature, move some com-mas around, and leave some others comfortably in place. We will encounter some friendly amendments and some others perhaps not so friendly. But our challenge will be to do *our* very best to make sure that A.A. members, most often working through their home groups, have *the* very best means available to carry the message to those who still suffer the scourge of alcoholism. We are here in the same manner to help all our members maintain their own sobriety. We are here to do all in our power to advance this great work, remaining ever true to our Traditions and Concepts. Our collective prayer is that we leave A.A. better off, or at least no worse off, as a result of our work here this week.

Our focus is on the home group, which, in a sense, operates in the same fashion as our *recovery*. Whereas alcoholism is isolating, insulating and self-centered, recovery looks outward, outward to reality, outward to Twelfth Step work, and outward to service. Healthy A.A. groups function the same way. Each needs to provide service opportunities to its members to carry the message of recovery. The *real* autonomy of a group is not preserved by its distance from other groups, but by its proximity to them, by its creative diversity, and by its willingness to work together with other groups through the service structure.

We all know that there is a difference between attending a meeting and belonging to a group. A home group is a haven, a safety net, and a source of emotional balance—a place to be helped and to help others. The distinction between a group and a meeting is often lost in large urban areas, where the bonds of support and loyalty can suffer by the transitory nature of attendance. Our Traditions speak only of groups, not of meetings. To strengthen groups and the concept of a home group as the fundamental unit of recovery is a worthy goal—and it should be our overall goal here this week.

All three sides of our triangle—recovery, unity, and service—coexist on an equal footing, though sometimes *unity* is given short shrift. That, however, may create a dangerous imbalance, because neither recovery nor service can



long survive in the absence of unity.

Our responsibility in *service* is to listen, to learn, to love, and to lead—but first of all to listen. That process does not begin at this Conference. It begins with the groups and with the service structure that communicates with the Fellowship through them. Our Traditions and Concepts place groups first, for it is the groups that are found at the top of the inverted triangle. As it says in *The A.A. Service Manual*: “For most A.A.s, membership in a home group is one of the keys to continuing sobriety.” (p. S23)

Professionals have long been aware of the success rate of Alcoholics Anonymous. They send people to A.A. because experience has shown them that A.A. works. We here know that it works through the basic unit of our Fellowship, the home group.

My dear friends, it should be our challenge for the next decade to do everything we can to strengthen not only the home group but the intermediate service bodies that link this Conference to the A.A. groups. That is, we should encourage groups to be more active in the service structure, to have G.S.R.s, and to elect D.C.M.s. I believe that every action we take in our various committees this week should be directed toward that end. We also should look carefully at the ways technologies like the Internet can help us in our work, without endangering our basic premise, one drunk talking to another.

The challenge of the next decade is to revitalize all parts of our service structure in order to better serve our groups. If each Conference exhausts itself on the minutiae of internal business, the shape and color of the ornaments we hang on each tree, rather than the overall growth and health of the forest, the work of A.A. will suffer, as will the spiritual basis of our Fellowship.

If this Conference does its job, if we share with one another our common vision, and if we detach ourselves from the short term and look to the long term, we are the only board of inquiry our Fellowship will ever require. That was the mission entrusted to the Conference nearly 55 years ago. That is our continuing obligation and responsibility today.

John Koster, trustee

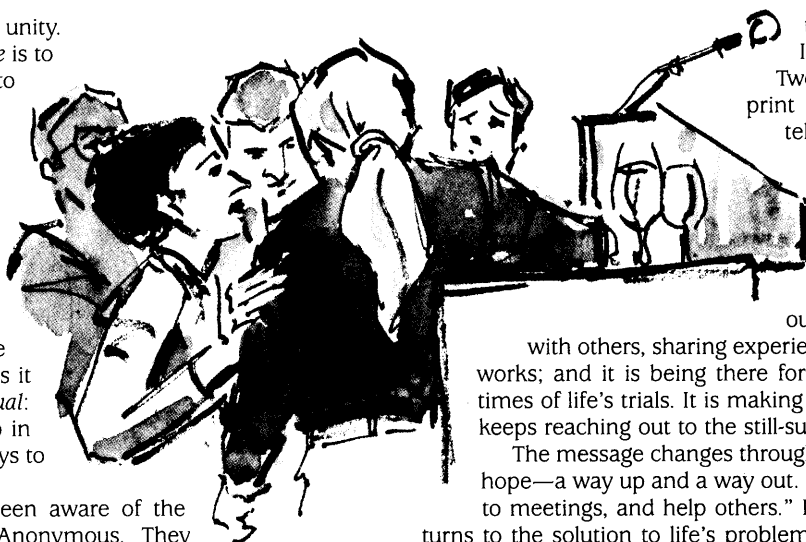
Workshop: “Do I Carry the A.A. Message, or My Own?”

Wednesday morning Conference members divided into groups for workshop discussions based on the Conference theme “Basics of Our Home Group—Recovery, Unity and Service.” Following are questions and a summary of responses from those discussions.

1. How do I define “The A.A. Message?” Where do I find “The A.A. Message?”

The A.A. message is defined in our basic text, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, and in the Twelve Steps. It is one alcoholic sharing with another that there is a solution—we don’t have to drink anymore, and we don’t have to live that way anymore, one day at a time. It is a message of hope that we carry through love and kindness. We share with another alcoholic that they are not alone; it is “the language of the heart.”

Carrying the A.A. message is our primary purpose. It is defined in our Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. It is



the way we live our lives. It is a spiritual path. A.A.’s Twelve Steps are the blueprint for life. The Twelfth Step tells us that “Having had a spiritual awakening as the result of these steps, we tried to carry this message to alcoholics, and to practice these principles in all our affairs.” It is working

with others, sharing experience and showing that A.A. works; and it is being there for someone in need during times of life’s trials. It is making sure that the hand of A.A. keeps reaching out to the still-suffering alcoholic.

The message changes throughout our sobriety. First it is hope—a way up and a way out. We’re told “don’t drink, go to meetings, and help others.” In doing this, the message turns to the solution to life’s problems as we share our experience, strength and hope with other alcoholics. Through sponsorship we are introduced to the Steps and through our home group we practice the Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts. We show the newcomer the path that we have followed. The A.A. message is about change, love, and happiness; and, the transformation from being hopeless and helpless to hopeful and helpful. It is defined through honesty, open mindedness, and willingness. It is about how to live sober, and it is all-inclusive.

We find the A.A. message when we share our life, hope, and pain with others. It is also a personal definition that means something different to each of us. It is trusting in our Higher Power, cleaning house, and working with others.

The A.A. message can be found in the rooms of Alcoholics Anonymous and our home groups, our Preamble, and in Conference-approved literature—such as the Big Book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, the Grapevine, and *A.A. Comes of Age*; it is carried through speakers, both in person and through audio/visual formats. It is also in our prisons, at many A.A. recovery and service events, in our local A.A. offices, in our service structure, our Class A trustees, and at G.S.O. It is found through listening to others with an open mind, sharing at meetings, one-on-one communication, taking someone to coffee, and working with our sponsor. The message is heard through identification. It is reflected in how we act and respond to situations; it is in our everyday life; it is basic and simple.

2. How do I make newcomers aware of A.A.’s literature?

Newcomers become aware of A.A. literature by its availability at A.A. meetings. The Big Book can be placed on the speaker’s table. The literature table should be attractive and highly visible, perhaps by the door. Display a sampling of A.A. literature in other languages. Select a group literature chairperson. Make an announcement at the beginning of the meeting, or at the secretary’s break, that literature is available to everyone, whether or not they can pay. Read “How it Works” directly from the Big Book. Quote and credit our literature when we share at meetings.

Most groups have newcomer’s packets and meeting schedules, as well as a supply of the Big Book, the Twelve & Twelve, the Grapevine, *The Language of the Heart*, and the literature catalogue. Give newcomers *As Bill Sees It* or the *Daily Reflections*. Point out the differences between A.A. literature and non-Conference-approved literature. Often, meetings and/or groups are structured around various pieces of A.A. literature and packets are prepared for varying lengths of sobriety. Emphasize the history of A.A. and encourage members to become interested in learning more

about our co-founders through the literature on A.A.'s history.

We can also encourage newcomers to attend Big Book or Twelve Step meetings. It is helpful to read the literature together in meetings or one-on-one. Be sure to know the literature you are recommending. Share how the literature helped us and let newcomers know that this is where we found answers to our problems. We might give them specific pages to read. When someone asks us "how it works?" we can show him or her the Big Book. As sponsors we can either provide newcomers with the Big Book and Twelve & Twelve or encourage them to purchase it. We might give them a Grapevine/La Viña subscription or give away our Grapevines. Make them aware of articles in the Grapevine/La Viña and be sure they know about our A.A. tapes.

Literature is not self-evident to newcomers. We need to carry it into jails and institutions. Bring A.A. literature on Twelfth Step calls. Personal contact with newcomers is essential. When we give out literature we can include our phone numbers. Don't forget to also reach out to visitors who may be prospective A.A. members. Remember "attraction rather than promotion."

3. How do I carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic through my home group?

First, and most important, is to make the newcomer or the still-suffering alcoholic feel welcome. Meet them at the door with a warm welcome and friendly greeting and introduce them to others. Listen to them before and after the meetings; get to meetings early, leave late, offer rides and make a point of shaking hands and telling them we are glad to see them. We offer them coffee, literature, and/or a sobriety chip. We celebrate their anniversaries and we welcome them back. We ask them to join us after the meeting, and offer transportation, if needed.

Show up regularly to show that the message works. Offer to sponsor people or identify those willing to be sponsors and show them that it is a "we" program. We set a good example by being involved in Alcoholics Anonymous. We participate by working the Steps and practicing the Traditions. We remember that it takes time for a newcomer to feel welcome. We talk one-on-one and bring the newcomer to meetings with us.

Through sharing we try to help them identify and look for the desire to stop drinking. We keep our sharing interesting and brief. We share positively with newcomers and talk to our sponsors about negative experiences. We invite them to share on topics, teach them about the First Step and help newcomers to understand the Traditions. When no one has a topic for discussion, we might discuss a Tradition. We regularly take a group inventory to check how we are doing, if we keep the message of A.A. clear, and to identify areas that need work. We adhere to the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts and assume responsibility for group health. We remember that it is a program of attraction rather than promotion.

Offer newcomers service positions and encourage them to participate in our group activities, including business meetings, and talk about the structure of A.A. We sign up to carry the message outside the home group—to institutions, treatment and healthcare facilities, and jails, and we become involved in the community by giving information and literature to ministers, churches, police, doctors, schools, and our neighbors. We sponsor service-oriented functions and actively participate in service at all levels. We participate in the hot lines, financially support the district, area,

intergroup, and G.S.O., and take literature wherever we go.

4. How do I carry the A.A. message at all levels?

By participating in service we are carrying the message. The message focuses on Recovery, Unity and Service and "How it Works." We also carry the message when we let people know we need their help. We understand that we are one of many and remind members that there is no "them," only "us." Keeping it simple always works best. We carry the message through love, compassion, tolerance, happiness, through our attitude, our behavior, our actions, and our dress. We don't talk down and we remember the power of example. Live what we talk—be a walking Big Book. By showing everyone we are having fun they might want to join us in service.

We share our own experiences in relating to each level and are visible by going to A.A. events. Sponsors encourage others to participate and become connected to A.A. through action. We share the importance of participation for A.A.'s future and show that we are willing to go to any length. It helps to put a Grapevine/La Viña in the newcomer's hand, to write a story for the Grapevine/La Viña, or to think about our responsibility of sharing articles with the Grapevine.

We participate in all activities—such as visiting institutions, jails, and halfway houses and by making ourselves available for phone service. We can reach out to the professionals and let them know who we are and how our program works. At the Conference level we can make public service announcements, make C.P.C. material available, reach out to remote communities, keep providing new translations of A.A. literature, and reach out to alcoholics with "special needs," such as the visually impaired, hearing impaired, physically disabled, etc. We sponsor workshops in our areas and districts, encourage people to bring new people to workshops, and ask groups to participate in service workshops and maybe even host one.

We keep the message clear through the general service structure, which ensures that the message can be carried. We talk about the service structure and opportunities when sharing. Remember that the process of carrying the A.A. message never ends, at any level. We participate in Alcoholics Anonymous at all levels possible through self-support of the home group, at assemblies, district meetings, and General Service Conferences. We carry the message through Class A trustees. We need to keep ourselves informed and be aware of each level's functions. Carrying the message at the district and area levels, intergroup/central offices, and through the A.A. Grapevine is done through the joy of living. Some areas organize a pick-up system to bring those who cannot attend meetings to the area, district, etc. Calling G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s after meetings helps to determine what works and what doesn't work and reminds them of the value their experience brings to the service structure. Finally, when we have a service position, we show up for events. We bring our sponsees and newcomers to spread hope.



Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2005 Conference.

FLOOR ACTION

It was recommended that:

- 1 The draft manuscript, *A.A. In Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, including revisions suggested by the 2005 Conference Correctional Facilities Committee, be returned to the trustees' Corrections Committee for review and revision, mindful of the concerns expressed during the Conference discussion, and that the revised draft manuscript be submitted to the 2006 Conference Corrections Committee.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 2 The theme for the 2006 General Service Conference be: "Sponsorship, Service and Self-Support in a Changing World."
- 3 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2006 General Service Conference:
 - a) Sponsorship:
 - 1 Presenting A.A. to Newcomers
 - 2 Changes in the Alcoholic Coming to A.A.
 - 3 Sponsorship Into Sobriety, Into Service
 - b) Service:
 - 1) Performing Service Without Expectations
 - 2) Leadership—An Ever Vital Need
 - 3) Responsibility With Accountability
 - c) Self-Support:
 - 1) An Informed Group Conscience
 - 2) Gratitude Through Self-Sacrifice
- 4 The following be the workshop topic for the 2006 General Service Conference: "Passing It On in a Changing World."

ARCHIVES¹

No recommendations.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

No recommendations.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

- 5 The "Singleness of Purpose" statement, which follows, be included in the pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals":

Singleness of Purpose and Problems Other than Alcohol

Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as "substance abuse" or "chemical dependency." Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend *open* A.A. meetings, but only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings.

- 6 A progress report on the development of an effective informational media presentation introducing A.A. to training academies and in-service training for corrections personnel be brought back to the 2006 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

The following should be reflected in the presentation:

- a) What A.A. is and is not.
- b) How to contact A.A.
- c) An inmate's chances of maintaining sobriety on the outside are improved by participation in the A.A. program of recovery.
- d) Correctional facilities usually regard A.A. as contributing to the objectives of their institution.

- 7 The name of the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities be changed to the Conference Committee on Corrections.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 8 In the interest of self-support, area contributions for delegates' expenses be increased from \$800 to \$1,200 effective with the 2006 Conference and that areas continue to be encouraged to make contributions over and above this requested amount to help cover a greater portion of the Conference costs.

Note: The last increase was in 1997 from \$600 to \$800 at which time the requested area contribution covered approximately 26% of the direct costs. By 2004, the percentage has fallen to 17% and this increase will result in approximately 26% of the direct costs being covered.

GRAPEVINE

No recommendations.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS¹

It was recommended that:

- 9 An encrypted, anonymity-protected, delayed extranet broadcast of the 2005 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony be approved.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 10 The following introduction be added to the front matter of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*:

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.



Introduction

Alcoholics Anonymous first published this book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, in 1953. Bill W., who, along with Dr. Bob S., founded Alcoholics Anonymous in 1935, wrote the book to share 18 years of collective experience within the Fellowship on how A.A. members recover, and how our society functions.

In recent years some members and friends of A.A. have asked if it would be wise to update the language, idioms, and historical references to present a more contemporary image for the Fellowship. However, because the book has helped so many alcoholics find recovery, there exists strong sentiment within the Fellowship against any change to it. In fact, the 2002 General Service Conference discussed this issue and "it was unanimously recommended that the text in the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, written by Bill W., remain as is, recognizing the Fellowship's feeling that Bill's writing be retained as originally published."

We hope that the collective spiritual experience of the A.A. pioneers captured in these pages continues to help alcoholics and friends of A.A. understand the principles of our program.

- 11 The pamphlet "Young People and A.A." be revised to include eleven current, and eight new stories, and that the Publications Department forward the revised draft pamphlet or a progress report to the 2006 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.
- 12 The Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, continue to be developed, keeping in mind the 2004 Conference Advisory Action regarding the trustees' recommendations on contents, process and story solicitation and that a progress report and/or draft copy be brought to the 2006 Conference Literature Committee.
- 13 The addition of the following four paragraphs to the current section titled "Service Sponsorship" in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be approved with minor revisions to the current pamphlet text suggested by the committee:

a) ...A.A. service is anything whatever that helps us to reach a fellow sufferer—ranging all the way from the Twelfth Step itself to a ten-cent phone call and a cup of coffee, and to A.A.'s General Service Office for national and international action. The sum total of all these services is our Third Legacy of Service.—The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service, page S1.

b) A service sponsor is usually someone who is knowledgeable in A.A. history and has a strong background in the service structure. The A.A. member is introduced to a new language: G.S.R., D.C.M., area assembly, minority opinion. They will become familiar with the Traditions, Concepts and General Warranties, as well as the A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service, A.A. Comes of Age and other A.A. literature.

c) Co-founder Dr. Bob said, "I spend a great deal of time passing on what I learned to others who want and need it badly. I do it for four reasons:

- 1) Sense of duty.
- 2) It is a pleasure.
- 3) Because in doing so I am paying my debt to the man who took time to pass it on to me.
- 4) Because every time I do it I take out a little more insurance for myself against a possible slip."

d) The basis of all sponsorship is to lead by example. Service sponsors can impart to their sponsees the pleasure of involvement in the work of Alcoholics Anonymous. This is best done by stressing the spiritual nature of service work and by pointing out the usefulness of simple footwork and faith.

- 14 The manuscript of the revised pamphlet "The A.A. Group" that includes revisions suggested by the committee be approved.
- 15 The text under the heading "The A.A. Grapevine" in the pamphlet "Your A.A. General Service Office" be replaced with the following:

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

As it has since 1944, the A.A. Grapevine serves as the

monthly magazine of Alcoholics Anonymous. Articles, drawings and photographs, which reflect the growth of A.A. over the years, are not paid for, but contributed by members in free sharing of experience and thought, as at an A.A. meeting. You do not have to be a professional writer or artist to contribute to the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña, A.A.'s Spanish-language magazine. All submissions are welcomed and acknowledged. Manuscripts are always read by A.A. members on the editorial staff. Published material is protected by copyright, held by the A.A. Grapevine Inc.—a corporation entirely separate from A.A. World Services, Inc.

For editorial submissions, or to subscribe to the magazines, please contact the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., 475 Riverside Drive, New York, NY 10115; or visit the Web site at www.aagrapevine.org.

- 16 The term “sexual preference” be replaced with “sexual orientation” on page 10 in the pamphlet “A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic.”

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 17 Rick Horstmann, alternate delegate, Area 2, Alaska be seated as a Conference member at the 55th General Service Conference because David Manson, the Panel 54 delegate for Area 2 is unable to attend.
- 18 Glenn Harrison, alternate delegate, Area 37, Mississippi be seated as a Conference member at the 55th General Service Conference because Elizabeth Kepner, the Panel 54 delegate for Area 37 is unable to attend.
- 19 The 58th General Service Conference be held April 27-May 3, 2008, having considered significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws' deadlines of the General Service Board, Inc.
- 20 The timetable for the election of delegates from the Western Canada Region be revised to allow for an even distribution of new delegates on each panel.

The revised timetable for the election of delegates from the Western Canada Region be accomplished with the election of Panel 56 delegates by having one area in the Western Canada Region elect a delegate for a one-year term with the understanding that this delegate would have the opportunity to stand for his/her own two-year term in the following Panel 57 election.



PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 21 The Membership Survey pamphlet and the one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 2004 Membership Survey with the following revision to the reporting categories under “Length of Sobriety”:

Sober more than 10 years.
Sober between 5-10 years.
Sober between 1-5 years.
Sober less than 1 year.

to better reflect the range in which the “average” appears.

- 22 The television public service announcement (P.S.A.), “Living in Chaos,” developed by the trustees’ Public Information Committee be approved.
- 23 The television public service announcement (P.S.A.), “Living in Chaos,” be translated into French and Spanish, centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a total cost not to exceed \$40,000, in addition to the work of local committees, and that information gathered from the process be forwarded to the 2006 Conference Public Information Committee for their review.
- 24 The phrase “and taking pills” be removed from the P.S.A. “Teenager,” spot #6, on the radio P.S.A. CD item #R-10.
- 25 The trustees’ Committee on Public Information take the initial steps proposed to determine the feasibility of replacing two videos, “A.A.—Rap With Us” and “Young People and A.A.,” with estimated initial project costs not to exceed \$20,000, and report back to the 2006 Conference Public Information Committee.
- 26 Distribution of the video “Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View” be discontinued since it is outdated.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

- 27 The existing chart of the “A.A. Grapevine, Inc.” in *The A.A. Service Manual* be replaced with the updated version.
- 28 The following text pertaining to the A.A. Grapevine Digital Archive be added to *The A.A. Service Manual*:

The A.A. Grapevine Digital Archive

In June 2004, Grapevine articles were preserved electronically and posted on the Web site, making it possible for A.A. members, professionals working in the field of alcoholism, and others interested in the Fellowship to access almost every Grapevine article and letter ever published.

With articles written by A.A. members from June 1944, when the magazine was first published, to the present, the archive offers a vivid account of A.A. history as well as a view of the Fellowship today. It also makes stories easy to find. Using keywords, visitors can search the archive by location, author, or subject to find the first version of the Traditions, to learn what A.A.s have said about such topics as sponsorship and self-support, and to explore how much—and how little—A.A. has changed. Readers

may also browse through the collection by department, topic, or date to find hundreds of jokes and cartoons, along with thousands of articles.

- 29 The following text pertaining to the A.A. Grapevine Reprint Policy be added to *The A.A. Service Manual*:

General Guidelines for Reprinting Art and Articles from the A.A. Grapevine

Permission to reproduce articles or other A.A. Grapevine or La Viña material, either in print or via electronic media (such as web pages), must be obtained from the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. Each article or item must be reprinted in its entirety and carry the following credit line:

Copyright® (month, year) A.A. Grapevine, Inc. Reprinted with permission.

Organizations, publications, or Web sites outside of A.A. must add the following:

Permission to reprint the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., copyrighted material [in this publication, organization, or Web site] does not in any way imply affiliation with or endorsement by either Alcoholics Anonymous or A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

Logo and Artwork

Only the Grapevine cartoons Victor E. and Clara T. may be reprinted with permission.

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., does not grant permission to reproduce either its logo or registered trademarks (The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., Box 1980, The Grapevine, La Viña, etc.) or its artwork or any other cartoons on any other Web site or in any other publication.

- 30 Online meetings in languages in addition to English, French and Spanish be listed in A.A. directories under "ONLINE MEETINGS" with the meeting language indicated next to the listing and in accordance with the 1997 Conference Advisory Action that:

On-line A.A. meetings that request to be listed in A.A. directories be added to the "International Correspondence Meetings" in A.A. directories, that each listing include the internet address of the on-line meeting, and that each on-line meeting requesting to be listed in our directories furnish G.S.O. with the name and physical address of a member willing to serve as "mail" contact.

- 31 Online meetings listed in A.A. directories under "ONLINE MEETINGS" continue to be listed with an e-mail contact address only, in keeping with the 1997 General Service Conference recommendation that:

On-line A.A. meetings that request to be listed in A.A. directories be added to the "International Correspondence Meetings" in A.A. directories, that each listing include the internet address of the on-line meeting, and that each on-line meeting requesting to be listed in our directories furnish G.S.O. with the name and physical address of a member willing to serve as "mail" contact.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

No recommendations.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 32 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April 2005 (see page 42 for approved slate).
- 33 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in April 2005 (see page 42 for approved slate).
- 34 The slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the Grapevine Corporate Board in April 2005 (see page 42 for approved slate).
- 35 New language, in bold-face below, be added to existing language of the Bylaws of the General Service Board regarding successor terms of Class B trustees in the event of resignation or death:

In the event that any member trustee shall resign or shall die, the trustees may at any regular or special meeting elect a new member trustee to fill such vacancy, or, alternatively, permit such a vacancy to continue until the next annual meeting of the General Service Board. In the event that the vacancy is that of a Class B member trustee, the successor shall be elected for a period of four years from the date of the meeting at which he or she is elected. ***In the case of a Class B regional trustee, the position may be filled at the next annual meeting of the General Service Board by election in accordance with the election procedures for such regional trustee, or, may be left vacant for the balance of the unfilled term with regional coverage being provided by the trustees-at-large or by regional trustees in adjacent regions. If a region chooses to elect a new Class B regional trustee in the event of the resignation or death of the current regional trustee prior to the end of that trustee's term, the region should be informed that such an election would impact the current rotation schedule for Class B regional trustees serving on the A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards.***



Presentations and Reports

REPORT: FINANCE

Monday afternoon the Finance report, followed by a sharing session, was given by Vince Keefe, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.

Good afternoon. My name is Vince Keefe and I am a Class A trustee and treasurer of the General Service Board. I consider it a privilege to deliver the treasurer's report to the 55th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company, is in the Finance Section of this report. Our audit partner, Kevin Sunkel, is in attendance and is available to answer any questions that may arise. Also available are Don Meurer, chief financial officer of the General Service Office, and Eugene O'Brien, controller of the A.A. Grapevine. We all recognize and appreciate the dedication and outstanding service these three talented individuals perform for the Fellowship.

I have arranged my talk in a way that I hope will facilitate clear and effective communication between each of you and the area that you serve. Time and again we have heard that there is a lack of understanding by some of our membership when it comes to the services performed or the financial condition of the General Service Office, the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the Reserve Fund. One cause of this communication breakdown is most likely rotation. Just as each servant leader reaches the point of knowing the facts, rotation puts a new person in his or her place. So, with this in mind, I would like to present the financial facts in the most straightforward way possible.

I have organized this financial presentation into five components, namely: (1) our General Service Office, (2) A.A.W.S. Publishing activities, (3) La Viña, (4) The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and (5) the General Service Board Reserve Fund. I will primarily focus on the results for the calendar year 2004; however, prior year results and the 2005 budget are also included to create a broader perspective. Beyond the 2005 budget there are several large unbudgeted expenditures that need to be discussed. These expenditures have not yet been included in the budget process.

Our first chart summarizes the cost of the service functions performed at our General Service Office. I am sure that we are all familiar with each function, with the possible exception of the line entitled Supporting

Services. Supporting Services include the administrative, accounting, human resources, information technology, rent, and other overhead costs. The individual service functions would not be able to operate without this support structure. The total cost of the General Service Office functions for 2004 was \$7,622,288.

The anticipated cost of these same services in 2005 is substantially lower than in 2004. The primary reason for this decline is the cost reduction program implemented within the General Service Office. The overall decrease is more than just the difference between the totals for 2004 and 2005, because many of the line items from last year will actually increase due to inflationary factors. Fortunately, our G.S.O. team was able to find substantial cost savings without eliminating any of our valuable services.

In the next chart Supporting Services have been allocated across the activities to show the fully absorbed cost of each activity. A contribution of \$5.92 per member/per year, or \$132.51 per group/per year, would enable the Fellowship to be fully self-supporting from contributions.

Our next chart is a detailed breakdown of the Group Services activities. This will help us to communicate more clearly when groups ask just what it is that the General Service Office does for each group.

The next topic is the question of how we pay for these important service functions. The General Service Board has three sources to pay for these important services: group contributions, A.A.W.S. literature profits, and transfers from the Reserve Fund.

In 2004 the General Service Board received group contributions of \$5,191,000, an increase over 2003 of approximately two percent. We are very grateful for the broad base of voluntary contributions that supports our General Service Office. Group acceptance of the responsibility to pay for our service functions reinforces the commitment to our primary purpose of reaching out to the still-suffering alcoholic.

Voluntary contributions come from less than 50% of the groups registered in the U.S. and Canada. We certainly understand and accept that there are groups who simply do not have the means to send voluntary contributions. Of course, this leaves us all wondering why the remaining groups have not chosen to participate. One view on this subject is that we have a breakdown in communications between the General Service Office, the delegates, and the D.C.M.s. If this is true, then what can we do to correct this shortcoming? How can we help these groups learn about the General Service Office and the need for their support? The answer is clear—frequent communication from you to the groups through the D.C.M. structure.

Now to summarize the financial performance of our publishing activities. Gross sales of literature in 2004 amounted to \$11,620,500, which is 8% greater than the previous year. After deducting the cost of goods sold and shipping and warehousing costs, there remains a gross profit of \$5,712,600, or 50.5% of sales. This gross profit percent is 5% higher than 2003, mainly due to price restoration of the Big Book. The final profit after deducting the administrative costs is \$2,117,570, an increase over 2003 of \$776,000.

The publishing budget for 2005 anticipates approximately level unit volumes and includes a price increase, effective July 1, 2005, of \$1.00 per title on published books and booklets, except for all formats of the Big Book. The budget also proposes a handling charge applicable to literature orders under \$250, effective on the same date.



Next we look at La Viña. The General Service Board continues to fund La Viña, the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Average monthly subscriptions increased in 2004 to 9,316, an increase of 94. La Viña incurred an overall loss of \$108,050 in 2004. The General Service Board has invested \$887,800 since the inception of this project.

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. had a great year in 2004 in spite of a continuing decline in monthly subscriptions. The Grapevine showed a profit of \$60,945 on Publishing Income of \$1,578,250. This excellent outcome is the result of the superlative work performed by the board and management team throughout 2004.

At this point we can combine the individual parts into a summary income statement for the year ended December 31, 2004. We see that the cost of services of \$7,622,288, less contributions of \$5,191,634 and interest of \$2,671, leaves a shortfall of \$2,427,983. We then deduct the profit from literature of \$2,115,812 and are left with a deficit of -\$312,171. Remember that deficits in recent years have been an acceptable way of keeping our prudent Reserve Fund within an acceptable range.

The last item to take into account this year is the final payment of \$74,840 for the Grapevine Digital Archiving project. This project was approved by the General Service Board in 2002 for a total cost of \$194,000 and was completed in early 2004 within the original cost estimate. All of the past issues of the Grapevine are now safely stored in digital format, with the wonderful advantage of being in a searchable and retrievable database.

The final result for the year 2004 is a deficit of \$434,118.

The last part of this analysis will cover the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. The Reserve Fund ended 2004 with a balance of \$9,075,510, equal to approximately 8.5 months of operating expenses. This means that we are now at the low end of the acceptable range in terms of the number of months of expenses covered. Steps now need to be taken to replace the deficits with profits to prevent the fund balance from declining further. Fortunately, the A.A.W.S. Board has already anticipated this in earlier planning and has included provision in the 2005 budget to eliminate the deficits. The cost reductions, along with the price increases on certain books and the new small order handling charges, should ensure that the Reserve Fund balance does not fall any lower.

It seems appropriate at this point to review the key actions that have been taken in recent years to maintain the Reserve Fund within an acceptable range. We have:

- Reduced the price of the Big Book by \$1 coincident with the publication of the 4th edition.
- Restored the price of the Big Book in July 2004 by raising the price by \$1.
- Announced increases in certain book prices and handling charges effective July 1, 2005.
- Accomplished a major cost reduction program at the General Service Office to lower our annual operating costs.

It seems clear that we have been very effective in keeping our Reserve Fund within acceptable limits. The downside to this approach is that we continue to raise literature prices. And it looks like this pattern will continue to occur in the years ahead. In fact, we will need additional funds to deal with several new demands that have appeared on the horizon. These new demands are in the discussion stage and will need to be acted upon in next year's budget process. There are four items.

Post Retirement Health Benefits: This is the health insurance coverage we pay each month for our retired employees. The issue

of this liability is described in a recent letter from our auditor, and I quote, "The question of 'adequacy' is considered in relation to the ability of the Reserve Fund balance to meet any circumstances or conditions in the foreseeable future. Although we believe that the assets of the Fund are sufficient to allow A.A. to meet any such demands in the short-term, we are concerned about the continued growth in the unfunded liability for retiree health benefits. This liability has always been excluded from the determination of the Reserve Fund balance since it is budgeted and paid for by the operating entities from current operations. However, the rapid growth in the cost of medical benefits has the long-term potential to become a significant demand on A.A.'s financial resources if provision is not made to prepare for this need in the future. As of the date of this report, this issue is being studied by the board, with the anticipation that a viable plan will be proposed and adopted by 2006. Therefore, subject to the resolution of the retiree health benefits liability, we consider the Fund to be *adequate* to meet A.A.'s needs."

The Finance Committee agrees with this opinion and we will make a recommendation to the General Service Board later this year to establish a new long-term fund to hold the money needed to pay a part of the benefits in the future. It would not be unreasonable to expect cash to be transferred from A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine to the new fund to be in the range of \$250,000 in each of the next ten years.

Carpeting in the G.S.O.: This carpeting is now 13 years old and showing the wear and tear of many visitors. The approximate cost to replace this carpeting is \$200,000.

G.S.O. Archiving Project: This short-term need follows on the footsteps of the recently completed Phase One of the restorations needs. With very old reel-to-reel tapes, etc. having been restored, we now must move on to old films and more recent material. This may cost in the neighborhood of \$200,000.

General Service Office Digital Project: As part of our overall information storage plan, we are moving into the Digital Age and are beginning to assess the costs and impact of moving paper documents to digital imaging for easy access and retrieval. We have a current ballpark estimate of about \$100,000 for this project. As we move into project design, we will have a better idea of actual costs.

Given all this information, what does the future look like? Judging from our experiences of the last several years, we will be putting much more pressure on literature prices to balance our future budgets. Higher prices will mean fewer units being sold. If we lower the number of pieces of literature sold, we will also reduce the number of opportunities for literature to reach the still-suffering alcoholic.

Of course, the Fellowship always has the option of increasing voluntary contributions. Just imagine how spiritually uplifting it would be if the number of contributing groups increased to 75 percent. At this level, the Fellowship could be fully self-supporting through contributions. Literature prices would decline, more units of literature would be distributed, and we could reach out to more still-suffering alcoholics in the world. This is more than a lofty goal. This is one of the commitments each member takes on when making the "I Am Responsible" pledge introduced by Bill W. at the 1965 International Convention in Toronto.

My experience gained by attending Regional Forums is that our Fellowship is very eager to learn the facts, and more than willing to accept this financial responsibility. They simply need to be informed and this task clearly begins with each of you as delegates. If you communicate the facts clearly, the Fellowship will be better informed and will likely respond with enthusiasm.

Vincent E. Keefe, treasurer
General Service Board

RECOVERY

Monday afternoon Arnold Ross, general service trustee, moderated the presentations on the Legacy of Recovery and the sharing sessions that followed.

"How It Works" In Our Home Group

Although I know the first sentence from Chapter 5 of the Big Book (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 58), "Rarely have we seen a person fail who has thoroughly followed our path," refers to the first 100 alcoholics, in the beginning I associated it with the other people in the meeting. Because isn't that how it works? Initially, we follow in the footsteps of people who were there before us, and eventually we trudge the road to happy destiny, arm in arm with our fellows.

But it wasn't always that clear to me. During my first year of sobriety I went to A.A. meetings grudgingly. I remember thinking at my second or third meeting as How it Works was read, "They're reading that same thing again. Can't they find something different to read?" If I wasn't finding something wrong with the group, then I was pretty sure the group was finding something wrong with me.

I went to the Winnipeg Women's Group, which meets on Monday nights, thinking that it would force me to find a female sponsor. Which, by the way, worked. I also ended up at the First Step Group, which offered four meetings a day, because I couldn't keep the voices in my head calmed down with just one meeting a week. The only reason I continued to show up at either one was I knew the alternative—getting drunk—would be worse. Two groups turned out to be a bonus for me because I was usually mad at one or the other, so I always had a place to go to cool off. I tried to keep everyone at a distance and not get involved. Although I felt safe sliding into a seat at the last minute I was skeptical of their friendliness. I helped out, but only because they obviously needed someone like me to put them right. And so it went.

Around my nine-month mark I was at a meeting out of town and I blurted out to a room full of strangers that I missed my Monday night women's group. I realized that night that somehow, against my will, I had started to care about the people I saw at meetings. Soon after that I began stopping at the First Step Group every day after work. I saw people come to their first meeting, take 30-, 60- and 90-day chips and get their lives back on track. I was witnessing the miracle of recovery happening over and over again, and I started to care about Alcoholics Anonymous. For a while I struggled with giving up one group or the other, but I finally decided that I couldn't give up either one—both had come to mean too much to me. Isn't it ironic that someone as critical and uncomfortable in the beginning at A.A. meetings should end up belonging to two home groups?

My two groups are very different from each other. First Step is a large group that holds 28 meetings a week and provides enough time slots and types of meetings that it is almost impossible for a newcomer not to fit a few into their schedule. I've met and made life-long friends in the group and continue to attend meetings and share with them.

The Winnipeg Women's Group just celebrated its 52nd Anniversary. It is a safe place, and a great place to watch and listen. Many of the members have been sober a long time and they give me hope that I too might be able to stay sober for the rest of my life. Imagine the stigma of the woman alcoholic 50 years ago? For that reason our meetings are still closed and we start off each with a warm welcome to our visitors, taking special care to acknowledge women there for their first ever A.A. meeting, as

well as women from the local treatment centers. Fifty years ago we may have represented the housewife who hid her bottles in the washing machine, but today we have a cross section of women from most walks of life.

But as different as they are, my groups have much more in common. They follow the Traditions carefully, they embrace newcomers, they promote service work, they contribute financially to A.A., and they listen to the group conscience. Both groups represent the best of Alcoholics Anonymous, but each in their own autonomy.

In service we talk about preserving the message, but it becomes real for me when I see it happening at my meetings. A few months ago a member of the Winnipeg Women's Group received a twelve-year cake from her grandmother, who has over 40 years of sobriety. We also have a mother and daughter team. At another meeting a woman shared with us that she had first come to A.A. in the early eighties. She said she'd tried again and again without success, but that A.A. was always there for her. I remember thinking, "Isn't that just about the nicest thing anyone could say about us?" Last summer a beautiful young woman who was pregnant joined our group. Today, at a meeting, as she sits near the front soaking up every word, doting oldtimers walk and rock her baby at the back of the room. She knows she'll have to leave him with a sitter when he becomes older, because that's the rule, but in the meantime he's the youngest and the only male member of our group.

So, no matter if you are like me and belong to two groups, or have moved often and belonged to many, or have always stayed with the group where you began, I have a wish for you: that each of your groups has the same thing in common, namely, that when you come through the door and slide into your seat, you feel like you have arrived *home*, because that is what the home in home group is all about.

Robin Fewing, Manitoba

Carrying the Message Through Practicing the Principles in Our Daily Lives

On September 12, 1993, my life was almost over. You see, I had a drinking problem. I denied everything. I did not like the term drunk and despised the label alcoholic. I did not like what I had become—jobless, homeless, helpless and worthless. Today I stand before you a very grateful, recovering alcoholic, but only by the grace of God and the program of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Over time, I had developed a drinking problem that others talked about, but that I ignored and denied. Although I had lost many jobs, two marriages, and was an unacceptable, unreliable member of society, I did not want to admit that alcohol had me and wouldn't let me go, nor would I let it go. Over the years I had lost everyone and everything. My life was not worth living. I was living to drink and drinking to live. I had had enough of the pain but could not give up the one thing that was killing me—alcohol. But on September 11, 1993, alcohol had finally given up on me and had decided that I needed to die, one of the powerful aspects of this disease that I have come to realize. In a blackout I tried to kill myself.

I found myself at the end of my rope, at the end of any sanity, lying in a hospital bed with restraints so I could not hurt myself. To me, my life was over. I had become what I did not want to become, a raving alcoholic. During 48 hours of DTs, somewhere inside me was a voice telling me to ask for help. I had given up on God many, many years before, but I was desperate. I did not want to live; neither did I want to die. I could not live sober, nor did I

want to continue drinking. It was then that I screamed for help, for something, someone, anything, to help me. At that point I found a peace that I had never known. I also found Alcoholics Anonymous, with some help from people who genuinely cared for me, and from some of your caring and loving members. I did not know that I was to learn of principles, of a new life or of a happier me. All I knew was I needed something other than what I had. I loved drinking, but hated what it had done to me and what I was doing to myself.

Today, I have learned principles that I live by and that I pass on to others in meetings and over coffee. I share these principles in my job, at home, and by how I behave. I have learned these principles by working and applying the Twelve Steps and trying to abide by the Twelve Traditions in my daily life. Today I am living proof, to myself and to my fellows, that in spite of me I can live sober. Yet it has not come easy. I first had to learn that I had to be honest, not just outwardly but inside, with that person whom I have become. I had to gain some sense of hope that I was worthwhile and had a reason to live. I had to believe that there was a Power greater than me. I had to take steps to find what I had become and what I needed to do to change into the person I wanted to become. I had to remember that I was not God, that I was human and prone to make mistakes. I had to learn that I was not a ruler or director. I had to learn from the beginning what is described on pages 60 and 61 in the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*—that I had self-will and it was running amuck. Although I was still alive and not drinking I always felt that I was on a collision course with something or someone. I learned I was self-centered and self-seeking. I learned I did not care for anyone or anything. I had to learn to calm my mind and my heart long enough for God and the program of Alcoholics Anonymous to begin working in and through me. All of this I did by your teachings within this Fellowship. I had to hurt bad enough, and want the hurt to stop bad enough, to allow for the miracle of Alcoholics Anonymous to work with me.

Today I find that I am striving to be a better person through the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous. I know that if I live by these principles I will have a happier, more productive day. I have learned that when I string these days together, day after day after day, somehow, miraculously, I have become a sober, productive member of society and of Alcoholics Anonymous. I have learned through practice that I get what I give. When good things happen to me and praise or recognition is given to me I try to humbly accept it and not gloat or demand more. When bad things happen I try not to justify or defend my actions. I have learned that humility works for me best when I practice it in all situations.

I do not work the Steps of A.A.; I try to live the principles, to the best of my ability. There is a saying that I may be the only Big Book some people will see. I remember the days of despair, of no direction, of misery, of loneliness, of hurt, of helplessness, of thinking I just need to die because I am not worth being alive. Today I am practicing the A.A. principles in my daily life, not always perfectly, but always to the best of my ability, and for today I am truly at peace and I am happy. Today I am of service to my fellow man, because it helps me more than it helps them.

How do I carry the message through practicing the principles in my daily life? I always remember what it was like for me growing up for the first time. I hope that somehow, someday, by sharing and living life, I am practicing the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous every day.

Don Myers, Wyoming

THE A.A. GRAPEVINE: "A VISION FOR THE FUTURE"

Monday evening's program began with two presentations on the A.A. Grapevine, moderated by John Skilton, Grapevine director.

In 1978, I had one of those experiences that broaden the horizon. I attended my first Founders Day Celebration in Akron, where I met Liverpool Jimmy. Since then, Jimmy's been to my home, and I've visited him in London. In fact, he called just the other day to let me know he'd see me in Toronto.

But that first night Jimmy talked about The A.A. Grapevine. He had never been to America and felt it connected him to the Fellowship here. Because of a slight case of wet-brain, I was struggling with the ability to read. But I still got the message: The Grapevine was truly a vehicle to share the Message of our Fellowship from one drunk to another, across the street or across the ocean.

In 1980 I went to New Orleans and my first A.A. International. One of the main-stage speakers was a member of a royal family in a middle-eastern kingdom. Unable to make face-to-face contact at first, he connected to Alcoholics Anonymous through our literature and the Grapevine.

How many lives has the Grapevine changed?

The Big Book talks a great deal about purpose. And the principle is always the same! Provision always follows purpose: If we keep close to God and perform His work well, He provides what we need. And history shows us that those who forsake their purpose are headed for failure. Our Traditions were created to keep us united in a single purpose. Last year that was our theme here. But spiritual law applies to all areas of life.

In 1935, the year that Dr. Bob and Bill W. met for the first time, the vast majority of people and goods going anywhere in this country were doing it on a train. Railroads accounted for 80 percent of all transportation. By the 1960s, that industry was facing almost wholesale bankruptcy. What happened? The railroad tycoons made a near-fatal mistake. They mistook their vehicle for their purpose.

Indeed their purpose was simple—to transport people and goods. The locomotive was just the vehicle, not the purpose. Had these companies remembered that, imagine how they might have grown, adding trucks and airplanes to their service as technology progressed. Railroad tycoons would have become transportation tycoons! FEDEX and UPS learned from those mistakes and created networks for shipping packages—using planes, trains, and automobiles.

So how does the A.A. Grapevine, in a mega-changing world, stay on purpose? Bill Wilson stated it in 1946: "The Grapevine will try to carry the A.A. message to alcoholics and practice the A.A. principles in all its affairs." And, just like the railroad, the vehicle is not our purpose. While I believe there will always be a place for the printed page, our purpose is not to print, but to carry the A.A. message. Where, other than regular meetings, are people looking for help, for experience, for wisdom, for humor, for hope?

The Internet has become the centerpiece for modern-day forums, and the A.A. Grapevine is now participating in that forum, advancing our ability to carry the message in new ways, more accessible than paper would ever allow. I use the computer more and more to find meetings and to gain information about A.A. everywhere. But where are those in prison looking? Where are those who are isolated from the A.A. community looking? Besides the Internet, CD's, DVD's and I-Pods, what other technologies will change how we communicate in the coming years? Our executive editor Robin Bromley has good news about advances we've already made, and she'll share that next. But, while we are finding new ways to carry the message, we will sure-

ly face the temptation to improve that message, to update our content, to become more modern.

In a world whose values can change wildly, our anchor is in our simplicity. Trust God, clean house, carry the message to others and you will walk in a new and wonderful world. We call the A.A. Grapevine our meeting in print. But I've been to meetings that would have turned me away from A.A., meetings that didn't seem to know what the program was about—drugs, sex, finances, discrimination, antireligion, antismoking, antiananything and everything. How does this help the new drunk live sober?

I am an active citizen. I belong to a place of worship. I vote in elections. I have strong beliefs about a number of areas of life. But, I don't advise others on who God is, whom they should vote for, or even what team to root for. I have no stickers on my vehicle—just a simple circle and triangle. A.A. has succeeded because of this nonjudgmental approach to new people.

For that reason, I would warn against diversifying so much that we lose the simple message of Alcoholics Anonymous. We are not the forum for all the ills of society, just those that deal directly with alcoholism and our simple program of spiritual recovery. So, while the vehicle may change, the passenger is the same—the A.A. message! I believe that God's will is to do the best we can with what we have today and today's technologies can carry our message of hope to people in ways our founders never imagined.

There is a delicate balance to our future success at the A.A. Grapevine. We must be willing to change, to use new ways to reach the drunk, but in order to remain effective, the A.A. message remains in principle what it always has been—focused on our program of spiritual recovery. If we can do that, we will continue to be a major channel for this wonderful A.A. message. And you and I will be joined by countless new members, grateful for the Grapevine that carried that message.

Dick Anderson, Georgia

The hundreds of manuscripts that come into the office each month demonstrate what powerful tools of recovery the Grapevine and La Viña are. These magazines save lives and support the recovery of thousands of alcoholics in the United States, Canada, and abroad. Sometimes they even attract a few members into general service. They do that not because of anything we in the office do—although the staff works very hard to put together each issue. They do it because A.A.s like you send in your stories and let people the world over know that the Twelve Steps and the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous work. Your stories are the heart and soul of the magazines. And that is something I would never, ever want to see changed.

However, I do think we can do a better job of getting these stories into the hands of more people. There is a new generation of alcoholics and professionals who do not know that A.A. has an international journal published in English and Spanish. One way we can change that is the old-fashioned way: with those of us who know and love the magazines making a concerted effort to pass them on. I would like to see more of us reminding G.S.R.s how vital the magazines can be to newcomers and to anyone else who wants to know more about practicing the principles of our program. I would like to see more of us reminding treatment, corrections, and C.P.C. committees—who work so hard to get a meeting into an institution once a week—that our meetings in print can be there the other six days. I would like to see more of us letting the Fellowship know what a vital resource the Digital Archive can be for personal recovery as well as research.

As Dick noted, there are wonderful innovations in technology that can help us carry the Grapevine and La Viña message. One of the most promising is the ability to make recorded stories available on our Web site.

It is now relatively simple and inexpensive to record stories from current issues of the magazines and post them online. People would be able to listen to them directly from their computers, or these audio versions of the stories could be downloaded onto a portable MP3 player like the iPod. This promises to be an effective way of reaching people who would rather get information from the Internet than from print. And it could be a wonderful way to help alcoholics who have trouble reading, or seeing, or getting to meetings—who have been asking the Grapevine since 1983 for an audio version of the magazine.

To test this, and see if this is something whose time has come, we are going to have two stories—one in English and one in Spanish—recorded and posted on our Web site by the end of June, in time for the International Convention.

Equally exciting is the prospect of developing the Grapevine Web site to make it a more useful and engaging resource—for A.A. members, professionals, and for active alcoholics sitting alone in the glow of their computers, surfing the net, to find Alcoholics Anonymous. We have seen the Web site evolve from a place that posted basic information about the Grapevine and its publications, to a place where you can exchange ideas with fellow alcoholics, register to be a GV or LV rep, and download a wealth of stories from the Digital Archive. And this spring, we are exploring ways to make it more useful by adding information and stories geared to groups and professionals, discussion topics for groups, and a special section on the Convention.

We are also extending or enriching the content of the print magazine by posting additional stories and photographs about a featured topic, as we did for the story about the first A.A. convention in Mongolia. We look forward to exploring other possibilities, including recorded or interactive interviews, blogging or live reporting from Conventions, Forums, and other A.A. events, developing the uses of the Digital Archive, and offering the magazines online, which you will hear more about as we go forward.

So far, I have been discussing the roles of the Grapevine and La Viña as tools of recovery. I don't have time here to discuss some of the other services they provide—such as news about the General Service Office and world services; texts and discussion topics for closed meetings; a forum for debate, and a window on the varied and sometimes contradictory ways that individual A.A.s practice the program.

There is one function of the Grapevine and La Viña that I would like to address, however, and that is the magazines' role as a tool for public information. As our Statement of Purpose says, the magazines are: "Written, edited, and read by A.A. members and others interested in A.A." Our meetings in print are a wonderful means of communication among A.A.s, while the personal stories give professionals a good sense not only of what meetings are like, but also real insight into the phases of active alcoholism, stages of recovery, and the aspects of alcoholism that persist long after the alcoholic stops drinking.

But I wonder if the Grapevine could do a better job of communicating with the world at large. Could it convey a more complete picture of A.A. as a whole and the extraordinary spiritual principles that govern it? Could it help dispel the notion that still crops up in some places today that A.A. is a closed society?

Conveying what A.A. is and is not to the public at large is a job the early Grapevine took very seriously. With articles by Jack Alexander, Fulton Oursler, Karl Menninger, Ernest Manning, the Premier of Alberta, Aldous Huxley, and other leaders in government, medicine, journalism, and religion, the magazine not only offered insight into the disease, but also helped establish the credibility of Alcoholics Anonymous, the efficacy of the program, and its seriousness of purpose.

An article by Ruth Fox in *A.A. Today*, for instance, credits A.A.

with giving impetus to the practice of group therapy, while E.M. Jellinek, pioneer in the field of alcoholism, reports on how much A.A. shaped his thinking about the disease. Yet today, it sometimes seems that we at the Grapevine have a tendency to circle the wagons and turn our backs on non-A.A.s, preferring instead to talk with our friends about "our" disease.

So here is another vision for the Grapevine and La Viña: I would like to see our magazines help people understand the contributions A.A. makes to society by publishing more stories about the extraordinary work our service committees do for the hospitals, correctional facilities, and schools in their communities. With articles written by professionals, I would like to let a new generation of doctors, attorneys, journalists, and social workers know what A.A. can do. By publishing more articles on the way the service structure works, I would like to invite a robust discussion of how A.A.'s Concepts and Traditions might be practiced in other institutions or how our society might serve as a model for others. And here, I am going to interject an unabashed call for articles: when you return home, I hope you will ask A.A.s to write about their work in hospitals, and schools and prisons. I hope some of you—and I am not letting the Class A trustees off the hook here—will be moved to share your thoughts about the Concepts and Traditions.

In a presentation he gave to this body in 1961, Bill Wilson called the Grapevine "the journal of a great society." I believe it is a great society, and I think that the Grapevine and La Viña of tomorrow have the responsibility to share it with the rest of the world.

Robin Bromley, Grapevine executive editor

UNITY

Following lunch on Tuesday Pacific regional trustee Phyllis Halliday was the moderator for the three Unity presentations.

"Love and Tolerance of Others is Our Code"

"Love and Tolerance of Others is Our Code." When I was selected to do this presentation, I thought I was being picked on. But as I thought about it, I realized, it is a great opportunity to express my thoughts on something that has been a part of Alcoholics Anonymous since the very beginning. The words "love and tolerance of others is our code" are there in the Big Book on page 84 to warn us of such things as resentments, fears, dishonesty and selfishness. All of these were part of the alcoholic's life prior to sobriety and often persist long after we begin "to trudge the Road of Happy Destiny."

As I have attended meetings over the years, I have witnessed many incidents where love and tolerance fell by the wayside. How often have you attended a meeting where someone new had a problem that a senior member of the group didn't agree with, and the newcomer was told he needed to discuss this with his or her sponsor? Often times that newcomer feels attacked and leaves the meeting never to return. Such situations should be handled in a more diplomatic manner.

One of the problems facing meetings today occurs when a person is invited to speak at a group and starts out saying, "There are drugs in my story and if you have a problem with it you need to talk to your sponsor." This is offensive to many people and should not be tolerated, but there are ways to address this without making a scene. It is difficult to estimate how many people are coming into Alcoholics Anonymous who have problems with drugs, but I can guarantee that the number is very high. Should these people be told to find another meeting that can better serve their needs, or do we lovingly tell them about our singleness of purpose?

During Area 26's pre-Conference weekend, I attended an impromptu meeting on "Our Singleness of Purpose." There were varied opinions, with the consensus being that people who have a problem with drugs should not be allowed to participate in closed meetings. This truly offended one couple, both of whom have used drugs in the past. I believe they were appeased after the meeting when some of the older members took them aside and spoke with them on the issue.

In researching this presentation I looked at a lot of writings from the Grapevine. In one article, a gay male with over 26 years of sobriety wrote that he had never told his story because he didn't feel comfortable disclosing his personal history to people who often told "queer jokes" and who laughed when the first gay meeting in that area was announced. He closed his article by saying, "Placing personal problems ahead of primary principles can only cause division within our ranks and threaten our future as a movement." (The A.A. Grapevine, February 1997) Other gay and lesbian people have expressed similar views in other articles throughout the years.

In recent years we have been inundated with problems ranging from HIV/AIDS to people with mental illnesses. Yet we have realized the need to accept these people and help them to recover from alcoholism through the principles and Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous. When someone with an illness attempts to get sober and tells his or her group they are taking medications for this illness, we don't ask them to go elsewhere. This stance would surely have killed many a person. We are not medically trained and as such shouldn't put ourselves in that position. We learned to love and accept them for what they are and help them as we would any person.

During the course of my sobriety, there have been many people of various sexual persuasions, different accents, mental illnesses, and people with physical challenges who have become members of my home group and were totally accepted because some wise person realized the need to love and tolerate the differences. We welcome drug addicts as long as they confine their sharing to their recovery from alcoholism.

In a Grapevine editorial published in 1944, our co-founder Dr. Bob, wrote an article entitled "On Cultivating Tolerance," in which he stated, "I have observed that those who follow the Alcoholics Anonymous program with the greatest earnestness and zeal, not only maintain sobriety, but often acquire finer characteristics and attitudes as well. One of these is tolerance.... Tolerance furnishes, as a by-product, greater freedom from the tendency to cling to preconceived ideas and stubbornly adhered to opinions. It often promotes an open-mindedness which is vastly important, in fact is a prerequisite, to the successful completion of any line of search, whether it be scientific or spiritual."

O'Dell Holloway, Kentucky

The Basket—Where Money and Spirituality Mix

Keeping in mind the Conference theme, "Basics of Our Home Group—Recovery, Unity and Service," when I was asked to do a presentation on "The Basket—Where Money and Spirituality Mix," a smile came over my face. A flood of memories of my early days in A.A. came back to me. Actually, my very first meeting came rushing back to me.

When I first entered the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous, having been totally crushed by life, I had no idea what was in store for me. My first meeting was on a Monday night, a closed discussion meeting—whatever that meant. All I knew was that everyone there was an alcoholic; they were of varying ages, and there were not many women. Although very skeptical, I knew I was in

the right place. I recall from that first meeting that when the sharing was over, the chairperson said, "We have a Seventh Tradition" and immediately started to pass the basket. I very vividly remember thinking to myself, "Aha, they are just out for the money... my money!" Being totally unaware that I would have to "pay" for the meeting, I closely watched what others threw into this basket. It seemed that \$1 (or as we Canadians say—a loonie) would suffice. So I gave my \$1 and carried my attitude of "all they want is my money" home with me that night. In the coming days and months, I realize now, my attitude was changing. Unbeknownst to me, the miracle of A.A. was beginning to happen in my life. I was practicing the principle of self-support at every meeting, especially at my home group. It was no longer a "burden" to drop that loonie in the basket.

When I became involved in general service work, becoming G.S.R. and district secretary, I realized just how important group unity was. It all happened in the group, where the individual A.A. member was. As the pamphlet "Self-support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" states, "*Self-support begins with me, because I am part of us—the group.*" I was glad to be a part of, to fit in, to be involved. I *really* wanted my group to survive, for without my home group I was certain I would not survive. My home group taught me "everything I always wanted to know about A.A., but was afraid to ask." I was comfortable and safe in my home group. I wanted newcomers to have the same experience. Nothing was, or is, more precious to me than my home group.

We are all a part of the worldwide Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. The enormous hands of A.A. reach out to numerous people every day and I am proud to be a part of it. My life was saved because someone before me cared enough to throw that "loonie" in the basket. Over the years, my loonie has increased, not because I want to show off that I can put more in the basket—not at all—but because I now realize the work that needs to be done in order for our Fellowship (and my group) to survive and to pass on this wonderful message of hope—and it does require money to do that.

I recall having a conversation with my neighbor one day, just before I was leaving to drive two hours to our area assembly. He was asking how A.A. was funded. Who pays for these meetings? How many people attend? When I told him we were self-supporting through our members' voluntary contributions, he was absolutely astonished. When you think of it, and I mean, *really* think about it, it is quite amazing, this principle of self-support. We believe in our Fellowship! We want our groups, districts, areas, and, of course, our General Service Office to survive. We want this all to be here for the newcomer and, more importantly, those who have yet to come through our doors.

At the end of our meetings in my home group we try to point out that, "We have a Seventh Tradition, which helps to buy literature, pay the rent, supply coffee, and helps A.A. as a whole." We say this in the hope that the message of self-support will come across and that it is realized that the money in the basket is a guarantee that the doors of this meeting will be open for those still-suffering alcoholics. If there is a need for more literature, my home group is always certain to have the pamphlets and books available, not just for the newcomers, but for everyone at the meeting as well. We also realize that there are financial needs beyond our home group and we are proud to be "a part of" and support to our district, area and General Service Office.

I recall a wise oldtimer once telling me, "You have to give back in order to receive." Today I give of my time and I give a little money, and I receive tenfold back. I receive the knowledge that my home group will survive to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers, and I receive the ultimate gift—my sobriety.

From the pamphlet "Self Support—Where Money and Spirituality Mix" (p. 8): "*Now that we are sober in A.A., the word 'support' has to do with sharing, people, self-respect, gratitude, and what we are privileged to give—not take—in material terms.*"

"While the Fellowship has always faced problems of money, property, and prestige in one form or another, through the wisdom of the Seventh Tradition we have never been diverted from our primary purpose of carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers—wherever he or she may be. This is the fundamental work of Alcoholics Anonymous, and to ensure that the hand of A.A. will always remain outstretched, money and spirituality must continue to mix. And for that, we are all responsible!"

Jan Lembke, Western Ontario

The Spiritual Principle of Our Twelfth Tradition

It is a pleasure and an honor to present to the 55th General Service Conference on "The Spiritual Foundation of Our Twelfth Tradition." I believe the entire program of Alcoholics Anonymous is spiritual. Thus, when we speak of spiritual principles, we are talking about our lives today. Another belief I have is that the Traditions, as well as the Steps and Concepts, mesh together and work in our Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. Sacrifice and humility should be the spiritual principles involved with our Twelfth Tradition: *Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities.*

"The spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice. Because A.A.'s Twelve Traditions repeatedly ask us to give up personal desires for the common good, we realize that the sacrificial spirit—well symbolized by anonymity—is the foundation of them all. It is A.A.'s proved willingness to make these sacrifices that gives people their high confidence in our future." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p.184)

I have learned to be honest in this new way of living and it would only be fitting to talk about some of the experiences that have taken place in my home group with regards to this Tradition. We have had difficulty at times remembering spiritual principles. The debate over smoking or nonsmoking was a huge conflict that threatened to doom the group. We are still a group and not smoking, and happily today we can laugh about that experience. God did for us what we could not do for ourselves. I have heard other experiences from groups that did not display any spirituality whatever. For example, the individuals with 20 plus years of sobriety who were fist fighting in the streets after a meeting because of some trivial matter. But these terrible things happen all too frequently, due to simply forgetting our principles. Please do not feel that I am bashing A.A. I am just being honest about my experiences because maybe we sometimes forget about reality. "Within A.A., I suppose, we shall always quarrel a good bit. Mostly, I think, about how to do the greatest good for the greatest number of drunks. We shall have our childish spats and snits over small questions of money management and who is going to run our groups for the next six months. Any bunch of growing children (and that is what we are) would hardly be in character if they did less. These are the growing pains of infancy, and we actually thrive on them. Surmounting such problems, in A.A.'s rather rugged school of life, is a healthy exercise." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 233)

A.A. is spiritual; we have all experienced this just by the fact that we are present here today. This room radiates spirituality. Sometimes our actions do not appear very spiritual, but as our Big Book states: "No one among us has been able to maintain anything like perfect adherence to these principles. We are not saints. The point is, that we are willing to grow along spiritual lines. The principles we have set down are guides to progress. We

claim spiritual progress rather than spiritual perfection." (*Alcoholic Anonymous*, p. 60)

Our co-founder, Bill Wilson, had great insight into our wonderful program, which is reflected in all his writings. He knew the Fellowship needed guidance and that is why he wrote the Traditions. He gave us the tools and we have learned to use them in order to grow. Anonymity has been the key to our long survival. That was Bill's wisdom and it stands true today. Anonymity breaks are not that common today because of our continued education. Of course, there is the occasional tendency to be superior by some of us, but the temptation to be in the limelight lessens when we get back to basics. Our other co-founder, Bob Smith, once spoke with Bill about keeping it simple and not lousing this thing up. He, too, had the wisdom and insight to make our beloved program what it is today. God bless our co-founders. "It is an all-pervading spiritual quality which today keynotes A.A. life everywhere. Moved by the spirit of anonymity, we try to give up our natural desires for personal distinction as A.A. members both among fellow alcoholics and before the general public. As we lay aside these very human aspirations, we believe that each of us takes part in the weaving of a protective mantle which covers our whole Society and under which we may grow and work in unity. We are sure that humility, expressed by anonymity, is the greatest safeguard that Alcoholics Anonymous can ever have." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 187). "And finally, we of Alcoholics Anonymous believe that the principle of anonymity has an immense spiritual significance. It reminds us that we are to place principles before personalities; that we are actually to practice a genuine humility. This to the end that our great blessings may never spoil us; that we shall forever live in thankful contemplation of Him who presides over us all." (*ibid*, p. 192)

Torv Theisen, No. Wisconsin/Upper Peninsula Michigan

SERVICE

Class A trustee Herb Goodman moderated the Wednesday evening presentations on the Legacy of Service.

Concept One—Final Responsibility and Ultimate Authority

Concept One: *Final responsibility and ultimate authority for A.A. World Services should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship.*

The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service states on page 6 that: "The A.A. groups today hold ultimate responsibility and final authority for our world services—those special elements of over-all service activity which make it possible for our Society to function as a whole." This responsibility was bequeathed to the Fellowship in 1955 at the St. Louis International Convention. Up until that time Bill Wilson, Dr. Bob and some trusted friends were the self-appointed trustees for Alcoholics Anonymous. They alone held direct responsibility for running the General Service Office. Bill determined that the Fellowship was ready to take responsibility for the general headquarters. His proposal was to form "The General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous." The A.A. delegates would meet yearly and would assume direct responsibility for the guidance of the A.A. general service headquarters in New York City. This Conference would insure that the headquarters would not be isolated from the Fellowship and, in the face of grave crisis, direct support from the Fellowship would be available. The headquarters and the trustees would be able to draw upon a reliable cross section of A.A. experience and speak with confidence that they had the support of the

Fellowship in their decisions. Although the Fifth Tradition clearly states that, "Each group has but one primary purpose—to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers," it must be understood that a group has many other important responsibilities. It cannot be stressed too much that the A.A. group is the place where the final responsibility and ultimate authority for A.A. resides. It is the place where the collective conscience of our Fellowship developed. The pamphlet "The A.A. Group... Where it all begins" states on page 26 "General service representative (G.S.R.): Working via the district and area committees, the G.S.R. is the group's link with the General Service Conference, through which U.S. and Canadian groups share their experience and voice A.A.'s collective conscience. Sometimes called 'the guardians of the Traditions,' G.S.R.s become familiar with A.A.'s Third Legacy—our spiritual responsibility to give service freely."

The G.S.R. represents the group at district and area general service assemblies. They keep the group informed about general service activities in their local areas. They are the point of contact for mail from the General Service Office, which uses them as the primary link for communicating with the Fellowship. They are the majority voice in the election of delegates for the General Service Conference. If these statements are true then it stands to reason that the group has a responsibility to have and to support its G.S.R. That the Fellowship will take responsibility and exercise its authority for A.A. World Services is questionable if the membership fails to come together at the group level and provide a G.S.R. with an informed group conscience. It is at the group level that the collective conscience of A.A. begins. It is then nurtured at the district level. It matures at the area level and is carried by the elected delegates to be combined into what becomes the collective conscience of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. Bill Wilson was convinced that the final responsibility and ultimate authority for A.A. World Services should reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship. He devoted a great deal of effort to convince Dr. Bob and his friends on the board of trustees that the Conference was needed and would work. Bill was convinced this action would ensure that the General Service Office in New York City would not become isolated from the Fellowship and risk the loss of confidence and support when needed. The pamphlet "The A.A. Group" states on page 11: "The entire structure of A.A. depends upon the participation and conscience of the individual groups, and how each of these groups conducts its affairs has a ripple effect on A.A. everywhere."

Although each group is autonomous with respect to its own affairs, I would think that an informed conscience would direct the group to take the action necessary to be part of the collective conscience of A.A. The Concept Checklist, a service piece from the General Service Office, provides some thought-provoking questions that can help a group determine if it is effectively following the Concepts. It is my belief that we as trusted servants are required to educate the groups on their responsibilities to be part of A.A. as a whole. The G.S.R. is trusted with ensuring that the group's conscience is passed on to the district, area and local intergroup if appropriate. The G.S.R. is also expected to take an active part in the selection of the delegate who is sent to the General Service Conference. It is the Fellowship's Third Legacy to be responsible for the guidance of the A.A. General Service Office in New York City. Concept One is deeply rooted in Tradition Two, but it takes the participation of the A.A. groups to develop an informed collective conscience of our whole Fellowship. We, the members of Alcoholics Anonymous, through our groups' participation, should support the service structure at all levels so that God can express Himself in our group conscience. It is our responsibility and it is the right thing to do.

Brent Brown, Southwest Texas

Concept Five—Minority Opinion—Are We Listening?

When I read the topic, my mind immediately focused on our area committee and assembly meetings as well as other areas' events and meetings I have attended. I remembered the various instances where I had witnessed Concept Five in action. I could recall the chairman of each meeting asking for the minority opinion after each vote, so my gut reaction to the question was, "yes—we are listening." Then I had to ask myself what I was listening to. The answer that came back to me was, more often than not, silence. I can't tell you the number of times I have sat through a group conscious, district or area meeting with no one saying a word when the minority opinion was called for. After the meeting concluded, or during the next smoke break, it was obvious that whatever topic had just been discussed and voted on may or may not have had additional information to be discussed. However, the topic was closed and we moved on to the next item of business. I wonder if the silence is because of apathy or fear? My instincts tell me that it's not apathy.

I know that Concept Five provides the vehicle to use if I'm disturbed or unsettled by an action of my home group, district or area. It is my responsibility to question the decision or action and make my voice heard. That being said, the answer of silence began to bother me. Why aren't members speaking up? "On an issue of grave importance, the minority has the actual duty of presenting its views. This 'Right of Appeal' recognizes that minorities frequently can be right; that even when they are in error they still perform a most valuable service when they compel a thoroughgoing debate on important issues. The well-heard minority, therefore, is our chief protection against an uninformed, misinformed, hasty or angry majority." (*The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated*.)

I can't help but speculate that at times the "hasty or angry" majority may be silencing the minority. I don't believe that this is done on purpose; I simply believe it is the nature of an alcoholic.

Similar to the obsession I had for alcohol, I can get obsessed with an idea, thought or action. Once in this state, it's my way or the highway. I'll use the Steps, Traditions, or Concepts as my weapon to try to discredit you and keep the majority convinced that I'm right and you're wrong. This happens without even realizing it. This repeated behavior will either drive those in the minority away or keep them silent.

Bill's subtle but effective statement in Concept Nine reminds me "...a fine plan or idea can come from anybody, anywhere." As a trusted servant it is my responsibility to encourage the minority opinion by voicing my own, even when it's uncomfortable or unpopular. I need to show the Concepts in action by speaking up and, more importantly, listening to what is being said. If I'm listening, my mind is open and I am considering the words being spoken and not thinking of how wrong the other person is because they happen to have another view, or their idea is different from how we've done things in the past.

When we take Step Three, we turn our will and our lives over to the care of God *as we understood Him*. Through the rest of the Steps we begin to trust and build a relationship with this God until, in Step Eleven, we can pray "...only for knowledge of His will for us and the power to carry that out." The practice of these Steps and the belief in a loving God is evident in Tradition Two by showing us that "...there is but one ultimate authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience."

How many times have you heard in a meeting the statement "My God speaks to me through people," or something similar? If this is true, the minority opinion can often be a loving God expressing Himself. It is up to us to ensure that we allow others

the freedom to express themselves without fear of upsetting the majority or stating an opinion that goes against the grain. I need to be mindful of the loving God who may be trying to speak to me through the home group member I'm not the fondest of, or the G.S.R./D.C.M. who is going to extend the meeting another half hour, or longer, because they do bother to voice a minority opinion that causes a reconsideration of a motion. It's my responsibility to keep an open mind and listen regardless of the messenger God chooses.

Being in the minority is not a popular place to be. However, it is clear in Bill's writings of his own experiences that he spent a large portion of his sobriety in the minority when it came to the development of the Traditions, the Concepts and the service structure for Alcoholics Anonymous. Bill never gave up, as he knew the future of Alcoholics Anonymous depended on all Three Legacies and principles that guide our Fellowship. Without his tireless and sometimes emotionally charged efforts to have his voice heard, I'd hate to think of where we would all be today.

So, now my question is to you: are you listening?

Nancy Kunkel, Maryland

Leadership—Responsibility for A.A.'s Future—Concept Nine

The topic I have been asked to present is "Leadership—Responsibility for A.A.'s Future—Concept Nine." The first thing that comes to mind is Tradition Two. "For our group purpose there is but one ultimate authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience. Our leaders are but trusted servants; they do not govern."

Leadership in this program is a very delicate topic. None of us seem to mind being led but we balk at being pushed! How we are led is the foundation of what we will accomplish. Two things that will ruin an A.A. service career faster than drinking is thinking that just because we are trusted servants, we are self-appointed authority figures who seem to know the answers. Hell, most of us are still learning the questions. Second, is to come with a personal agenda based on thinking we are authority figures. This type of leadership is rejected in A.A. It reminds us too much of ego and egos make us uncomfortable. I can only carry the message, I did not create the message and I may not even agree with the message, but my goal must be to make the message available. This program, like life itself, can only afford one authority figure, that is God as we each understand Him.

The best trusted servants/leaders are folks with enthusiasm. A G.S.R. who is excited about being part of the A.A. service structure promotes enthusiasm and, in turn, the group becomes enthusiastic and then involved. A group without enthusiastic leaders becomes complacent and complacency is a hard habit to break.

The A.A. Service Manual reminds us that at times the "leaders" will have to take criticism. We need always give these critics careful hearing and be willing to let them modify our opinions or change them completely. It is the leader's responsibility to carefully explain the process that everyone in the A.A. program cannot witness first hand, such as the committee process and how and why it works. An informed area has a delegate that not only represents but also teaches and explains. It is sometimes not easy to put into words what is in the heart, but reporting on any issue under the direction of God seems to be the best way. A.A. is being safeguarded and the future insured. A.A., like its Fellowship, has a Higher Power safeguarding its future. As long as God is a major part of A.A., we are in very good hands. It was said many years ago that if A.A. is ever destroyed, it will have been

destroyed from within. Leaders must lead in ways to prevent this from ever happening.

A.A. is based on being led by example. It is suggested to get a sponsor. The good ones sponsor us by leading by example, not dictating. Do as I say and not as I do does not get very far when we get the chance to work with a newcomer, or for that matter, any member of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Those in a position to be considered leaders in Alcoholics Anonymous should never feel pressure to sound a certain way, or represent something a certain way. We may currently be what some would call leaders, but bottom line is we are alcoholics and, like every other member, just one drink away from a drunk. It is apparent that somewhere in our A.A. program, we witnessed service work and got involved. Few members would say their experience was negative and it did not help their personal life, if their hearts were right.

Railroading someone into a service position is wrong and is a direct result of taking God's will out of the program. If a hand doesn't come up at the election meeting, possibly one will the next meeting. It may be best to not have a new G.S.R. for a few months into the new rotation than it is to railroad one in that doesn't really want to be there. It may be hazardous for not only the group, but also for the individual.

I am very proud and honored to serve this great Fellowship in whatever way God wants me to. Because of that, I will be the best example of a recovering alcoholic I can be, for not only the sober members but for those still-suffering from their alcoholism.

Jim McDonald, Idaho

INTERNATIONAL

Thursday afternoon the International presentations were moderated by trustee-at-large/U.S. Charlie Bartell.

18th World Service Meeting

The 18th World Service Meeting (WSM) convened here in the Crowne Plaza Hotel, New York City, on October 24, 2004. Forty-eight delegates, representing 35 countries where A.A. has a general service structure, were welcomed by the chair of the General Service Board, Elaine McDowell. The theme was "One Message—Many Languages—One Fellowship." During the five days of this event, the delegates met as assigned in four standing committees and in four scheduled workshops; we came together in plenary sessions to hear reports from committees and workshops, reports from the zonal service meetings, presentations on a wide range of topics, and service highlights from 27 regions and countries. It was a full agenda, yet enthusiasm was evident in each of the scheduled events. Interpreters worked in all sessions to provide simultaneous translation in both French and Spanish.

A long-sought-for service piece, "Country-to-Country Sponsorship—Carrying the Message Worldwide," was approved. This has proven to be a successful method of assistance for new A.A. entities, the most recent example being Japan sponsoring Mongolia. In addition to the already established zonal meetings of the Americas, Europe, and Asia-Oceania, a new zonal meeting was added to the list in 2004: Sub-Saharan Africa. This had been a co-sponsored effort of GSB-Great Britain and GSB-US/Canada. While the Second Eastern European Service Meeting was postponed "to a yet undetermined date," a new zonal meeting was proposed. It is a co-sponsored effort between GSB-France and GSB-US/Canada to create a new Central Africa Zonal Meeting by 2007 with a starting membership of five French-speaking countries.

In the presentation on the International Literature Fund, Greg

Muth reviewed the General Service Office's International Literature Assistance expenditures to emerging countries. Since 1991, the costs amounted to over \$2 million, of which \$472,884 came from support outside our conference structure. In the following discussion, it came to our attention that only the general service structure of Ireland was entirely self-supporting through the contributions of their Fellowship. Naturally, we turned to the Irish delegates for an explanation. It's an interesting one: The Irish Fellowship was used to putting one Irish pound in the pot, on average. Around the time of Ireland joining the European Union, someone had foreseen that the Irish currency, when the exchange occurred, would result in a reduction in A.A. contributions, since the euro would be worth less than the Irish pound. To counter this potentially devastating situation, a program was started to promote putting two euros in the pot when the change to the new money happened. They began this program well in advance—and it worked! With this increase in contributions, the prudent reserve was able to be topped up, and the overflow was sent to the International Literature Fund.

During this time in Ireland, the structure and the Fellowship were maturing, and their communication improved through use of newsletters to inform the Fellowship about the need for self-support throughout the Irish general service structure. The improved communication allowed better transmission of reports of the use of the literature that the International Fund monies were able to provide. The delegate gave the example of the recent A.A.W.S. publication regarding the cost of printing the literature for A.A. in Mongolia. The newsletter in Ireland expressed this figure as the total printing cost (plus shipping) divided by the number of A.A. members in the Irish Fellowship and arrived at the figure of five euros per member. This was equal to about one week's contribution for the average member. In this way, the outcome of the International Literature Fund's efforts in Mongolia became personal to the Irish A.A. member. He or she could feel an immediate sense of connection with the Twelfth Step work that is represented in carrying the message to another alcoholic *in that alcoholic's native language*. The phrase "In order to keep it, we've got to give it away" took on new meaning as A.A. members in Ireland applied it to their money. They keep on giving, and they like hearing about how the money is used to bring the program to the far corners of the world.

The Irish experience is what I want to use to tie the 18th WSM to the theme of this General Service Conference: "Basics of Our Home Group—Recovery, Unity and Service." That Irish story illustrates that the basic strength of the A.A. movement comes from the recovery of its members in group settings. It shows that through that recovery a desire to give back is born and can be channeled through service to carry the message to others. The Irish do this service within their own country, but felt inadequate doing so beyond their borders, so they choose to send their increased contributions to assist the international efforts to carry the message—specifically to the International Literature Fund. This remarkable achievement of self-support, coupled with the newfound confidence that accrues to the helper in a helping situation, has engendered a newfound sense of partnership with those other countries that are doing the active sponsorship of A.A. in new nations. That, in turn, has sparked a sense of Unity among the Irish groups and with A.A. as a whole. The stories of the A.A. program, brought into new places and changing the lives of the new A.A. members there, inspires on-going interest and sacrifice in the form of continued contributions for the double cause of self-support and international Twelfth Step work. Carrying the message does work both ways!

*Murray McIntosh,
trustee-at-large/Canada*

A.A. Around the World

The staff member on the International assignment has the unique opportunity to witness how the basics of our home group—recovery, unity and service—assist in A.A.'s growth around the world.

In 1955, our co-founder Bill W. wrote: "The expansion of Alcoholics Anonymous soon became nothing less than staggering... This foreign development brought us a whole new set of dilemmas to solve... We ran into language barriers, so more and more of our literature was translated into other tongues... We now know it is only a question of time when every alcoholic in the world will have as good a chance to stay alive and happy as we have had here in America. Serving the foreign groups has therefore become a major activity, though we've scarcely scratched the total problem so far. If A.A.'s Headquarters had never done anything else, this effort alone is worth many times its cost." (*The Language of the Heart*, pp. 152-153)

The story of A.A. Around the World begins always with the sick and suffering alcoholic. In whatever faraway land someone finds A.A., that person needs another alcoholic in order to stay sober. When a second alcoholic is found, an A.A. group is born. Historically, the A.A. message has been carried in a myriad of ways—perhaps in a magazine article, or a visit from traveling A.A.s, professionals or members of the Armed Forces. When the magic of one alcoholic sharing with another happens, it is important that A.A.s stay together, and that unity is supported by A.A.'s Twelve Traditions. As more A.A. groups come into being, A.A. members realize that they must work together to carry the A.A. message of recovery. I would like to highlight some events that illustrate how A.A. members overseas are sharing the responsibility of carrying the A.A. message:

- Following the Fifth Asia-Oceania Service Meeting in 2003, the A.A. groups in Japan, through their general service board, assumed the responsibility of sponsoring and sharing experience, strength and hope with the Mongolian A.A. Board. Subsequently, Noriaki N., general manager of the Japan Service Office (JSO) in Tokyo and Isamu S., JSO International staff member, attended with trustee-at-large/Canada Murray McIntosh and Greg Muth, G.S.O.'s general manager, the First National Convention in Mongolia. At this historic event, using the Third Legacy procedure, the beginning of a service structure of A.A. in Mongolia was created. Mongolia plans to attend the Sixth Asia-Oceania Service Meeting to be held later this year.
- In February 2005, in Croatia, after several years of planning and discussion, A.A. Split, the new central office, held its first business meeting. It was reported that the meeting began with a reading of the pamphlet "Problems Other Than Alcohol," the Third, Fourth and Sixth Traditions, and the "A.A. Guidelines on Central or Intergroup Offices." The A.A. group representatives elected a steering committee and chose a "special worker" for the central office. Representatives from A.A. Switzerland attended the meeting to gather information on how their board and members might support the A.A. groups in Croatia.
- Following the devastating tsunami in Asia-Oceania we received inquiries from A.A. groups asking what they could do to help in the relief efforts on behalf of Alcoholics Anonymous. We shared that we expressed our loving concern to the local offices in that region. We also offered to provide literature assistance to the General Service Offices in Australia, New Zealand, South Africa and India. In the January/March 2005 issue of the "Easy Does It," newsletter of the Thailand Intergroup, Chris W. reported: "This has been a strange and trying time. It has been a time of increased fellowship. The Patong meeting room was turned into a morgue, so island A.A.s converged upon the Sunday and

Wednesday night meetings at Mission Hospital and the Friday night meeting at Bangkok Hospital. On January 4, a convoy of three vehicles went to Khao-Lak and carried a meeting to a fellow A.A. member. We chose the topic 'acceptance' and it is safe to say that each of us gained some comfort from the group and from the strange notion that 'acceptance is the answer to all of our problems today.' The response of the A.A. groups in Thailand, and the support of G.S.O.s in the Asia-Oceania region, along with offers of literature assistance from the U.S./Canada, if needed, are vibrant examples of our Three Legacies in action.

In recent years, a big support in the growth and health of A.A. in other countries has been the utilization of nonalcoholics, or friends of A.A. Nonalcoholics—free of the A.A. member's need to maintain anonymity at the public level—often serve as links between A.A. and the professional community—thus, alcoholics may be reached who might otherwise never find the program. Nonalcoholics can also open doors that will allow A.A. members the opportunity to carry the A.A. message. Last year, a door was opened when A.A. groups in Singapore were invited to send members to voluntarily staff A.A. literature tables and chair A.A. meetings at the First Asia Pacific Institute on Addiction. This landmark event brought together faculty members from eight nations and over 400 professionals from 23 nations and five continents.

In Ghana, over 60 professionals from psychiatric hospitals, prisons, the clergy, military, health care agencies and news organization gathered to learn how A.A. can be a resource for the professional who may be in contact with still-suffering alcoholics. Elaine McDowell, chair of the General Service Board, gave a presentation, and literature packets containing "This is A.A.," "44 Questions," "A.A. As a Resource for the Health Care Professional" and "Information on A.A." were distributed and flyers with local A.A. information were made available, as well as a contact list for A.A. in Africa. At the end of the day, the prison chaplain closed the meeting with a prayer, asking that "all present become ambassadors for A.A."

Serving on the International assignment has given me the opportunity to observe first hand how A.A. has crossed racial, cultural and language barriers. It has also been a privilege to see Bill's vision, shared in the October 1969 Grapevine, become a reality: "Surely the time will come when our overseas A.A. population may well exceed that of the United States and Canada. In *The Third Legacy Manual* and in other writings, the principle has already been enunciated that the General Service Office in New York should one day become the 'senior service center' among a number of national and zonal offices around the globe."

Today there is an A.A. presence in more than 180 countries and there are 58 General Service Offices. I firmly believe that A.A. will continue to grow as long as we share the basics of our home group—Recovery, Unity and Service—at home and around the world.

Adrienne Brown, G.S.O. staff

2005 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

Friday morning's agenda began with two presentations on A.A.'s upcoming 70th Birthday Party. Bob Pelot, Eastern Canada regional trustee, was the moderator.

Our 12th International Convention, celebrating the 70th Birthday of Alcoholics Anonymous, has been a work-in-progress since April 1996, when the Conference recommended that Toronto be the site of the 2005 Convention. From June 30—July 3, 2005, an anticipated 40,000 to 50,000 A.A. members, Al-Anons and friends and family will stream into Toronto for our celebration of sobriety and the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous

At the end of March we had a total registration of 31,000, a bit ahead of the advance registration for the last Convention, in Minneapolis, at this time five years ago. Of the total folks registered, 75 percent are A.A. members; those in the 40 to 55 age group are in the majority; at least 35 A.A.s are between the ages of 13 and 15; and 16 percent of our attendees are over 65 years of age. By years of sobriety, the largest group is in the 11 to 20 years category, and nearly 7,000 members have 20 years or more. Fifty percent have attended at least one previous Convention, and 50 percent are attending their first. So far, members from 63 countries have registered, and we are aware that members in China, Mongolia and Cuba are making efforts to come to Toronto.

Beginning Thursday midnight, there will be marathon meetings in English, French and Spanish. Simultaneous translations for the Big Meetings in the Roger's Centre Stadium (formerly the SkyDome) will be provided in Spanish, French, German, Italian, Polish and Japanese. We have received approximately 100 requests for sign language interpretation, and we plan to provide professional ASL interpreters for selected workshops and meetings and in the Roger's Centre Stadium for the Big Meetings. So far, over 70 percent of attendees have registered online.

The housing lottery went quite smoothly. Of course, not everyone was pleased, and to accommodate those attendees in the outlying hotels, we will provide a limited shuttle bus system.

There are four dances to kick off the Convention on Thursday night, June 30th, and there will also be the traditional three-mile Fun Run. Workshops, regional meetings, topic meetings, panels and special interest meetings will take place Friday and Saturday. In all, more than 200 sessions are planned with approximately 800 participants.

The first three-speaker Big Meeting will take place Friday evening in the Roger's Centre Stadium beginning with the opening Flag Ceremony, and Saturday night, there will be the Oldtimers Meeting. Sunday morning will be the final three-speaker meeting, as well as a brief commemoration of the 50th Anniversary of our co-founder, Bill W., turning the responsibility for the Fellowship over to the General Service Conference, and a presentation of the 25 millionth copy of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

Thousands and thousands of wonderful volunteers who will be greeting A.A. members from all over the world at the airport, the train station, in the lobbies of the hotels, on the streets and in the subways, as well as at the stadium and Convention Centre. We will also have bilingual and multilingual volunteers.

The theme, as you know, is "I Am Responsible," first introduced by Bill at the 1965 International Convention, held in Toronto. Before asking the members gathered there to join him in reciting this declaration, Bill reflected, in part, that "We rededicate ourselves to those vast responsibilities which the long future will hold for us." Each of us, in our hearts, says "I Am Responsible." And that is why all of us who are working on the International Convention want to do everything we can to make June 30th through July 3rd a wonderful and memorable weekend of A.A. sharing.

Doug Richardson, G.S.O. staff

While A.A. members around the world are making plans to attend our 70th Anniversary in Toronto, Ontario, we in Area 83 are preparing to receive you from June 30th to July 3rd. Approximately 4,000 volunteers are being organized to greet

attendees; they will take shifts of four hours each over the Convention period.

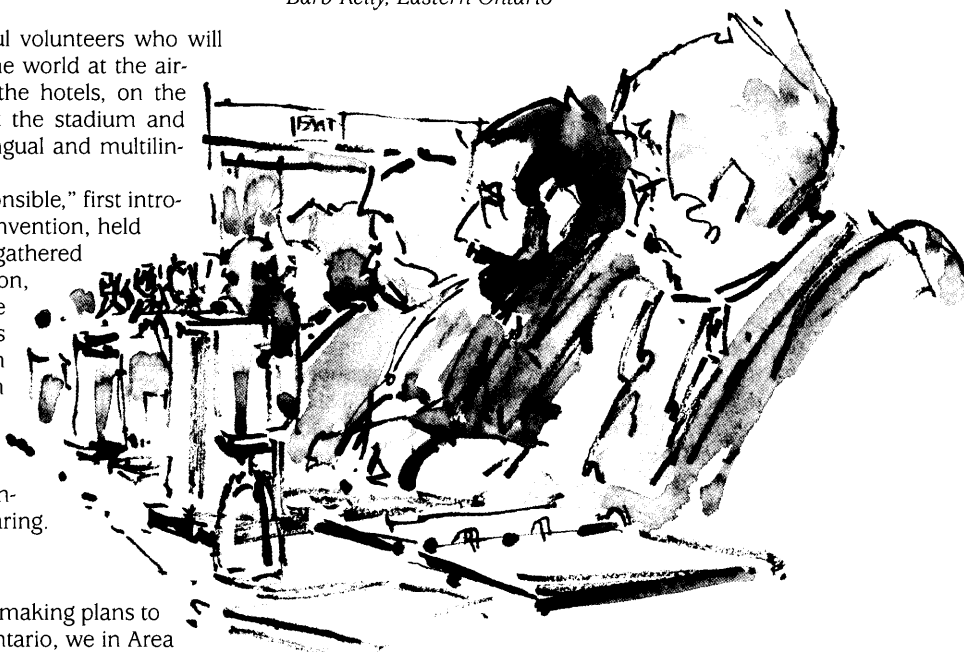
Toronto is a beautiful city with hundreds of things to do. You will find restaurants of nearly every type. There are major sports activities taking place, along with many cultural activities. Most importantly, though, you will have the opportunity to meet old friends and make new friends in our A.A. Fellowship.

The theme of the 2005 Convention is "I Am Responsible," and I would like to share my thoughts on what this means to me, based on our 55th Conference theme "Basics of Our Home Group—Recovery, Unity and Service." The first of our Three Legacies, Recovery, starts at our home group—the heartbeat of Alcoholics Anonymous. It is here that I found sobriety, and a sense of belonging; where I learned to put others' needs ahead of my own; where I was given an opportunity to become involved in service, and to gain self-confidence and learn to be tolerant of others. It is by being with members of A.A. that I maintain my sobriety, and being with 50,000 members in one large setting will only provide a more solid foundation for my sobriety.

The second of our Legacies is Unity, which is the saving grace that keeps Alcoholics Anonymous together. Our lives and the lives of those to come depend on the Unity of our Fellowship. We must stay whole or the heart of A.A. would cease to beat. Through our Steps and Traditions we can protect our service structure and Fellowship to ensure that the doors of A.A. are open worldwide.

The Third Legacy is Service. When I came to Alcoholics Anonymous I was completely beaten. Physically, mentally and spiritually whipped. I learned, by attending meetings of my home group, that the principles of our program would be life changing, if only I would adapt to a new way of thinking. To keep this way of life I learned that I would need to give back what I had been so freely given. Thus I became involved in service. I learned to be responsible. I learned service was gratitude in action, and that it felt good to try to do something for others. It is my responsibility to assist others in their service journey, always remembering that our primary purpose is to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. To protect our Fellowship and my own sobriety, I need to maintain our Three Legacies. For that, I Am Responsible.

Barb Kelly, Eastern Ontario



Reports from the General Service Board, A.A.W.S., Trustees' Committees and G.S.O.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD REPORT

Trustees' report: As I took time to reflect on our last year together, I was struck by the many gifts that trustees of the General Service Board receive from A.A.'s trusted servants. We are given the privilege of observing dedicated service on the front lines here at home, in the United States and Canada, and in far-flung areas of the world. We are able to observe the miracle of recovery in Alcoholics Anonymous demonstrated in the lives and service of so many A.A. members. On behalf of my fellow trustees, I thank you for your service, for your recoveries in A.A. and for your lives. We look forward to sharing this 55th General Service Conference with you and celebrating the Conference theme, "Basics of Our Home Group—Recovery, Unity and Service." Over this year, the board has received several communications from the Fellowship and has responded to the concerns expressed.

Since the 54th Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Portland, Oregon; Montreal, Quebec; and Louisville, Kentucky. Special Forums were held in Goose Bay, Labrador and Rouyn-Noranda, Quebec.

In August, a Final Report of the General Service Board Native North American Committee was distributed to all Conference members. Sharing from across U.S./Canada indicated there are 300 active Native American groups. As the report states, "It is hoped that this shared experience will encourage both continued and additional Twelve Step service to Native American populations..." In October, a G.S.O. staff member was invited to give a presentation on general service at the 14th Annual National/International Native American A.A. Convention.

A highlight of this year was our Forum-like presentation to the International ICYPPA Convention in May in Orlando, Florida. This introduction to general service and various presentations to younger A.A. members were greeted with enthusiasm and thought-provoking questions. We anticipate being invited to future ICYPPA Conventions. This is an extension of Dr. Jack Norris' vision for Regional Forums—to improve communication between the board, the G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs and as many A.A. members as possible.

This year we welcomed four new trustees to the board: Class A (nonalcoholics) trustees Bill Clark, M.D., and Ward Ewing, D.D., as well as two Class B (alcoholic) trustees: Chuck Barta, West Central region trustee, and Tom Kraemer, Western Canada regional trustee. At the close of this annual meeting, six trustees will rotate: myself, Charlie Bartell, David Every, Dick Gallagher, John Koster and Dorothy May. Your board interviewed four candidates for the one Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee opening, which will be created when Leonard Blumenthal rotates in as chair of the General Service Board and I rotate off the board. Once again, I was humbled by the generosity of spirit of those nonalcoholics who were willing to serve A.A. and bring their professional skills and love of A.A. into our A.A. community. It is with both joy and faith in rotation and great sadness that I leave my spiritual family after so many years. Each of my rotating trustee colleagues represent outstanding service and sacrifice on behalf of the Fellowship. I am proud to have served with them.

We will go forward at this Conference without our beloved staff member and last year's Conference coordinator, Bill Archer, who lost his struggle with cancer last June after leading us through a very special Conference experience. Those of us who knew him will miss his marvelous presence and devotion to the principles that embody our Fellowship. Many of us experienced Bill's won-

derful spirit and his ability to change the occasional bleak moment into one of joy and harmony.

This year we also lost our Special Projects manager, Elaine Soroka. We received condolence messages from far and wide that were a tribute to Elaine's past eleven years of diligent service in working with G.S.O.'s Records Department to maintain accurate group information, preparing our many directories and responding to multiple requests for help in maintaining accurate and up-to-date area group records. We welcomed new G.S.O. staff member, Mary Dargan, and Support Services manager, Karen Hale, who has assumed many of Elaine Soroka's responsibilities. Mary is attending her first Conference and has been a great source of support to many trustees' Literature subcommittees.

In February, *The A.A. Service Manual* was added to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site in English, French and Spanish. This new addition to the Web site has received an enthusiastic and positive response.

The 2005 G.S.O. budget includes a \$1.00 increase on all books, except for all formats of the Big Book. The Grapevine Corporate Board continues to make considerable progress and the Grapevine magazine achieved a positive net income of \$60,950 for 2004 and projects the trend to continue for 2005. On-time delivery of the Grapevine magazine and new subscriptions have been welcomed by the Fellowship.

At the 52nd General Service Conference, I reported that the Big Book had been translated into 44 languages. Today, the Big Book is now available in 52 languages worldwide. It is the board's continuing responsibility to safeguard the integrity of A.A.'s written message in all languages. Toward that end, your Publications Department is responsible for overseeing translations of Conference-approved books. I am happy to report that since last April our Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, has been published in Indonesian and Farsi and in a new Dutch version; the translation of the Big Book into Faroese and the translation of *Daily Reflections* into Simplified Chinese have begun. Publications staff also maintains contact with General Service Offices or committees in other countries to achieve accurate translations of Conference-approved pamphlets. Among the pamphlets translated in the last year are: "A Brief Guide to A.A.," "Is A.A. for You?" "44 Questions," "A Newcomer Asks," "This is A.A." and "A.A.'s Legacy of Service" in Swahili and Sinhalese. Nearing completion are several pamphlets in various languages. In each case, the translation reflects the original (English) manuscript, and the practice of assuring that the basic A.A. message is tied to our principles and primary purpose.

In May, and again this January, Bob Pelot, Eastern Canada regional trustee, traveled to the Ungava Bay communities, located in Nunavik, where he met with elders, young people, professionals and A.A. members. Bob reported that, "Although we have been communicating over the years on a regular basis with most of the communities we visited, I feel that there has been nothing more constructive than the actual personal contact we had with the local members and the representatives of the communities."

In August, Adrienne Brown, G.S.O. staff member on the International assignment, and I met with government leaders from the Department of Social Development, Republic of South Africa, in Washington, D.C. During this meeting we provided an overview of Alcoholics Anonymous, distributed pamphlets in Setswana and English and encouraged them to contact G.S.O. South Africa. Greg Muth, G.S.O. general manager, our trustees and G.S.O.'s International coordinator traveled abroad extensively in 2004: Panama, Singapore, Colombia, Mongolia, China, Poland, Greece, Ghana, Togo, Cameroon, France and Great Britain.

In November, Greg, Adrienne and I joined members of the General Service Board of France to discuss the possibility of a Central Africa Zonal Meeting in 2007 with members of the General Service Board of Cameroon. Greg and Adrienne plan to attend the Second Sub-Saharan Zonal Meeting in June. Zonal Service Meetings are invaluable to emerging countries as forums for passing on A.A. experience and the reassurance that, although the growth of A.A. presents challenges, no one member or one country is alone, thanks in large measure to the support of groups and members in Canada and the United States.

We had the privilege of participating in Togo's first A.A. convention. Greg Muth and Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada, witnessed the beginnings of the general service structure in Mongolia, a proud commitment, on their part, to the principle of self-support.

The General Service Board hosted the 18th World Service Meeting last October in New York. Forty-eight delegates from 35 countries spent a week sharing their service experience with each other. Delegates from Lithuania and the Dominican Republic attended for the first time. Charlie Bartell and Murray McIntosh, our trustees-at-large, were our delegates. The theme of this World Service Meeting was "One Message—Many Languages—One Fellowship." Delegates from emerging countries benefited from sharing from longer-established general service structures regarding the challenges of attraction versus promotion, interpreting the spirit of anonymity, country-to-country sponsorship and the historical role and importance of Class A trustees to Alcoholics Anonymous as it grows in emerging nations.

In November, I was invited to speak at the 47th International Council on Alcohol and Addictions Conference in Venice, and was able to present information on A.A. as a resource to both business and industry. I emphasized how, historically, A.A. had sought to cooperate with the professional community and that we continue to seek that cooperation today.

I would also like to report on the many generous offers of support, financial or with literature, received at the General Service Office from A.A. members and groups wishing to help those A.A. members who suffered as a result of the tsunami disaster in Asia. Based on the autonomy of the Asia Oceania Zone, we were able to report to the U.S./Canada A.A. members that the Australia and New Zealand General Service Offices were in contact with A.A. groups in Thailand, India, Sri Lanka, Indonesia and Malaysia. We sent offers of support to the Australia and New Zealand General Service Offices, if needed. Similarly we offered support to the G.S.O. of South Africa for literature distribution for affected groups in the Sub-Saharan Zone. We also forwarded messages of concern and support from the General Service Board and the General Service Office to General Service Offices, World Service Meeting delegates, Central Offices and A.A. contacts in the affected areas. Disasters such as this remind us not to take for granted meeting space, literature, or the lives and health of our fellow A.A. members.

We join you in looking forward to the 2005 International A.A. Convention celebrating the Fellowship's 70th Anniversary in Toronto, June 30 – July 3, 2005, with the theme "I Am Responsible." Personally, I am looking forward to the opportunity of hearing the sharing of experience, strength and hope at the many daytime meetings and at the evening stadium meetings, and to participating with tens of thousands of A.A. members rededicating them-

selves to their own sobriety and to our Fellowship of the Spirit. We will hear the echo of the voice of our co-founder, Bill W., from 1965 in Toronto: "Stirred by gratitude beyond expression, we shall give thanks to God whose grace has made it possible for us to achieve the quality of responsibility, individual and collective, that has brought our Fellowship into its present state of well-being and worldwide reach." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 328.)

Elaine McDowell, Ph.D., chair

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation. The trustees of the General Service Board are the members of A.A.W.S. and elect the A.A.W.S. directors, who are responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), which provides group services, including printing and distribution of Conference-approved and service literature. The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the last Conference to receive G.S.O. management and staff reports; review group services activity and progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations; review financial reports; price new or revised publications; review publishing operations and matters of G.S.O. administration; consider requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A.-copyrighted literature; and address other matters as they arose.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors. Currently, four are trustees, including two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three are nontrustee directors; and the G.S.O. general manager and the staff coordinator also serve as directors. Also attending board meetings, but not voting, are the senior advisor to the general manager, G.S.O. staff members, the controller, publications director, human resources manager, archivist, board secretary, and a representative from the Grapevine office. The board welcomed guests, trustees, appointed members of trustees' committees, delegates and other A.A. members to its meetings during the year.

The committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services, which considers the needs of all service assignments; Publishing, which reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications concerns; Finance, which oversees salary and budget, audit review, and retirement; and Nominating. Long-range planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole.

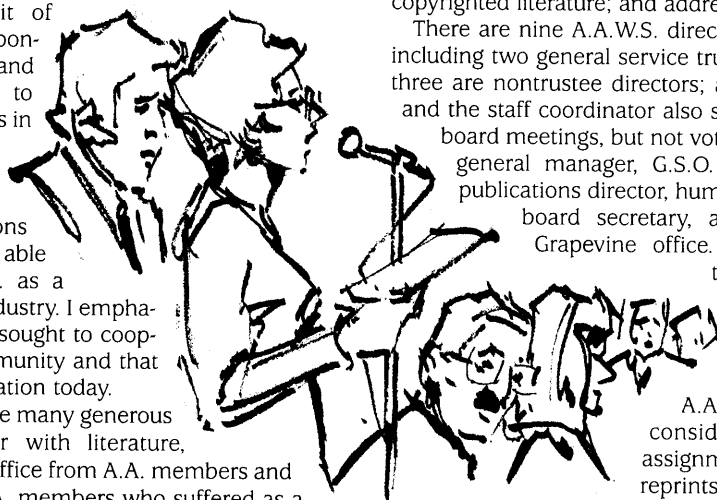
New Groups — During 2004, a net total of 619 new groups were registered with G.S.O.

Regional and Special Forums — Since the last Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff participated in the following Regional and Special Forums. *Regional Forums:* Pacific in Portland, Oregon, July 16-18; Eastern Canada, St-Hyacinthe, Quebec, August 27-29; Southeast in Louisville, Kentucky, December 3-5. *Special Forums:* A Special Forum was held in Goose Bay, Labrador, NF, June 5-6; and another Special Forum took place in Rouyn-Noranda, Quebec, February 19-20.

Visitors — G.S.O. welcomed a total of 1,388 visitors during 2004.

Annual Intergroup Seminar — Julio Espallat and Greg Muth attended the 19th Annual Intergroup Seminar in Denver, Colorado, September 30-October 3.

World Service Meeting — Forty-eight delegates from 35 countries participated in the 18th World Service Meeting (WSM), in New York City, October 17-21. The theme, "One Message, Many Languages, One Fellowship," set the tone for presentations and



encouraged sharing of experience on carrying the A.A. message through sponsorship of other countries within respective zones. The W.S.M. Literature Fund provides help in funding translations of A.A. literature and contributions to this fund totaled \$126,000 in 2004.

ICYPAA Conference — During May 27-30, members of the General Service Board, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff attended the 47th National ICYPAA Conference in Orlando, Florida.

Spanish National Convention — Greg Muth attended the Spanish National Convention in Phoenix, Arizona, September 3-5.

Native American Convention — Valerie O'Neill attended the 14th Annual National/International Native American Indian A.A. Convention in Minneapolis, Minnesota, October 14-17.

National Council on Alcohol and Drug Dependence (NCADD) 60th Anniversary — Greg Muth and Rick Walker attended NCADD's 60th Anniversary Celebration in Washington, D.C.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site — Following a 2004 Conference Advisory Action, the Services Committee presented the 3rd and 4th Quarter, plus Annual 2004 Activity Reports on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site to the board, which approved their being forwarded to the trustees' Committee on Public Information for their review.

Postings to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site — The pamphlet, "A Brief Guide to A.A.," was put on the Web site. The board also approved the recommendation that a selection of Conference-approved radio public service announcements (PSAs) be uploaded to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, www.aa.org. In the spirit of the 2002 General Service Conference Advisory Action that "A four-year replacement schedule for television PSAs be implemented to replace one television PSA each year over the next four years..." the PSA, "We Know What Its Like," was added to the Web site in September of 2004. The Overseas list was added to the site; and the board approved recommendations to add the Intellectual Property Policies and *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* to the site as well.

Visits by G.S.O. office staff to overseas service structures — General Service Office staff enjoyed visits with trusted servants and A.A. members in other service structures, as follows.

Europe: Greg Muth attended the 10th International Convention of A.A. in Ermioni, Greece, May 1-10. Adrienne Brown and Murray McIntosh traveled to Poland during August 24-29, visiting the Polish G.S.O. in Warsaw and attending Poland's 30th A.A. Anniversary Convention in Krakow. (Following the trip to Poland, Dr. Ewa Wydhytto-Osiatynska, a friend of A.A. and a psychologist and Director of the Regional Alcohol and Drug Program in Warsaw, Poland, visited G.S.O. New York.) Elaine McDowell and Adrienne met in Paris, France with the General Manager of G.S.O. France, several members of the General Service Board of France, and a trustee from the Board of French-speaking Switzerland to discuss plans for a possible Central Africa Zonal Meeting in 2007. Greg Muth attended the Quarterly Meeting of the General Service Board of the U.K. in York, England, November 17-20.

Africa: Elaine McDowell and Adrienne Brown met with A.A. members and professionals to provide information about Alcoholics Anonymous in Ghana, Africa, November 6-10. Elaine McDowell, Greg, Adrienne—along with members of the General Service Board of France visited A.A. groups in Togo and participated in Togo's 1st A.A. Convention, November 10-13. They continued on to Cameroon, November 14-16, to meet with A.A.s and participate in a workshop in Cameroon. In addition, Adrienne Brown and Elaine McDowell, Ph.D., met with representatives of the Government of South Africa in Washington, D.C., on August 12.

Latin America: Adrienne Brown and trustee-at-large/Canada, Murray McIntosh, attended the 8th Annual Colombia National Convention in Barranquilla, Colombia, July 2-5.

Asia/Oceania: Adrienne Brown visited the Asia-Pacific Institute on Addictions and visited the Thailand Intergroup and various Thai A.A. meetings during May 29-June 4. Greg Muth and Murray McIntosh traveled to Ulaan Baatar, Mongolia, July 7-10, and witnessed the formation of Mongolia's General Service structure using A.A.'s Third Legacy procedure.

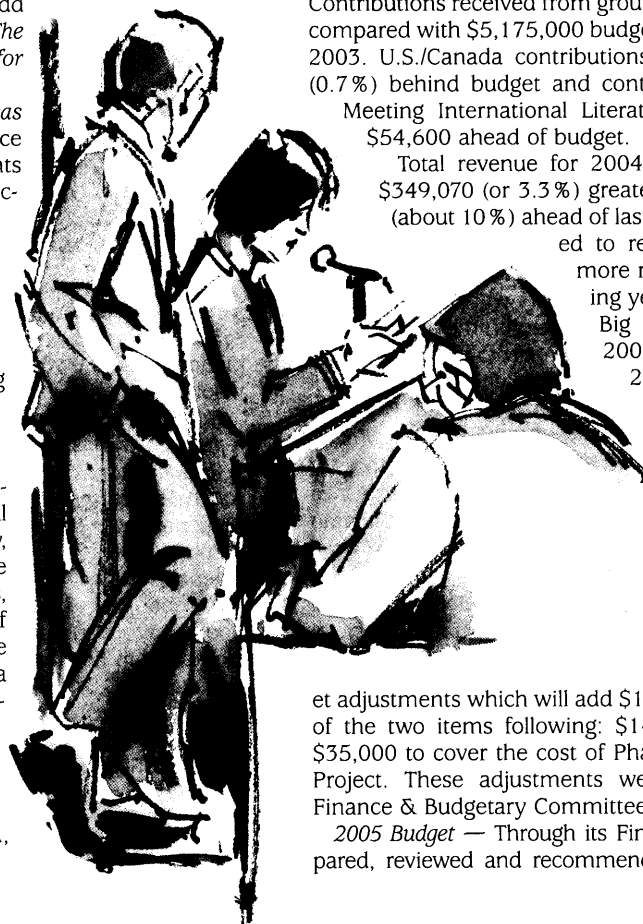
A.A.'s 70th Anniversary International Convention in 2005 — As of mid-March, 30,000 people were registered for the International Convention, scheduled June 30-July 3, 2005, in Toronto, Ontario. As the countdown to our 70th Anniversary celebration continues, convention planning projects are on schedule. G.S.O. has continued to share information with those interested in attending on the need for proper travel documentation and, for those with past convictions for criminal offenses, the need to obtain clearance through Canadian Immigration authorities in advance of the event.

Financial Results for 2004 — A brief summary of the financial results for 2004 reflected the following: gross sales of \$11,620,496 were approximately \$645,000 (5.9%) greater than budgeted and \$851,000 (7.9%) greater than 2003 gross sales. Contributions received from groups and members of \$5,194,015, compared with \$5,175,000 budgeted and \$5,194,315 received in 2003. U.S./Canada contributions were approximately \$36,000 (0.7%) behind budget and contributions to the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund were approximately \$54,600 ahead of budget.

Total revenue for 2004 was \$10,905,170, which was \$349,070 (or 3.3%) greater than budgeted and \$988,870 (about 10%) ahead of last year. For 2004, we had budgeted to receive approximately \$210,000 more revenue than during the preceding year, anticipating the effect of the Big Book price restoration in July 2004. Total operating expenses for 2004 were \$11,217,300, approximately \$100,000 (1%) less than budgeted and approximately \$762,400 (7%) more than in 2003. Unaudited net loss for 2004 was \$312,148 compared with a budgeted loss of \$760,991, or \$448,800 better than budgeted.

Mid-Year 2004 Budget Adjustments — The board approved mid-year 2004 budget adjustments which will add \$177,750 to the budget, consisting of the two items following: \$142,750 needed for Operations; \$35,000 to cover the cost of Phase II of the Computer Software Project. These adjustments were forwarded to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee.

2005 Budget — Through its Finance Committee, the board prepared, reviewed and recommended G.S.O.'s 2005 budget to the



trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee for review. The budget includes an increase of \$1.00 per title on books G.S.O. publishes, except for all formats of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*. The price increase will take effect on July 1, 2005. The budget also includes implementation of a 10% service charge on all orders under \$250.00 with a minimum service charge of \$3.00, also effective July 1. This information was mailed to all central/intergroup offices, GSRs, and non-A.A. purchasers on March 25; and will be announced in the April/May issue of Box 4-5-9. (Details of A.A.W.S.'s financial operations are included with the Treasurer's Report.)

Adoption of Best Accounting Practices — The board adopted the policy adopted by the General Service Board concerning best accounting practices for Capitalization and Depreciation of operating items formerly expensed as incurred.

Publications Department Staff — Andrea Brennan was promoted to Order Entry Manager, and Edward Nylan was hired as a new Production Assistant.

Unit Distribution of Books — For the year 2004, G.S.O. distributed a total of 1,953,631 units, up 9% from the total of 1,784,278 units in 2003. Through December 2004, total A.A. purchases amounted to 1,472,586 units; while non-A.A.s accounted for 481,045 units, or 25% of 2004 purchases.

Big Book Sales (All Editions) — Through December 2004, 1,202,089 book units were distributed, compared to 1,014,393 units for the same period in 2003—representing an increase of 187,696 units, or 19%.

25,000,000 Big Books — We recently published the 25-millionth copy of our Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, a significant milestone in A.A. history. That copy will be presented to a friend of A.A. during A.A.'s 70th Anniversary celebration during the 2005 International Convention.

Translations and Licensing Projects — The following translations have been printed: Simplified Chinese pamphlets, "A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous" and "Is A.A. for You?"; Japanese Daily Reflections; Lavrian Big Book and the pamphlets, "The A.A. Group," "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," "Understanding Anonymity," "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?" and "If You are a Professional"; Sinhalese pamphlets, "This is A.A.," "Is A.A. for You?," "44 Questions," "A Newcomer Asks," "A Brief Guide to A.A." and "Information on A.A."; Swahili pamphlets, "A Newcomer Asks," "Is A.A. for You?," "A Brief Guide to A.A.," "This is A.A." and "44 Questions"; and Zulu Big Book. The following translations have been licensed: Hungary to print and distribute the Big Book; and Australia to dub and distribute the public service announcement, "Reach Out." Portugal to use 10 stories from the English Fourth Edition Big Book—which had been translated into Portuguese—along with several of their own stories—in the new edition of the Big Book in Portuguese, to be published by A.A. in Portugal. G.S.O. approved Chapter Five of the new translation of the Big Book into Greek and asked Greece to continue with this translation project. When completed, they will print and distribute under our license. The board also approved the pricing of the Japanese hard cover Big Book at \$34.

The A.A. Service Manual — The publication of the 2004-2005 Edition (English, French and Spanish) of *The A.A. Service Manual* was completed and the "Advisory Actions of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous" (English) was updated to include the actions of the 54th General Service Conference.

Literature Display Rack — The board approved the following: price increase for current literature display rack from \$17.00 to \$20.00; test production and sale of the two side extensions at a purchase price of \$20.00; sale of a set containing the current display rack with two side extensions at a purchase price of \$35.00.

P.I. Literature Display Container (M-46) — The board approved the cost of the Literature Display Container (M-46); and new vendor pricing on a similar, sturdier display container, and recommended that the new generic display container replace the current P.I. container and be sold at a price of \$0.75 each, with a choice of 100 Treatment Facilities, Cooperation With the Professional Community, or Public Information no charge flyers included.

Copyright Infringement Cases in Germany — In July, we were informed that the defendant in the copyright infringement cases in Germany had remitted payment of court costs and attorney fees (approximately \$27,000) as ordered by the German Appeals Court in October 2003.

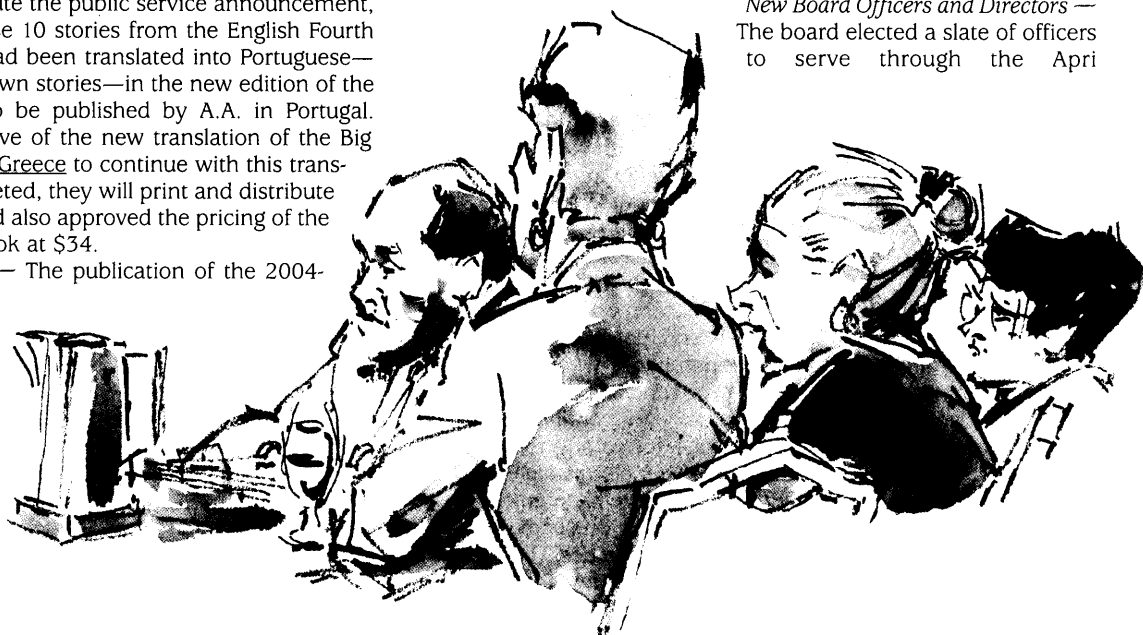
Copyright Protection — We have added language to our current licensing agreements to help keep our copyrighted material from appearing on the Internet without our permission. We will insert such language into all new agreements and will send out addendums to all existing agreements.

Intellectual Property Policies — The A.A.W.S. Directors and G.S.O. staff members heard a presentation from outside counsel on Intellectual Property issues regarding A.A., followed by a question and answer period with the presenter. A sharing session was then held regarding these important issues, particularly as they relate to the use of trademarks and service marks. After further review by the A.A.W.S.'s Services Committee, an amended draft of the Intellectual Property Policies, reflecting language available in The A.A. Service Manual, was recommended to the board and approved.

Web-Based, Wholesale Ordering System — The board approved the recommendation from its Publishing Committee for the establishment of a Web-based, wholesale ordering system for central offices, intergroups and other large purchasers to place orders via the Internet. Anticipated implementation by the Publications Department would be during late 2005.

New Warehouse for International Stock — The transfer of international stock and fulfillment business to DataMart, a company located in Montreal, Quebec is in the final stages. Use of the warehouse in Vienna, Austria will be phased out over the next three months.

New Board Officers and Directors — The board elected a slate of officers to serve through the April



2005 Conference. The board welcomed Gary Kluksdahl, Southwest regional trustee, as a new trustee director, to its June 2004 meeting.

Work Force — At year-end 2004, G.S.O. had 79 full-time positions plus 6 part-time/students.

New Staff Member — Mary Dargan joined the G.S.O. staff on August 23 and, after training, assumed responsibility for the Literature assignment.

New Support Services Manager — Karen Hale has joined our team as G.S.O. Support Services manager and is familiarizing herself with operations related to those responsibilities.

Organizational Changes in Information Technology — Effective August 23, Lillianna Murphy, director of Information Services; and Gerald Walker, systems administrator, departed their respective positions. We are especially grateful for Lillianna's dedication throughout her tenure, and for the numerous projects she coordinated during her years at G.S.O. Information Technology functions will be overseen by Don Meurer, our controller and C.F.O., on an interim basis. Information Technology functions are being supported under a contract with our consultant, Ambient, Inc. After a thorough review of our needs, Ambient completed the conversion of our Exchange Mail to Utopia Systems, Inc. Application Service Provider (ASP). We have since realized a dramatic improvement in the performance of our e-mail system, while eliminating most problems associated with SPAM and undesirable "pop-ups." In January 2005, A.A.W.S. engaged Invision of Hauppauge, NY, to outsource our Information Technology infrastructure. Invision will establish dedicated network and server resources for G.S.O. at its state-of-the-art data center on Long Island; migrate existing systems from our current servers at 475 Riverside Drive; and provide 24/7 systems management and support for G.S.O.'s network, server, and desktop resources.

Ronald Gauthier, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' report: In response to the 2004 Conference Archives Committee's support and strong encouragement, we began to explore the feasibility of raising the distribution of the new *Markings*, the archival newsletter. The work will be completed by mid-2005.

The 2004 reprint of the Archives Workbook incorporates suggestions by the 2004 Conference Archives Committee.

In September 2004 spending on the audio preservation project conducted at the G.S.O. Archives was halted due to concerns of budget overrun. The original project scope covered digitizing and formatting the large number of reel-to-reel tapes in inventory, which at the time (2000) were judged to be in the poorest condition compared to other forms of audio media in the collection. This project is complete; all reel-to-reel tapes then in the G.S.O. Archives collection have been re-mastered. Of the original capital project allocation of \$400,000, \$230,000 was spent to complete the project.

An inventory of remaining items (including a large number of audio cassette tapes, additional reel-to-reel tapes received since the project terminated, and a lesser number of wire and phonograph recordings), in terms of their condition, content and nature, was prepared and the discussion will continue in 2005 regarding development of a project for reformatting and digitizing this material. The preserved audio material is invaluable. The benefits of the audio preservation project have been enjoyed by an increasing audience: audio selections were presented first to members of the 2004 General Service Conference, then those participating at the 2004 Pacific Regional Forum. Currently, a

series of DVDs containing a selection of irreplaceable audio material is being developed for the 2005 International Convention.

Gary Kluksdahl, chairperson

Archivist's report: We started 2004 with a renewed *Markings* newsletter. The new design signals a new vision and an expanded focus for the newsletter. We continue to welcome articles contributed by local archivists and we are always on the lookout for more material. We will also explore the wealth of the archives' files and present articles on the history of our Fellowship. Each issue focuses on a theme. The first one, as a natural starting point, described some of the early recovery efforts in existence before the birth of Alcoholics Anonymous. We hope that the articles will increase our understanding and appreciation of the historic context of our Fellowship.

Early in 2004 we started to utilize a new underground storage facility north of New York City. The decision was made after several meetings with representatives, exploring various options in terms of fees, facility layout, geographical locations, as well as site visits. We intend to store our most precious documents under strict climate control, while providing optimum security for our vital records. The transfer of documents is ongoing and gradual; the first batch of documents has been sent to the site already.

Selections of historic audio material were first introduced to members of the 2004 General Service Conference then, later in 2004, to participants of the Pacific Regional Forum. Our recorded histories provide primary testimonies on how early on archives keeping was addressed in the Fellowship. The recorded histories reflect the recollections of oldtimers setting out with a wire recorder to capture their times for us, the future generations. Hearing the voices in time capsule-like messages, greeting us, demonstrating their faith that a future generation will appreciate the history recording effort is a tearfully emotional experience.

Judit Olah, archivist

AUDIT COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Audit Committee consists of four trustees in addition to the board treasurer, who chairs the committee. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The committee meets with the outside auditor and G.S.O. and Grapevine management; separately with the auditor; and in executive session without the auditor. The Audit Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews such items as audit process, audit results, internal controls, best accounting practices, and management integrity.

Vincent Keefe, treasurer

CONFERENCE

Trustees' report: The committee met three times since the 2004 General Service Conference, and we reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the 2004 Conference, including the theme chosen for the 55th General Service Conference, "Basics of Our Home Group—Recovery, Unity and Service." We also discussed a Summary of the Evaluation Questionnaires and a Summary of Post-Conference Sharing Session, and made the following suggestions:

- Add the service piece "General Service Area Map" to the Conference Manual.
- Consider adding one additional time slot for the joint trustees'

and Conference Committee meetings and examine meeting times.

- Look for ways to improve communication with Conference members on the history and purpose of the joint trustees' and Conference Committee meetings.
- Consider relabeling the answer options on the Conference Evaluation Forms.

The committee discussed the following additional considerations of the 2004 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions:

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference consider changing the reference to "personal digital assistants" to "*personal digital assistants (PDAs) with a keyboard requiring power*" in Section Definitions 1. of the "Guidelines for PC Users at the General Service Conference."
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference consider forwarding a recommendation to the 2005 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions regarding the broader use of self-powered personal digital assistants (PDAs) and/or similar electronic devices with no attachments for note taking at the General Service Conference.

A subcommittee was formed to examine the feasibility and practicality of implementing the two additional considerations and to explore all options. The subcommittee presented a report at our October 2004 meeting. The committee took no action and we agreed that the existing guidelines for PC users and PDA's remain as is.

The committee discussed the request that all proposed agenda items (and their source) submitted for inclusion on the General Service Conference Agenda and denied, be compiled. This item had been tabled at the October 2003 committee meeting where the committee asked the committee secretary to communicate with the submitting area outlining the committee's questions and concerns and to gather further details. After lengthy discussion on the impact such a list would have on keeping the focus of the Fellowship on those items which are on the Conference agenda, the committee took no action.

We reviewed and accepted the preliminary budget for the 55th General Service Conference and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee. In addition, we reviewed and approved the workshop questions and the *preliminary* draft of the main agenda for the 55th General Service Conference for distribution in the Communications Kit to be mailed by January 3, 2005.

The committee discussed electronic distribution of Conference agendas and background material and recommended to the General Service Board that, starting with the 55th General Service Conference, Conference agendas and background material be made available on CD-format to Conference members, upon request, on a two-year trial basis to be reviewed following the 2006 General Service Conference by the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference, and that G.S.O. staff prepare guidelines for redistribution of Conference agendas and background and present a draft to the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference for review at the January 2005 meeting. [Note: The option of requesting CD format and/or hardcopies would be available to Conference Members.]

The committee discussed how G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site has been useful to the work of the committee. The committee noted that Box 4-5-9, which is posted on the Web site, includes articles on the General Service Conference.

In January, we approved the updated main Conference agenda that included presentation topics chosen by the Conference Agenda Committee and approved by the 2004 Conference. We reviewed a list of topics submitted for consideration and forwarded to the appropriate committee or board for consideration. There were over 20 items forwarded to trustees' and Conference committees, and to A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards. In

addition, we reviewed the list of suggestions for the theme, presentations and workshop topics for the 2006 Conference.

The committee reviewed and approved the revisions to the 55th General Service Conference Evaluation Form. We reviewed and approved a draft of "CD Format and Redistribution of Conference Background Material" guidelines.

Finally, it was with great pleasure that we welcomed the delegate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee to our January meeting. Our committee sincerely hopes that everyone has a wonderful Conference experience and that we will all continue to enjoy the wonderful life that has been given to us in Alcoholics Anonymous.

Arnold Ross, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

Created in 1951, the annual meeting of the General Service Conference became in July 1955 "...the guardian of the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, the perpetrators of the world services of our Society, the voice of the group conscience of our entire Fellowship, and the sole successor of its co-founders, Doctor Bob and Bill." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, pp. S91-S92)

A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area structures for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referred directly to a Conference committee. Occasionally topics are submitted, which are more appropriately under the purview of either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards. These items are accordingly forwarded to those boards for their attention. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the Early Bird edition of Box 4-5-9 and the Conference *Final Report*.

None of this work would be possible without the help of a very capable staff assistant and an "in house" team of extraordinary G.S.O. employees working behind the scenes to ensure that the Conference week is a memorable experience for all.

Eva Sanchez

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities were combined by action of the General Service Board in April 1998. Since the 2004 General Service Conference, the committee, has met three times. The committee's work embodies A.A.'s primary purpose, and is guided by actions of the General Service Conference



and the General Service Board. Highlights of trustees' Committee meetings have been sent to area, district and other C.P.C. and Treatment Facilities chairs, in addition to current sharing that could benefit local committees.

The committee discussed a request from the A.A.W.S. Services Committee for sharing on how G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site can be of help to the committee and forwarded several suggestions to the secretary of G.S.O.'s Intra-Office Web Site Committee.

Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) — A primary committee focus is assisting local C.P.C. committees to provide A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic. The committee gave the go-ahead to produce the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit in a three-ring binder format.

The committee requested that the C.P.C. staff member gather sharing from local committees on ways that they approach professionals, for possible inclusion in the Workbook. An additional consideration of the 2004 Conference C.P.C. Committee requested "that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities review the inclusion of the name of a Class A trustee in the service piece 'Information on Alcoholics Anonymous.'" After discussion, the trustees' committee concluded that, in this particular context, it would be more appropriate to replace the name with a description of the professional making the comment.

The committee also reviewed the 2004 list of 54 exhibits as well as the exhibit evaluations and expressed gratitude for the breadth and depth of these opportunities for contact with so many professional groups. Offers to exhibit at professional conferences are considered based on expanding the range of professions and on new geographical locations.

Treatment Facilities — The committee's interest in treatment facilities, rehabilitation centers and similar centers is reflected through local A.A. committees on Treatment Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions (H&I) and Bridging the Gap (BTG). Shared experience about this facet of Twelfth Step work is conveyed in literature, by written communications, and by articles in *Box 4-5-9*. The committee considers the need for changes in related literature and service material, such as the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit.

The committee began a long-range discussion of the effectiveness of T.F. committees and the General Service Office Treatment Facilities staff assignment. At the request of the committee, the 2004 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities began discussion of this topic. The Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities asked staff to mail a survey regarding T.F. activities to T.F.,

BTG and H&I chairs, as well as central and intergroup offices. Survey results were compiled, analyzed and reviewed by the committee. The survey results were widely distributed in January 2005.

Allen Ault, chairperson

Staff reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community — Experience indicates that many professionals are aware of A.A., yet few know what A.A. is, or what we do, and fewer have been to an A.A. meeting. The staff member on the C.P.C. assignment, along with a capable assistant, provides information about A.A. and facilitates good communication with those outside of A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

In 2004, the C.P.C. desk responded to more than 1,900 inquiries from professionals, 961 of which were associated with visits to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, other requests coming by letter, e-mail and phone. Many of those same professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees who responded with offers for direct contact, information about how to send clients to meetings, offers of literature, or other means to assure that A.A. is a resource for professionals.

For another year that we endeavor to see that professionals are aware of the long-range help offered by A.A. include the newsletter for professionals, *About A.A.* Two issues of *About A.A.* were published in 2004. The Spring issue shared the experience of four nonalcoholic professionals and how they use A.A. as a resource. The Fall issue focused on the A.A. Grapevine, and how it can be helpful to professionals. Currently, more than 13,000 professionals are receiving *About A.A.*

Professional exhibits continue to result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members. The C.P.C. assignment arranged for displays at 54 national or international conferences of professionals. At these exhibits, G.S.O. provides the booth space and literature; local C.P.C. committees coordinate A.A. volunteers who staff the booth to questions and provide literature and contacts. In addition, over 22 local exhibits were referred to area C.P.C. committees.

The C.P.C. desk is a resource for C.P.C. chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons at the area and district levels are sent a welcome letter and applicable C.P.C. background material. Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience. C.P.C. committees are encouraged to send minutes and to share their experiences for possible inclusion in future *Box 4-5-9* articles. Articles were published in *Box 4-5-9* about local C.P.C. activities throughout the year. This created interest in C.P.C.

service work with courts, clergy, doctors, medical students, educators and other professionals.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O. and encouraged to attend "open" A.A. meetings.

The staff member on C.P.C. also serves as the liaison to area, district and other committees involved in carrying the A.A. message to remote communities—those communities to which it is difficult to carry the A.A. message because of language, culture, or geography. The staff member also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism, and Recovery Month planning meetings.

Rick Walker

Treatment Facilities — The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to share experience and information with committees that carry the A.A. message into a variety of treatment settings. The General Service Office currently lists 82 Area Treatment Facilities (T.F.) committee chairpersons, plus 401 district and other T.F. chairpersons, as well as 22 Area Bridging the Gap (BTG) and 17 Area Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) committee chairpersons; 138 BTG and H&I district and other chairpersons are also listed. The total list comprises 660 T.F.—and/or information in treatment settings.

Highlights of quarterly meetings of the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities are sent to members of the Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Public Information and Treatment Facilities Committees. Periodically, we share highlights from the trustees' meetings and activities from the T.F. staff assignment with area, district and other T.F. chairs, for the benefit of the committees they chair. In addition, we are always grateful for local T.F. experience that may be included in an activity report or in a *Box 4-5-9* article.

Each committee chair is sent a welcome letter along with the Treatment Facilities Kit and/or Workbook, A.A. Guidelines and related material. These trusted servants receive *Box 4-5-9* and *About A.A.* to share with their committee. Area T.F. chairs also receive an up-to-date, confidential list of all Area T.F. Committee chairs so that they can share experiences and activities. Correspondence, including requests for sharing and for G.S.O.'s collected experience, is always welcomed from local committees. Some committees are invigorated through cooperation with professional staff in local facilities, often learning better ways to approach clients within the regulations established by the facility.

The T.F. staff member also receives correspondence from clients or patients in treatment centers. Each request receives a response from the staff member along with A.A. literature. Some of these patients submit a request for help and are referred to local committees so that local committee members have the opportunity to extend the hand of A.A. Requests from professionals in treatment centers are given careful attention. Each professional is sent literature, and in most cases contact with members of the Treatment Facilities or C.P.C. Committee is arranged. The staff member on this assignment also serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, and as co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities.

Irene Kontje

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2005¹

	Groups	Members
United States	52,651	1,190,637
Canada	<u>4,872</u>	<u>95,984</u>
Sub-Total	57,523	1,286,621
Correctional facilities ²	2,562	66,963
Internationalists		76
Lone members		<u>223</u>
Total	60,185	1,353,883
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	<u>45,209</u>	<u>729,097</u>
Grand Total	105,294	2,082,980

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in more than 180 countries, including 58 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use an earlier year's figures.

CORRECTIONS

Trustees' report: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Corrections is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Since the 2004 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Corrections has met three times. At the recommendation of the 2004 Conference, the trustees' committee unanimously agreed to forward the following statement on A.A.'s Singleness of Purpose to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities to consider for inclusion in the pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals":

"Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings, but only those with a *drinking* problem may attend closed meetings."

A subcommittee was appointed to help review the revised and updated draft manuscript of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* by working with the Publications Department to review the final selection of stories and illustrations. The committee reviewed a draft manuscript for the revision of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* and recommended it to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for review and consideration.

The committee forwarded a report to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities on the feasibility and cost of producing and distributing an informational video featuring someone highly credible in the corrections field introducing A.A. into training programs for corrections personnel.

The committee forwarded a report and draft service piece, "Guidelines for the Development of Workshops Introducing A.A.

in Training Programs for Correctional Personnel" to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities

The committee recommended that its name be changed from "Trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities" to "Trustees' Committee on Corrections" and this was approved by the General Service Board.

At the request of the A.A.W.S. Services Committee, the committee discussed how G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site could be more useful to the work of Correctional Facilities Committees. A number of suggestions were forwarded to the A.A. World Services Board.

Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D., chair

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Nearly 700 letters a month arrive from inmates, most asking for free literature, many asking for names of outside A.A. members with whom to correspond, or for help in making contact with A.A. upon release. We try to facilitate these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Correctional Facilities committees. The newsletter, *Sharing From Behind the Walls*, containing sharing from inmate letters sent to G.S.O., is also a responsibility of this assignment.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS), coordinated by this desk, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. There is an ongoing need for "outside" A.A. members, particularly men, to participate in this service. Yet whenever a G.S.O. staff member attending an assembly, convention, conference or other Fellowship function has mentioned the tremendous need for CCS volunteers and provided ample supplies of the service piece "Corrections Correspondence—a special kind of A.A. service" (F-26), there has been a substantial increase in the number of A.A.s wishing to correspond with those on the inside. Additionally, a letter explaining the Corrections Correspondence Service is sent twice a year to delegates and correctional chairpersons asking for A.A. volunteers to write to inmates on an individual basis.

The staff member sends an alternate year informational letter to wardens and correctional professionals throughout the United States and Canada, enclosing a return postcard for those professionals requesting additional information or contact with a local A.A. Correctional Facilities committee. The mailing now contains the information that A.A. pamphlets and books are available in languages other than English, contains a copy of the July 2003 issue of the *A.A. Grapevine: Released: One Day at a Time*, and includes language about A.A. that is particularly pertinent to selective correctional settings. This issue of the *A.A. Grapevine* is also

sent to all inmates who contact the office for prerelease assistance.

One of the most pleasant duties of the assignment is communicating with the area and district Correctional Facilities, Hospitals and Institutions and Bridging the Gap Committees. We shared with the committees our list/order forms, available in English, French and Spanish, for obtaining Correctional Facilities discount packages. These packages were designed to assist Correctional Facilities committees in their Twelfth Step work by providing an assortment of A.A. literature at discount prices.

A frequent question asked by A.A. members involved in corrections service is how to get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. The fear of not having the inmate identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and the amount of time institutions require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into correctional facilities are commonly pointed out as impediments to Fellowship participation. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in correctional service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

Mary Clare Lynch

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' report: At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2004 and reported that the G.S.O. expected a loss from operations of approximately \$618,241, which after mid-year adjustments, resulted in an estimated loss of \$760,991. Actual results for 2004 were some \$389,000 better. Net revenues were about \$349,000 better than expected and expenses were about \$40,000 less than budgeted. At the end of 2004 the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 8.4 months of operating expenses.

General Service Office — Our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. We should all be encouraged that contributions in 2004 were again higher than the previous year, even if ever so slightly. This represents the seventh year in a row that contributions have increased over the previous year, reflecting a positive trend. Contributions of \$5,064,000 received from groups and members were \$37,000, or 0.7%, less than budgeted, but \$67,000 more than in 2003. The \$5,064,000 in contributions came from about 25,140 groups, individuals, and service entities. That, for comparison, represents 43.7% of the 57,523 groups registered with G.S.O., and this percent is just slightly less than the previous year. Beginning in 2002 we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O. Total contributions of \$5,191,634, as reflected in our 2004 financial statements, include approximately \$128,000 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. During 2003, the comparable number was \$102,900, and it was \$108,000 in 2002. While contributions were slightly higher, so too were the number of groups reported. Interestingly though, the number for groups was slightly higher while the percent of groups contributing appear to be decreasing ever so slightly. It is important to remember that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$11,297,500. This was \$630,000, or 6%,



greater than budgeted, and \$837,000 higher than 2003. In general, units of books sold increased slightly in 2004 over 2003. In total, printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were greater than budgeted, as were sales. As a result, gross profit of \$5,710,842 was \$330,000 more than budgeted.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$10,905,100, some \$349,000 greater than originally budgeted. Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2004 were \$11,217,318. This was \$100,000 less than budget, but \$762,000 more than the previous year. Therefore, compared with the budget, the increase in revenues, augmented by the decreased expenses, resulted in an operating loss of \$312,148 for the year, a substantial improvement from the budgeted loss of \$760,991. In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was approaching the upper limit established by the General Service Conference. The Conference-approved limit is 12 months of combined G.S.O. and Grapevine operating expenses. We had accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund. At December 2004 the balance was about 8 months. At \$9,075,500 (the adjusted balance used for the calculation), the Reserve Fund amounts to \$157 per listed A.A. group. To give perspective to this number, contributions per group averaged about \$88 for the 57,523 groups registered, while expenses to support services to those groups averaged \$133 per group.

Turning to 2005, the G.S.O. budget assumes relatively flat unit sales of books and booklets. Your responsible trusted servants, after reviewing financial matters, recommended an increase in prices of books and booklets (except the Big Book) as well as an imposition of a small shipping charge effective July 1, 2005. The price increase and shipping charge both come one year after the price restoration of the Big Book, on July 1, 2004. You may remember that the price of the Fourth Edition was set at \$5.00 vs. \$6.00, thus specifically reducing the expected Gross Profit with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. Projections at that time anticipated that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years. Prudence dictates that even though contribution revenue has seen an upward movement during the last several years, a restoration of the revenue stream is appropriate. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services supplied. You should also be aware that as we continue to strive to have literature available—for our Service Conference, in Spanish and French, as well as English—lower print runs in those languages result in higher production costs. Because we strive to have similar selling prices regardless of our manufacturing cost, lower overall gross profits are an expected result, making price increases required from time to time.

In keeping with our Seventh Tradition of self-support, this year's budget also includes a slight increase in contributions. The budget envisions approximately a 2.5% decrease in costs when compared with 2004 actual, and a 3.3% decrease when compared with the 2004 budget. Based on these primary assumptions—a slight decrease in dollar sales; a 1.5% increase in contributions; a decrease in total operating expenses—the projection for 2005 is for an excess of revenue over expenses of \$71,083,

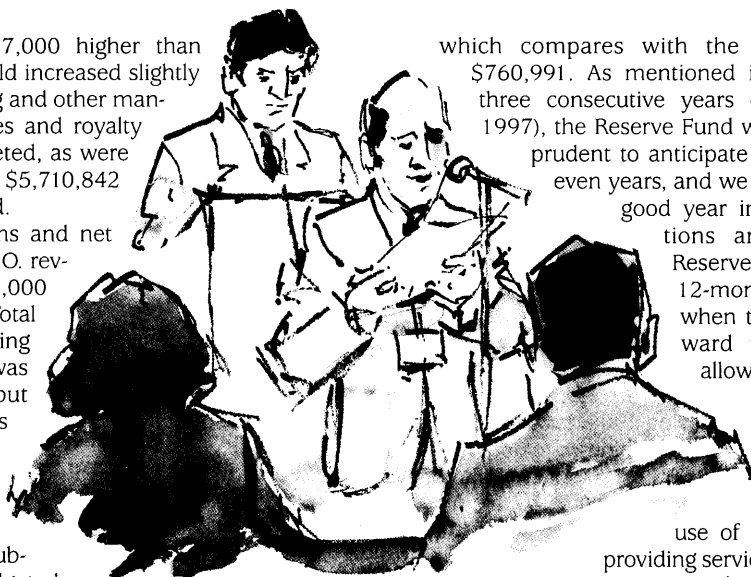
which compares with the 2004 budgeted loss of \$760,991. As mentioned in prior reports, following three consecutive years of planned losses (1995-1997), the Reserve Fund was at a point where it was prudent to anticipate slightly better than break-even years, and we did! Then, following a very good year in 2000, both from operations and the Convention, the Reserve Fund was approaching the 12-month level. We were grateful when the Conference moved forward the "Floating Cap plan" allowing for the orderly "managing down" of the Reserve Fund. We are seeing the results of that action.

Just to expand a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship—in 2004 we spent \$7,622,288 on services to the Fellowship, approximately \$534,000, or 7.5%, more than the \$7,088,055 spent in 2003. This compares with \$7,182,000 spent in 2002, \$6,685,600 spent in 2001, \$6,143,300 spent in 2000, \$5,876,500 in 1999, \$5,867,700 in 1998, and \$5,944,000 in 1997. Contributions provided 68% of this and 32% came from the profit on literature sales. (This compares with 72% and 28% in 2003, 71% and 29% in 2002, 70% and 30% in 2001, and 73% and 27% for 2000.) Services spending amounted to \$132 per listed A.A. group, up \$7 from last year, while contributions were about \$90 per group, up \$1. The 2004 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services, 32.2% (which includes the Group Services assignment; Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 12.5%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 9.6%; trustees' and directors' activities, 6.7%; Regional Forums, 7.8%; Archives, 10.2%; C.P.C., 5.4%; Spanish Services, 1.1%; Public Information, 4.1%; Correctional Facilities, 3.9%; and Treatment Facilities, 1.9%; Convention activities, 2.9%; World Service Meeting activities, 1.7%.

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, magazine income was approximately 2% greater than the prior year, while average circulation was down approximately 3.9%. Average circulation during 2004 was 108,203, compared with 112,614 for 2003, 115,753 for 2002, 115,000 in 2001, 115,700 in 2000, 115,900 for 1999, 117,300 for 1998, 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine was \$1,174,119, which was \$18,000 more than the previous year, but \$62,000 less than budgeted. Revenue of Other Items was \$192,000, less than budgeted and \$37,000 less than the previous year as well. Gross profit on Other Items, was approximately \$106,000 less than budgeted but only \$14,000 less than 2003. Therefore, total income, including interest income, was \$1,631,360, almost exactly even with 2003, but about \$166,700 less than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration (excluding the Digital Archives Project funded by the General Service Board) were \$1,570,410. This is \$56,000 less than last year, and \$123,000 less than budget as well. As a result, the Grapevine (excluding La Viña) reported a profit from operations of \$60,945, compared with the \$5,400 profit last year.

The Grapevine's 2005 budget, excluding La Viña, anticipates magazine subscription income of \$1,816,700, essentially even with the \$1,817,900 realized in 2004, an increase in magazine direct costs of \$36,000, and a gross profit of \$1,125,200. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase



\$58,000, while interest income should be about even. The anticipated profit for 2005 of \$17,783 is expected and, when achieved, will make three successive positive years of Grapevine operations.

La Viña — La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2004 average circulation of 9,316. This compared with 2003 average circulation of 9,222, up slightly from the 2002 circulation of 9,000. Past circulation is 8,600 in 2001, 8,500 in 2000, 8,000 in 1999, and 8,400 in 1997. La Viña appears to be a first-rate product. Our hope is that it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and that we will see a growth in circulation. The project has incurred losses each of the past eight and one-half years. During 2004, subscription income was \$75,430 and direct costs of publishing were \$66,530, resulting in a \$8,900 gross profit. During 2004, La Viña realized approximately \$13,900 from the sales of CDs net of costs. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$130,830. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña, making the overall loss on the project for the year \$108,050.

The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. For 2005, the loss on the La Viña project is budgeted to decrease approximately \$14,000, to \$93,837, and circulation is projected to increase slightly to 9,500 copies. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee will continue to monitor progress against the original business plan and inform the Conference. Since the inception of the project, \$887,794 has been invested in La Viña, and, in 2001, the General Service Board recommended that La Viña continue to be published at the General Service Board's expense. During the year, the Trustees Finance and Budgetary Committee engaged two subcommittees to consider two items. The first has reviewed Capital Projects, Depreciation, and "Best Accounting Practices" and the other is reviewing issues dealing with Post Retirement Medical Benefit Obligations (FAS 106). The FAS 106 discussion includes items such as (1) the creation of a separate "Board Designated Fund" of the General Service Board to account for and receive monies to fund these future benefit obligations, and (2) the operating corporations annually funding such amounts required as determined by calculation models. The subcommittees will continue to meet and report back.

In summary, steps taken to enhance the revenue side of the equation, reductions in the expense side, and consideration of long-term obligations help insure that the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition. The outlook for this year appears favorable, and we continue to have the financial wherewithal to carry the message.

Vincent Keefe, treasurer



GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 55th General Service Conference, the board held three General Sharing Sessions. The topic of the July 2004 session was "A.A. Principles: General Service Conference, General Service Board, General Service Office." The October topic was "Attraction vs. Promotion." In January 2005, the session focused on "A.A. Seventh Tradition—Are We Truly Self-supporting?"

July 2004 — Gary Kluksdahl, Southwest regional trustee, presented on the "A.A. Principles and the General Service Conference" and shared that the General Service Conference, its results and practices, are always being scrutinized by the Fellowship, which is as it should be. Gary noted that essentially, as a Conference, we must invoke all of our Traditions, our Concepts for World Service, and the principles contained in our Steps, in order that we might achieve this "informed group conscience." He went on to say that, in most cases, if something is good for A.A., we should have an overwhelming majority vote. Sometimes, when we fail to arrive at the right question or consideration, that question or consideration will almost always come up again and be analyzed and discussed when the Fellowship is ready for it. He concluded by saying that we need always remember that, as a Conference, our spiritual principles will guide us through any discussion, no matter how contentious. Ultimately we will find the true conscience of the Conference, if we adequately disclose, discuss, and vote in substantial unanimity, and we will likely discover that such matters are good for A.A. as a whole. When we become afraid to discuss, or unwilling to look at such matters, then we have failed the Fellowship that asks us to "act for them, but never govern."

David Every, general service trustee, introduced his presentation on "A.A. Principles and the General Service Board" by sharing that we have many principles in A.A. that can be found in our Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts for World Service. In the Bylaws of the General Service Board, Inc., written by Bernard Smith and adopted originally in 1957, you'll find all three of A.A.'s Legacies: the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts for World Service. David added that in his view, the principles contained in the Traditions and Concepts are designed to help our Fellowship achieve Unity. As a board, the General Service Board attempts to practice these principles in all its affairs. To remain unified we must be willing to sacrifice personal ambitions and ego for the sake of A.A. as a whole. Finally, David stated that if the board is the custodian of the Traditions and is obligated to operate within the spirit of the Concepts, then the board is the custodian of A.A. Unity and we are obligated to do everything in our power to maintain it.

Valerie O'Neill, G.S.O. staff member, shared on the "A.A. Principles: General Service Office" and remembered the earliest days of A.A., when there was no long-term sobriety and 30 days without a drink was a miracle; no money, all low-bottom drunks; no literature for the first four years and a great social stigma that would be difficult for us to imagine today. In spite of this, the earliest A.A. members banded together and made an anonymous spiritual commitment on behalf of the Fellowship to provide information about Alcoholics Anonymous to anyone who asked, no questions asked—alcoholic, nonalcoholic, A.A. member, non-A.A. member. Valerie mentioned that each assignment at the General Service Office represents a different way of presenting "consistent and accurate" information about A.A. and that G.S.O. also practices the principle of corporate poverty. In conclusion, Valerie expressed that the principle of Fellowship guides the actions of the General Service Office. Just as sobriety is "contingent on the daily maintenance of our spiritual condition," the General Service

Office functions on a daily basis to reflect the ongoing principles and Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The following sharing ensued:

- The chair of the Sharing Session mentioned that the principles embedded in A.A. are part of all great spiritual movements, and that most people who are exposed to those A.A. principles are impelled also to try to live by them. As a Class A trustee he is constantly grateful for the opportunity of being exposed to these principles.
- Another Class A trustee asked if we are concentrating too much on the dollar amount of the Reserve Fund instead of asking what else could we do with Seventh Tradition contributions to carry the message.

October 2004 — Gayle Solheim Riese, G.S.O. staff member on the Public Information desk, shared that the first thing she did when she received the loving invitation to present was misread the topic as "Attraction *Rather Than* Promotion" instead of: "Attraction versus Promotion," and decided to stick with it anyway. The next thought that clamored for attention was the response provided to those who call or write to the office in high dudgeon when they "catch" us *advertising* A.A. on television. When this happens she calmly explains that public information in Alcoholics Anonymous, through public service announcements or other vehicles, is the attempt to share with the general public what A.A. is, what we do, and how to get in touch with us. What she usually doesn't add in her initial soothing response is that Tradition Eleven advises against "sensational advertising," not against advertising in any form. Gayle noted that the Long Form of the Eleventh Tradition jumps right in with personal anonymity—"Our relations with the general public should be characterized by personal anonymity"—and pointed out this takes for granted that we *will be having* relations with the general public. All that the Long Form of Tradition Eleven reminds us is we ought to avoid "sensational advertising." Gayle shared that this Tradition has also had a strong meaning for her on a personal level.

Mike Perry, Northeast regional trustee, expressed that his first response to this assignment was to wonder how to make such a simple idea interesting and long enough to take up eight minutes. "Attraction vs. Promotion" refers to the Tradition Eleven and seems, at first, to limit itself to dealing with the public in general, "the Earth People," as they are sometimes called, and only in regard to the news media. Having scratched the surface, he found it runs much deeper than that. Public relations is essential in our mission to carry the message to the next alcoholic, but the types of publicity used have to present the principles of A.A., not any individual members. As a society we should exercise self-restraint and we should publicize the principles of the society and its work, not the individual members. Mike closed by sharing that the journey from the mind of a self-centered alcoholic to a person who sees that the reality of his recovery is the work of his Higher Power, is truly remarkable and wondrous and that this journey is only made possible through the intervention of others, the directions they freely give to help him, and a set of spiritual guidelines to practice as he learns to live life in the fourth dimension.

Following are highlights of the subsequent sharing:

- A.A. principles may be viewed as the layers of an onion, but that when you remove layers you don't subtract, but add meaning to the whole.
- Appreciation was expressed for the valuable services Class A trustees provide to A.A., and how throughout A.A. history the press has developed a respect for our Traditions.
- Excessive promotion does not necessarily ensure a better view of an organization.
- One person shared that it is his personal responsibility to make service work attractive so others will also receive its benefits.

- A trustee-at-large shared about his experience in Mongolia where, in four years, the Fellowship grew from a few members to over 40 groups. When the first A.A. members began to interact in their communities and continued to stay sober, others were attracted.
- The importance of letting others know how to find us. Anonymity should not be understood as invisibility.
- The importance of providing a simple message, sharing our principles and removing personalities.

January 2005 — Vince Keefe's (Class A trustee) presentation was on "A.A.'s Seventh Tradition—Are We Truly Self-supporting?" Vince shared that he decided to look at the question from the viewpoint of the individual member, and confessed that up until that point he always thought of "self-support" and "denying outside contributions" as separate and unrelated ideas. Now he could see that these two are very closely linked, and that it is because we deny outside contributions that we must take on the responsibility to see that our services are adequate and that all our expenses are paid with internal contributions. Vince also thought that this is a responsibility that must be taken on by each individual member of Alcoholics Anonymous. Vince finalized his presentation by asking: What can an individual do who is not yet focused on Tradition Seven? He suggested three things. First, pray about it. Contributions to pay for services are directly connected to our primary purpose of extending a hand to the still-suffering alcoholic. Second, be inquisitive. Ask questions about the services that are performed within our service structure at the district, area and G.S.O. level. Finally, determine what amount you and your group believe would be appropriate to pay for these services and then turn this decision into action.

Presenting on the same topic, Chuck Barta, West Central regional trustee, shared that according to the dictionary, being self-supporting is simply to support oneself without the help of others. Chuck also asked, what is it that we are trying to support and referred to Bill W's writings on page 139 of *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*. He concluded that what we are trying to support is any service that helps reach fellow sufferers. Chuck stated that he believed the answer to the question of self-support can and will be found by utilizing the inventory process. One should ask, "Is my group practicing the Seventh Tradition?" If it is not, why not? Is there a reason for not contributing? Participation is the key to harmony. Chuck concluded that hopefully, by leading by example, more groups will begin or resume practicing the Seventh Tradition.

The following sharing ensued:

- Communication plays a major role in helping groups become aware of the services available and in claiming responsibility for them.
- The Tradition Seven is not only financial, but also giving of your time and effort.
- It was reported that one group sent a one dollar contribution regularly to all service entities. The most important aspect was to be spiritually connected.
- It may be beneficial to reassess how we continue to communicate with the A.A. groups.
- Experience has confirmed that an abundance of wealth could have sunk us.
- Going to groups and encouraging participation through a G.S.R. has helped the groups to get connected and participate.
- Many A.A. groups are unaware of the general service structure and may not contribute due to lack of information.
- One person shared how, as a newcomer, she understood that the money in the basket is spiritually A.A. money, not just the group's.
- There may not be an absolute solution, but it will continue to be a fine balancing act.

Herbert Goodman, chairperson

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: The Group Services staff member oversees the production of service material, which provides information and shared experience not found in Conference-approved literature. When a need is indicated G.S.O. provides service material, such as: New Group Forms; A.A. Guidelines; a catalog of A.A. Literature and Audiovisual Material, as well as a catalog for Special Needs. A multiple-page list describes the service items. The staff member on the Group Services desk oversees the production of these information pieces and the Group Handbooks, G.S.R. and D.C.M. Kits. G.S.O. continues to work toward providing services in English, French and Spanish. Current ongoing projects:

- Involved with coordination of three A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S. and Canadian.
- Supervision of G.S.O. Service files. There is a variety of service material available, upon request, to A.A. members, groups, and for service workshops. It is available in Spanish and French whenever possible.
- Liaison with intergroup/central offices, including serving on the Policy and Site Committees of the 20th Intergroup Seminar, which will next take place in Charlotte, North Carolina, September 2005.
- Liaison with Special Needs Committees sharing available resources and experience from G.S.O.
- Liaison for G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

Currently all correspondence in Spanish from the U.S./Canada comes to the Group Services desk. There are approximately 1,880 Spanish-speaking groups in the U.S. and Canada. The Group Services staff member assists in providing services to the Spanish-speaking community. Over 90 Spanish-speaking linguistic districts have been formed in area service structures, and continue to grow. The groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter.

Julio Espallat

INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE/ WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' report: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

World Service Meeting — The 18th World Service Meeting was held October 24–28 in New York City, with the theme—“One Message—Many Languages—One Fellowship.” Forty-eight delegates representing 35 countries or zones participated. Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada, served as a first-term delegate, and Charlie Bartell, trustee-at-large/U.S., as second-term delegate representing the General Service Board. Charlie served as chairperson of the Working With Others Committee and Murray served on the Agenda Committee, on which he will serve at the next World Service Meeting as chairperson. Elaine McDowell, Ph.D., chaired the meeting; Greg Muth, was vice-chairperson. Staff member Adrienne Brown was the World Service Meeting coordinator. Other staff members who served as secretaries to WSM committees were Valerie O'Neill, Warren Stafford and Rick Walker. John Kirwin was the logistical coordinator in charge of the workroom and hotel facilities, and additional support from the office included Ayleen H. Martinez and Frank Segui.

In 2002 the 17th World Service Meeting recommended that the A.A.W.S. Board develop material on country-to-country sponsorship. A draft service piece on country-to-country sponsorship was forwarded to the 18th World Service Meeting Literature/Publishing Committee for their consideration. The 18th World Service Meeting Literature/Publishing Committee recommended that the service piece be:

- Titled *Country-to-Country Sponsorship—Carrying the A.A. Message Worldwide*.
- Printed by A.A. World Services, Inc.
- Made available for distribution to the Fellowship worldwide.

The final report of the 18th World Service Meeting is available upon request. The 19th World Service Meeting will be held October 15–19, 2006 in Dublin, Ireland, and the theme will be “Anonymous, But Not Invisible.”

Literature Assistance — The 2005 Literature Assistance budget of \$200,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund, representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service office, board, conference or structure. When necessary, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publications Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Since the last Conference, our basic text, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, has been translated into Latvian and Zulu; the Big Book is now in 52 languages. The Publications Department is planning to translate “A.A.'s Legacy of Service” into ten languages per year over the next five to six years. The most recent translations available are Simplified Chinese, Mongolian, German, Portuguese, Hindu, Italian, Polish, Japanese and Swahili. The Sinhalese pamphlets, “This is A.A.,” “Is A.A. for You?,” “44 Questions,” “A Newcomer Asks,” “A Brief Guide to A.A.,” “Information on A.A.,” and the Latvian “The A.A. Group,” “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship,” “Understanding Anonymity,” “Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?” and “If You are a Professional” have been printed. In addition, we approved the Faroese translation of the Big Book and the Simplified Chinese translation of *Daily Reflections*.

Zonal Service Meetings — Zonal service meetings are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet, and upon invitation, the General Service Board and General Service Office are represented as delegates or observers at these meetings.

- In 2005 the U.S./Canada will be represented by our trustees-at-large, serving as delegates to the Meeting of the Americas (REDELA), which will be held in the Dominican Republic.
- The European Service Meeting will be held in Germany and the Asia-Oceania Service Meeting in Australia. The Second Eastern European Service Meeting, hosted by the Ukraine and previously scheduled for March 2005, has been postponed.
- The committee recommended that the General Service Board U.S./Canada co-sponsor with the General Service Board of France, the First Central Africa Service Meeting, to be held in Cameroon in 2007.
- We received a request to continue co-sponsorship of the Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting and recommended that the General Service Board U.S./Canada continue co-sponsorship with the General Service Board Great Britain of the Second Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting. This meeting, hosted by the General Service Board of South Africa, will be held in Johannesburg, June 3 – 5, 2005.

International Trips — The General Service Board and General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary

celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits, regional assemblies, and other events. Trustees and staff members visited many countries, including Cameroon, China, Colombia, France, Ghana, Great Britain, Greece, Mongolia, Panama, Poland, Singapore and Togo.

We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards and offices in other countries, who carry our message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Murray McIntosh, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 58 international general service offices and literature distribution centers. The International desk is also responsible for communication with structures, groups and members outside the United States/Canada. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and it is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the International desk is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and the services of both our G.S.O. translators and outside professional services. In addition, G.S.O. staff who are fluent in other languages aid in telephone or in person communications. Where there is a nearby office, we provide the location, telephone number and e-mail or Web site address. We emphasize our faith in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries. The International staff member benefits by the experience of G.S.O. staff, great cooperation with the Publications Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary.

Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature (most touching are the unanticipated translations of the Big Book lovingly prepared by an A.A. member), and the beginnings of new general service or information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into about 52 languages, and additional translations are pending approval and/or funding.

Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Zonal Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. In addition, our office sends one or two observers to the Asia-Oceania, European, Eastern European and Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meetings. Our trustees-at-large (U.S. and Canada) are our delegates to the Meeting of the Americas (REDELA).

Adrienne Brown

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' report:

International Conventions — Since the last Conference, our committee has met three times. The focus of our work during the year revolved around the 2005 International Convention, Toronto, Canada, June 30 – July 3, 2005. The committee approved the 2005 International Convention Program, with the understanding that some last-minute additions or adjustments might be needed. The list of non-A.A. speakers for the Convention panels was reviewed and accepted, as well as the speakers for the Friday and Sunday Big Meetings. We agreed to invite special guests who are surviving links to our co-founders, together with a spouse/companion. The committee agreed to forward to the 2005 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums, for their consideration, the concept that an anonymity-protected delayed broadcast of the 2005 International Convention Friday Night Opening Flag Ceremony be made available electronically. We also recommended that saleable items at the Convention be determined by A.A.W.S. Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and agreed that a booth for La Vigne, the French language, Grapevine-styled magazine of the four General Service Quebec Areas, be provided at the 2005 International Convention. The committee reviewed the formats for the Big Meetings, and recommended they be as follows:

Friday Night — Following the opening Flag Ceremony, the new chair of the board will say a few words and introduce, as a group, the trustees of the General Service Board, who will be seated on the stage. Then he will acknowledge corporate board directors, past trustees and directors, present and past delegates, present and past G.S.O. and Grapevine staff, members of the Host Committee, Al-Anon members, and "all trusted servants gathered here tonight." The chair will then turn the meeting over to the Eastern Canada regional trustee, who will chair the A.A. meeting and introduce the three speakers: one from the U.S., one from Canada and one from another country.

Saturday Night — G.S.O.'s general manager will chair the Saturday Night Oldtimers meeting. There will be a sobriety "count-up" in five-year increments until 40—then in single year counts. The meeting participants will come from among the members with 40 or more years of sobriety who will be seated in the front rows. Names of the speakers who will share for a few minutes each, will be pulled "out of the hat." An "Applause" sign will be used at the end of the time limit to keep things moving along.

Sunday Morning — The chairperson of the General Service Board will open the meeting and introduce the Host Committee chair who, along with his two co-chairs, will say a few words. Presentation of the 25 millionth copy of the Big Book. The chairperson will then lead a brief commemoration of A.A. co-founder Bill W.'s turning over the running of the Fellowship in the U.S. and Canada to the General Service Conference, which occurred at "4:00 o'clock Sunday afternoon, July 3, 1955, in St. Louis, Missouri."

Regional Forums — Since the 2004 General Service Conference, the following regions have held Forums: Pacific, Eastern Canada, and Southeast. All were well attended by enthusiastic A.A. members interested in learning more about the general service structure of A.A. In addition, Special Forums were held in Goose Bay, Labrador and Rouyn-Noranda, Quebec, Canada. Many in attendance were experiencing their first A.A. service event as well as their first Forum. At the end of each Forum, many of those attending reported feeling "re-energized." Following is a list of the committee's activities relative to Regional/Special Forums since the 2004 General Service Conference:

- The committee reviewed and accepted the proposed 2005

Regional Forums budget and forwarded it to the trustee's Finance and Budgetary Committee.

- Reviewed and accepted the 2005 Regional Forums schedule as presented, which included three Regional Forums: Northeast, West Central and Southwest.
- Special Forums were reviewed and the committee recommended that a Forum be held in Coachella Valley, California (Area 9) in 2006, and one—in Mundelein, Illinois (Areas 19, 20 and 75), also in 2006. (In February 2005, at the request of the host committee, this Forum was moved from Mundelein, Illinois to Kenosha, Wisconsin.) In 2007, Special Forums were approved for Yellowknife, NW Territories (Area 78), and in Rimouski, Quebec (Area 88).
- There was discussion on adding mementos or other souvenir items for attendees at Regional/Special Forums, which later led to samples being reviewed; after discussion the committee took no action.
- We reviewed summaries of the questionnaires from the Western, Eastern Canada, Pacific, and Southeast Regional Forums, and from the Special Forum in Goose Bay, Labrador/Newfoundland. All were reviewed in consideration of each Forum's usefulness, current format and suggestions for improvements.
- In addressing a request for increased communication with our Hispanic members, our committee recommended to the General Service Board that a two-year experiment, beginning with the 2005 Northeast Regional Forum in Portland, Maine, allow the La Viña editor to attend, at least, the following Regional Forums: Southeast, Southwest, Pacific, Northeast and East Central at a current average cost of \$900.00 per Forum.
- We discussed the need for continuing to have credit card information on the hotel reservation forms that are mailed to the Fellowship and took no action.
- Due to the expressed need and increase in number of Special Forums during recent years, the committee discussed changing the name of the committee to include the term "Special" and took no action at this time.
- In line with this, the committee suggested that a subcommittee be formed in July 2005, to discuss the concept of restructuring and/or increasing Forums (Regional/Special). To help with this work, the committee recommended to the General Service Board that the concept of restructuring and/or increasing Forums (Regional/Special), be placed on the agenda of the 2005 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums for discussion.

The following Regional and Special Forums are scheduled prior to the 2006 General Service Conference:

2005		
May 20-22	Northeast	Portland, Maine
August 19-22	Special	Alaska
Sept. 30-Oct. 2	West Central	Great Falls, Montana
November 4-6	East Central	Houghton, Michigan
December 2-4	Southwest	Rogers, Arkansas

Phyllis Halliday, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention — The International Convention assignment entails coordinating the myriad details involved in producing the A.A. International Convention, held every five years. Working with four committees—Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host—the International Convention coordinator is responsible for bringing the Convention to life and to ensure that thousands of A.A.s can share and celebrate A.A.'s Anniversary. This time it's in Toronto, Canada, June 30 – July 3, 2005.

The 2005 Convention will be a wonderful event, with meetings, meetings, meetings, panels, workshops, marathons and stadium events. Events begin on Thursday evening with dances and a "Party in the Park" in Roundhouse Park across the street from the South Building of the Metro Toronto Convention Centre. Beginning at midnight on Thursday, marathon meetings will get underway in all three official languages of the General Service Conference U.S./Canada—one in English, one in Spanish and, for the first time, one in French—and these run continuously until Sunday morning. Opening Ceremonies will be held Friday night at the stadium, complete with the Parade of Flags, of those countries represented at the Convention, followed by the Big A.A. Meeting. On Saturday night, there will be an Oldtimers Stadium Meeting and on Sunday morning, the customary Closing Meeting at the Stadium.

Local Toronto A.A. Host Committee volunteers expect to number 3,000-5,000 and these people will welcome the many visitors to Toronto. For family members and loved ones that belong to Al-Anon or Alateen and will accompany us to Toronto, the Westin Harbour Castle hotel overlooking Lake Ontario will offer daytime Al-Anon/Alateen meetings, workshops, marathons and other events. We trust that all attendees will experience a milestone event, gratitude and the language of the heart in wonderful, exciting, friendly Toronto.

Doug Richardson

A.A. Regional Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staffs. Regional Forums are held at the invitation of a particular region every two years; there are four Forums annually. The work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The responsibility for direct contact with the hotel is assumed by a local A.A. host contact working with the Regional Forums coordinator and regional trustee. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates the details of the Forum. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "Early Bird" Newsletter at each Forum and a Final Report of the Forum to all who attend.

A region may request a Special Forum, which has fewer participants from the boards and staff over shorter time periods. Special Forums require the approval of the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums. They may be designed for remote, sparsely populated or urban areas. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the regional trustee and host contact tailoring each agenda to local needs.

Last December 3-5, 2004, the Southeast Regional Forum was held at the Executive West Airport Hotel in Louisville, KY. Two hundred and fifty-seven excited attendees got to mix and mingle with members of GSB, AAWS, and GV boards as well as members of the staff at G.S.O. and GV. Forum goers heard presentations describing how members of boards and G.S.O. and GV staff help when it comes to carrying A.A.'s message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Attendees also got to participate in workshops and Ask-It-Basket/General Sharing Sessions. Friday and Saturday evenings featured "Ice Cream Socials" and more mixing and mingling.

The staff member on A.A. Regional Forums also serves as

secretary of the trustees' Nominating Committee, Conference Committee on Trustees and, currently co-secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Warren Stafford

LITERATURE

Trustees' report: Following is a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 2004 General Service Conference.

- *Introduction to the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* — In response to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee Additional Committee Consideration, and as recommended by the 2003 Advisory Action, the committee reviewed a revised draft introduction prepared by the Publications Department to be added to the front matter of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and agreed to forward the revised draft introduction to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee for consideration.

- *"It Happened to Alice!"* — In response to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee Additional Committee Consideration that a new comic book format pamphlet be developed by the Publications Department to replace the pamphlet *"It Happened to Alice!"*, a subcommittee was formed to work in conjunction with the G.S.O. Publications Department to finalize a draft manuscript of the revised pamphlet. The trustees' Committee on Literature reviewed the proposed revised pamphlet of *"It Happened to Alice!"* and agreed to forward it to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee.

- *"The A.A. Group"* — The trustee's Literature Committee continued its comprehensive review of the *"The A.A. Group"* pamphlet per the 2003 Advisory Action and as reported in a Progress Report presented to the 2004 Conference Literature Committee. In January, the trustees' Literature Committee reviewed the revised draft manuscript and agreed to forward it to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee.

- *Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, Alcohólicos Anónimos* — The 2004 Advisory Action requested that a draft Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos* be developed by the trustees' Literature Committee, in keeping with the following outline on contents, process and story solicitation:

Contents: The Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book to be similar in page count to the English Fourth Edition Big Book and the first 164 pages of the Big Book, Dr. Bob's Nightmare, the Preface, the Forewords will undergo a complete review to assure accuracy of translation and consistency of style and tone throughout the text (as in translations of all languages, the Publications Department strives to reflect the best possible translation of Bill W.'s writings and does not require Conference-approval); retain selected stories from current Spanish-language Second Edition; select stories from A.A.'s *La Viña* magazine; select new stories from Spanish-speaking membership; stories to be organized in three main sections similar to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.

Story Solicitation: Within the United States and Canada and internationally to Spanish-speaking countries.

Story Selection Process: To be under the direction of the trustees' Literature subcommittee on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book; Story selection subcommittee to be all bilingual—Spanish and English, include Spanish editors, Spanish-speaking staff members, and the chair to appoint some subcommittee members from the Fellowship. The basic selection criteria: to use the same criteria as the English Fourth Edition Big Book based on Bill W.'s recommendations; each story must, as Bill W. recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution; each story must be a standard A.A. story that

tells what it was like, what happened, and what it is like today.

A memorandum soliciting Spanish stories with a deadline of September 1, 2005 was mailed to all Conference members, Spanish-language district committee members, Spanish Literature committee chairs, all central/intergroup offices listed in the U.S. and Canada, and Spanish-language country G.S.O.s. In addition, a memo requesting resumes from bilingual A.A. members for the story selection subcommittee was mailed to all Conference members, Spanish-language D.C.M.s, Spanish Literature committee chairs, all central/intergroup offices listed in the U.S. and Canada, and G.S.O.s in Spanish-language countries, with a deadline of November 1, 2004.

As of February 2005, four Spanish-language stories were received. Two bilingual A.A. members were selected to serve on the subcommittee, composed of Spanish-speaking staff members and Spanish editors, for the story selection for the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*. The trustees' Literature Committee forwarded a progress report to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee. The report was translated into Spanish by the Publications Department in an effort to communicate the progress of this project to the Spanish-speaking community.

- *"Too Young?"* — In response to the 2004 Advisory Action requesting that the Publications Department rewrite the pamphlet *"Too Young?"* with changes to layout and style, targeting the ages of 11-17, the Publications Department presented sample text and illustrations to the trustees' Literature Committee for review. A subcommittee was formed to work in conjunction with the Publications Department to finalize the draft manuscript of the revised pamphlet *"Too Young?"*. The committee forwarded the draft manuscript of the proposed revised pamphlet to the 2005 Conference Committee on Literature.

- *"Young People and A.A."* — Following its review of the 2004 Advisory Action that the Publications Department update and shorten existing stories, wherever appropriate, in the pamphlet and that the trustees' Literature Committee add new younger age stories, a subcommittee was formed to select stories for possible inclusion in the revised pamphlet. In addition, a memorandum requesting stories with a deadline date of January 1, 2005 was mailed to all Conference members.

The subcommittee reviewed the Publications Department revisions to shorten existing stories. Forty-three new stories were submitted and thoroughly reviewed by the subcommittee. Eight new stories were selected. The subcommittee prepared a Progress Report that the trustees' Literature Committee reviewed and forwarded to the 2005 Conference Committee on Literature.

- *"Questions and Answers on Sponsorship"* — As recommended by the 2004 Advisory Action that the trustees' Literature Committee broaden the section titled *"Service Sponsorship"* on page 28 in the pamphlet *"Questions and Answers on Sponsorship"* to reflect current shared experience, the Publications Department prepared and presented a draft to the trustees' Literature Committee. The committee forwarded the draft of the proposed revised section to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee for consideration.

Projects Completed:

- *Punctuation in "Dr. Bob's Nightmare"* — Following the 2004 Advisory Action, the punctuation in *"Dr. Bob's Nightmare"* in the Fourth Edition was restored as it appears in the Third Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

- *"Questions and Answers on Sponsorship"* — Following the 2004 Advisory Action, the text on page 11 under the heading *"May a newcomer have more than one sponsor?"* in the pamphlet *"Questions and Answers on Sponsorship"* was removed and replaced with the following text:

"Many feel it is best for a newcomer to have only one sponsor."

Choosing one sponsor helps to avoid the precarious practice of a newcomer going from sponsor to sponsor seeking the advice he or she wants to hear.

"However, some newcomers benefit from more than one sponsor. Here the newcomer shares in a wide range of experience and hears a great variety of ways to use the A.A. program. In addition, this is a means of averting the crisis mentioned in the preceding question—it is unlikely that two or more sponsors would be unavailable at the same time."

And, the sentence "Again, the answer is yes." be removed from the paragraph under the heading "May a newcomer change sponsors?"

Projects forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee for consideration:

- Revised draft introduction developed by the Publications Department to be added to the front matter of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*.
- Revised draft comic book format pamphlet "It Happened to Alice!"
- Draft manuscript of revised pamphlet "The A.A. Group."
- Progress report on the development of the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*.
- Revised draft text for the section titled "Service Sponsorship" on page 28 in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship."
- Revised draft pamphlet "Too Young?"
- Progress report on pamphlet "Young People and A.A."
- Revised text for the section titled "The A.A. Grapevine" in the pamphlet "Your A.A. General Service Office."

The committee extended their gratitude to Chris Cavanaugh, G.S.O.'s publications director, and his staff for their professional expertise, which is invaluable in completing the work of this committee.

Michael Perry, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, the literature coordinator works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publications Department, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all existing recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department. This year there was close collaboration and cooperation with the Publications Department on preparation of suggestions for the revision of "Young People and A.A.," and "The A.A. Group" pamphlets and comic book pamphlets "It Happened to Alice!" and "Too Young?"; a revised draft introduction to be added to the front matter of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*; and updating text in the "Your A.A. General Service Office" and "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" pamphlets.

This was a year of extensive subcommittee activity, meetings, conference calls, deadlines and detailed reports. The literature coordinator served as secretary to "The A.A. Group," "Too Young?," "It Happened to Alice!," and "Young People and A.A." subcommittees. Progress continued on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*. The literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate all Literature assignment committee and subcommittee responsibilities.

The literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups asking many literature-related questions: How can I order literature? Who does translations? Who can help me with my literature order problems? Where can I send my suggestion for a new literature format? and Who can give me

specific text and/or historical information from our literature? Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, our Customer Service representatives, our Publications staff and our Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 66 area literature chairpersons, 346 district literature chairpersons and 213 literature persons serving intergroups and individual A.A. groups.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French and Spanish with the following bimonthly distribution: 65,000 copies in English, 3,500 copies in French and 7,000 copies in Spanish. The staff member works closely with the Publications Department editor and the G.S.O. editorial committee to continue to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. in *Box 4-5-9*. The editorial committee welcomes ideas, suggestions and sharing on service from the Fellowship so that *Box 4-5-9* can be an accurate reflection of both Fellowship and G.S.O. activities.

As literature is essential in helping to carry our message of recovery, this remains a challenging and rewarding assignment.

Mary Dargan

LONERS/INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS (LIM)

Staff report: The Loners/Internationalists Correspondence Service is a valuable method of sharing for about 223 Loners in 58 countries, plus 76 Internationalists, and 198 Homers. Loners are members who are unable to attend A.A. meetings because there are no A.A. groups within a reasonable distance. Internationalists are members working or serving on a seagoing vessel for lengthy periods, and Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to illness or physical incapacity. Each is a valuable part of a service coordinated by the General Service Office that enables the member to stay sober by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters, tapes and/or e-mail, in addition to reading A.A. literature.

The correspondence service also includes 483 Loner Sponsors, who are not "Sponsors" or "Loners" in the traditional sense. Instead, these members share their A.A. group experience and activities with Loners, Homers and Internationalists through correspondence. We also list 57 Port Contacts who are valuable resources when Internationalists are briefly onshore. These members also share experience and hope via correspondence.

Complimentary literature is sent to each new member, including the *Loners, Internationalists, & Homers Directory* and a subscription to *Box 4-5-9*. Each LIM member receives the *Loners/Internationalist Meeting-by-Mail (LIM)*, a bimonthly publication comprised of excerpts of letters from LIM members to the General Service Office. As with any directory or list distributed by G.S.O., LIM is confidential to insure the anonymity of LIM members.

In 2004, correspondence from around the world demonstrated that the A.A. program continued to be the basis of sobriety and our way of life. A single issue of LIM may include sharing from Australia, Belgium, Germany, England, India, Ireland, New Zealand, Peoples Republic of China, Slovenia, Taiwan, one or more countries in Africa, as well as Canada and the U.S. The letters are inspiring in their simplicity and straightforward sharing.

It is a joy to be on the LIM assignment, to benefit by the sharing of members who encounter and walk through difficult circumstances each day. The courage of these Loners, Homers and Internationalists is an inspiration that I hope to pass on.

Irene Kontje

NOMINATING

Trustees' report: Since the 2004 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Nominating has met three times. At each meeting, the committee's work was guided by the principles of love, responsibility, and mutual respect. Listed below are the actions taken by the committee during that period:

- The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedures and made no changes.
- The committee reached a consensus that the tradition of having a Class A trustee serve as General Service Board chairperson should continue when considering the new chair to take office following the 2005 General Service Conference.
- The committee unanimously recommended to the General Service Board that Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D., be elected to serve as chairperson of the General Service Board at the April 2005 annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous.
- The committee unanimously recommended to the General Service Board that Jeanne S. Woodford be invited to serve as a Class A trustee, filling the slot to be vacated by Elaine McDowell following the 2005 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed a suggested topic from an area for consideration during the 2005 General Service Conference, as follows:

"That the qualifications for regional trustee and nontrustee director be updated to include the following: That an appointed committee member not be eligible as a regional trustee or nontrustee director candidate until one year after his or her last service as an appointed committee member."

Following a report by a subcommittee appointed to review this topic, the committee forwarded the topic to the 2005 Conference Committee on Trustees for review.

- The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the section below, in bold face, be added to existing language of the Bylaws of the General Service Board:

"In the event that any member trustee shall resign or shall die, the trustees may at any regular or special meeting elect a new member trustee to fill such vacancy, or alternatively, permit such a vacancy to continue until the next annual meeting of the General Service Board. In the event that the vacancy is that of a Class B member trustee, the successor shall be elected for a period of four years from the date of the meeting at which he or she is elected. **In the case of a Class B regional trustee, the position may be filled at the next annual meeting of the General Service Board by election in accordance with the election procedures for such regional trustee, or, may be left vacant for the balance of the unfilled term with regional coverage being provided by the trustees-at-large or by regional trustees in adjacent regions. If a region chooses to elect a new Class B regional trustee in the event of the resignation or death of the current regional trustee prior to the end of that trustee's term, the region should be informed that such an election would impact the current rotation schedule for Class B regional trustees as well as the rotation schedule for**

Class B regional trustees serving on the A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards."

The committee agreed to forward the above recommendation to the 2005 Conference Committee on Trustees for consideration.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the section below, in bold face, be added to existing language in *The A.A. Service Manual*. This section would appear between the schedule of elections and Election Procedure, as follows:

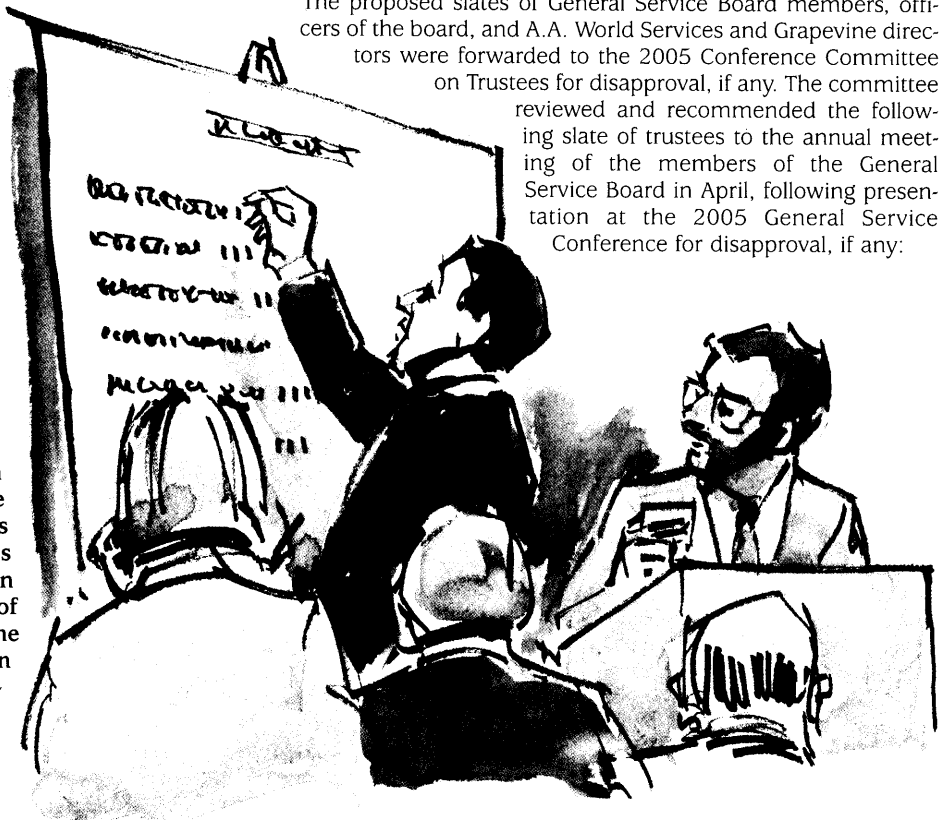
"In the event of the resignation or death of a trustee, at any point during their four-year term, the position may either be filled by election at the next General Service Conference, or left vacant for the remainder of the uncompleted term. If filled, the new-elected trustee shall serve a period of four years from the date of election. If left vacant, regional coverage shall be provided by the trustees-at-large or by regional trustees in nearby regions. Note: Should a new trustee be elected, their new four-year term would result in a change in rotation that would affect the A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards as well as their regional rotation."

The committee agreed to forward the above item to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, after review by the 2005 Conference Committee on Trustees of the committee's proposed changes to the Bylaws of the General Service Board.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board the following nominations: A.A. World Services Corporate Board — Charles Barta, West Central regional trustee, replacing Robert Pelot; Paul Cleary, as a general service trustee, replacing John Koster; and George Martin and Jane Tolar, as directors, replacing Paul Cleary and Jane Sheppard.

A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board — Tom Kraemer, Western Canada regional trustee, replacing Phyllis Halliday; Raymond Massey, as a general service trustee, replacing David Every; Herbert Goodman, Class A trustee, replacing Leonard Blumenthal; and James Branscome, as a director, replacing Raymond Massey.

The proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, and A.A. World Services and Grapevine directors were forwarded to the 2005 Conference Committee on Trustees for disapproval, if any. The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees to the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 2005 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:



Trustees of the General Service Board:

Class A

Allen L. Ault, Ed.D.	Herbert I. Goodman
Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D.	Vincent E. Keefe
William D. Clark, M.D.	Jeanne S. Woodford
Ward B. Ewing, D.D.	

Class B

Charles J. Barta	Murray McIntosh
Paul E. Cleary	Raymond Massey
Ronald J. Gauthier	Robert Mayer
Phyllis A. Halliday	Robert Pelot
Gary Kluksdahl	Michael D. Perry
Tom Kraemer	Arnold L. Ross
Howard Lowery	Dorothy Wilson

Officers of General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D.
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	Allen L. Ault, Ed.D.
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	Herbert I. Goodman
<i>Treasurer</i>	Vincent E. Keefe
<i>Secretary</i>	Ronald J. Gauthier
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald W. Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Valerie O'Neill*

Directors of A.A. World Services Corporate Board:

Charles J. Barta	Don Miller
Paul E. Cleary	Greg Muth
Ronald J. Gauthier	Valerie O'Neill*
Gary Kluksdahl	Jane Tolar
George G. Martin	

*To be replaced at G.S.O. staff rotation in September 2005

Directors of A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board:

James Branscome	Raymond Massey
Robin Bromley	Michael D. Perry
Herbert I. Goodman	Arnold L. Ross
Dorothy L. Hurley	John Skilton
Tom Kraemer	

John C. Koster, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with the responsibility of helping the membership to carry the message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We do this by recommending and coordinating activities which include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements (P.S.A.s); producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; coordinating health fairs and other community and school exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey; and carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. The committee met three times since the last Conference. Projects over the past year have included:

Television and Radio P.S.A.s — Following the decision of the 2004 General Service Conference to redistribute existing television P.S.A.s to new target English-language stations in the United States and Canadian English-language stations where P.S.A. play can now be tracked, the committee determined to rerelease one

P.S.A. rather than two or more to avoid introducing extra variables into the tracking data. The redistribution of the P.S.A. "We Know What It's Like" to 664 cable networks and television stations in the U.S. and 40 specialty networks and stations in Canada resulted in much lower total stations and airplay than the original release for a variety of reasons, but the stations that did play the P.S.A. in this release will be added to the list of stations that played it in the past to create a broader base of participating stations. The committee continues to emphasize centralized distribution as an adjunct to the important efforts of local P.I. committees, and local committees are encouraged to follow through on contacts with stations in their area.

In response to a request from the 2004 Conference Public Information Committee, the trustees made adjustments to the proposed television P.S.A., "Living in Chaos," and invited comments from the Conference Committee members. While the trustees remained unanimously in favor of the revised P.S.A., they recognized that information in some of the responses received significantly reduced the chances that the P.S.A. would be forwarded to the Conference. The trustees' committee asked that the first segment be deleted and the remaining two sequences be edited to create a P.S.A. in 30 second, 20 second, 15 second, and 10 second versions and the edited and repackaged P.S.A. was forwarded to the Conference Public Information Committee for consideration.

The committee agreed with the 2004 Conference Public Information Committee that the phrase "and taking pills" should be removed from the radio P.S.A. "Teenager," and forwarded the recommendation to the 2005 Conference Public Information Committee with costs for making the edit and replacing current inventory.

Communications with the Media — The committee reviewed and accepted the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media, mailed in February 2005, which will continue to feature the graphic chosen last year and a return mailing address specifying that it comes from Alcoholics Anonymous.

The committee reviewed and agreed to distribute a press release on the 18th World Service Meeting.

Membership Survey — The committee reviewed the draft of the "Alcoholics Anonymous 2004 Membership Survey," and forwarded it to the 2005 Conference Public Information Committee.

Young People's Videos — The committee forwarded to the 2005 Conference Public Information Committee a report on feasibility, costs and timelines for updating/replacing the videos "A.A.—Rap With Us" and "Young People and A.A."

Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — The committee reviewed quarterly reports from The A.A.W.S. Board regarding changes to the Web site, updates on Web site activity, and a summary of requests or correspondence from the Fellowship regarding the Web site and a summary of actions taken by the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests or correspondence. An annual report by the A.A.W.S. Board on the above areas, along with any additional comments from the trustees' Committee on Public Information, was forwarded to the 2005 Conference Public Information Committee.

The committee remains committed to do all they can to assist the membership in their service of carrying the message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers, and welcome suggestions from delegate areas as to what more can be done.

Robert Pelot, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment is charged with assisting the A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public—schools, health fairs, libraries, and all forms of the media. Below are some of the ways that this task is carried out:

- Communicate with over 700 P.I. committee chairpersons at the area, district and intergroup/central office and group level to provide them with Workbooks, Guidelines, and current shared information on Public Information activity.
- Provide literature to supplement the efforts of local Public Information committees that are serving as a resource about Alcoholics Anonymous at local health and community fairs.
- Provide P.I. committees with information regarding the production and distribution of television Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s), and radio P.S.A.s, in order to enhance their efforts on the local level, and refer all media requests for P.S.A.s to local committees.
- Respond to all inquiries that come to the office from the media, providing them with accurate information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- Read and process a number of newspaper, magazine and internet feature stories that mention Alcoholics Anonymous, and receive information from members regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio and film.
- Pass along instances of anonymity breaks in the media to the delegate in the area in which the break occurred, and provide them with an opportunity to contact the member and share experience regarding our Eleventh Tradition.
- Send out the Annual Anonymity Letter to the media. In February 2005 it was mailed to around 10,000 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services.
- Coordinate the triennial A.A. Membership Survey. In 2004 the Survey was sent to over 700 groups in the United States and Canada, with instructions to delegates and to group representatives regarding timelines and instructions for responding. The results of triennial surveys are then published in pamphlet form and as a large format table display for visual information about Alcoholics Anonymous at public events.

The success of any Public Information work at G.S.O. is measured the same way as any other A.A. service: Are we doing all that we can to see that the A.A. message of recovery reaches the still-suffering alcoholic by informing the general public about the A.A. program?

Gayle Solheim Riese

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Eleven A.A. members comprise the "G.S.O. Staff" with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. In 2004, the staff received 31,168 such requests by mail, e-mail and fax, plus many phone calls daily. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects or away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. All mail, e-mail, faxes, etc. are responded to within ten business days.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums, and other large A.A. events, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. To further assure that the work flow is smooth and adequately covered, assignments are divided into two units. Unit A consists of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, International Convention, Literature, Public Information and Treatment Facilities. Unit B includes Conference, Regional Forums, Group Services, International, and staff coordinator.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experience of A.A. groups

gathered over many years. These resources are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Requests for guidance received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, so that all responses reflect either research from A.A. literature or service material or the collective experience of G.S.O. staff and archives. Our weekly staff meetings provide a forum for sharing ideas on how to improve services to A.A. groups and members or how to provide the most complete answers to Fellowship inquiries. The staff coordinator chairs these weekly meetings and prepares a report on this weekly sharing session which is distributed to heads of various G.S.O. departments for their information.

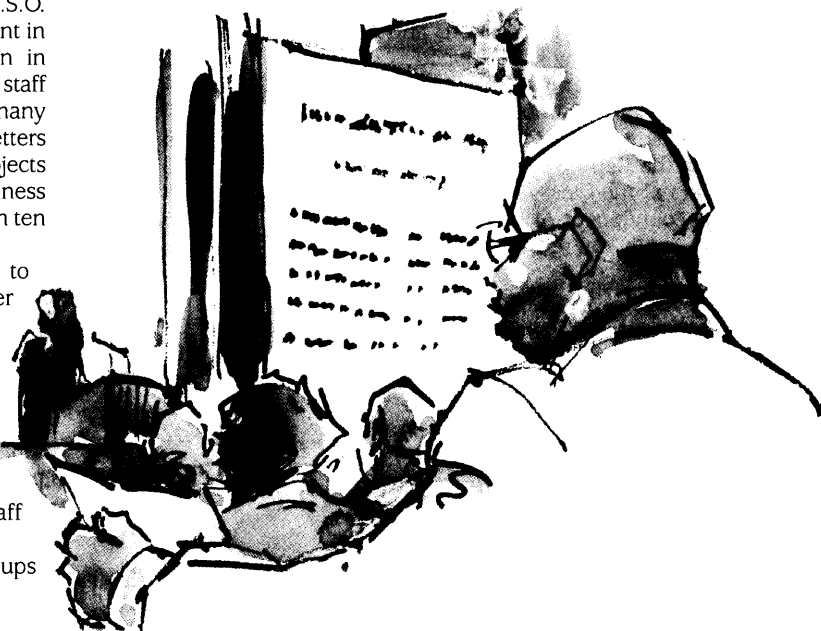
In August 2004, Mary Dargan joined our staff and immediately became immersed in four ongoing Literature projects to be reported to the 2005 General Service Conference. Criteria for applicants who want to be considered for an opening in the G.S.O. staff are: a minimum of six years sobriety, professional background, excellent verbal and writing communication skills and A.A. service experience. The staff coordinator is involved with training new staff members.

G.S.O. staff members serve as secretaries to trustees' and Conference Committees and also are voting members of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

In 2004, G.S.O. welcomed a total of 1,400 individual and 16 English and Spanish-speaking groups ranging in size from 10 to 50. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" during a tour of both G.S.O. and the Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the "open" A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays. This is an opportunity for the G.S.O. staff to welcome A.A. members from all over the world or from around the corner.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, preparing the minutes of board meetings and gathering information on board activities that appears in the *Quarterly Report*. The staff coordinator has the privilege of serving as a director on A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the dedication and skill of a very capable support staff.

Valerie O'Neill



Literature Distributed — 2004

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	595,842
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover-)	451,845
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print-)	35,726
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	118,112
Daily Reflections	167,970
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	183,938
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	11,988
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	169,602
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	19,350
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	57,327
A.A. Comes of Age	12,180
As Bill Sees It	41,811
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	28,803
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	12,535
"Pass It On"	11,798
Experience, Strength & Hope	22,913
Total	1,941,740

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/	
Twelve Concepts for World Service	31,782
Living Sober	160,340
Came to Believe	68,760
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	22,095
Total	282,977

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	10,993
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	23,726
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	36,248
A.A. for the Native North American	14,913
A.A. for the Woman	107,094
The A.A. Group	85,827
A.A. in Your Community	48,879
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	22,214
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	24,974
The A.A. Membership Survey	35,528
The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs	105,676
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	33,635
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	11,508
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	117,902
Circles of Love and Service	45,048
Bridging the Gap	25,689
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	18,362
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	15,680
Do You Think You're Different?	116,488
44 Questions	235,527
G.S.R.	43,229
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	21,809
How A.A. Members Cooperate	15,596
How It Works	60,859
If You Are a Professional	34,471
Inside A.A.	42,828
Can A.A. Help Me Too?	35,124
Is A.A. for You?	363,350
Is A.A. for Me?	95,931
Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	14,672
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	79,871

It Happened to Alice	51,016
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	45,961
The Jack Alexander Article	23,896
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	14,009
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	69,881
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	49,593
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	30,926
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	11,487
A Newcomer Asks	307,740
Problems Other Than Alcohol	120,721
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	277,093
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	18,061
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	31,493
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	77,261
Twelve Tradition Flyer	5,875
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	53,669
This Is A.A.	267,955
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	17,354
AA for the Older Alcoholic (Lrg Print)	56,050
Too Young?	79,986
Understanding Anonymity	65,300
What Happened to Joe	55,305
Young People and A.A.	115,402
Total	3,789,685

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	317,942
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	52,852
Wallet cards-Anonymity	34,316
Anonymity Display Card	2,377
Parchment-scrolls	2,740
Placards	462
C.P.C. Workbook	1,827
Archives Workbook	962
Correctional Facilities Workbook	980
P.I. Workbook	1,661
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,473
Treatment Facility Kit	500
Big Book on computer disk	192
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk	146
A.A. Guidelines	82,502
Group Handbook	2,109
Wire Racks	2,061
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	1,294
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	3,109
Alcoholics Anonymous (4 th Ed cassette album)	220
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	169
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	1,627
TV Public Service Announcement	179
Radio Public Service Announcements	155
Twelve Steps Shade displays	1,962
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,859
Fact File	2,215
Table Top Display 12 & 12	670
Pioneers of AA (Cassette Album)	74
Living Sober (Cassette Album)	168
Total	518,803
Grand Total	6,533,205

SPANISH

Libros y Librillos (Book & Booklets)

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	26,118
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	10,109
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	7,809
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	5,615
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	3,429
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	3,106
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	3,763
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	12,378
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	13,648
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	4,279
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	25,366
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	6,585
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	5,639
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	6,256
Total	134,100

Folleto (Pamphlets)

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	6,608
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	32,619
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	29,721
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	68,991
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	5,942
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	7,499
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	5,656
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	2,787
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	2,454
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	5,560
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	12,189
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	8,463
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	10,225
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	3,591
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	9,808
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	12,379
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	5,472
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	5,962
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	2,346
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	11,690
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)	3,469
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	12,674
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	3,100

Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	5,965
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	6,310
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	1,828
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	3,914
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,749
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	2,154
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	3,729
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	7,949
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	8,692
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	1,883
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	10,314
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,100
¿Hay un alcohólico en el lugar de trabajo? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	2,281
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	16,079
A.A. para el alcohólico de edad avanzada (A.A. for the older alcoholic)	5,970
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	7,337
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	3,879
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	2,419
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	3,929
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	2,646
Total	370,332

Diversos (Miscellaneous)

Guías (Guidelines)	3,625
Parchments, Spanish	330
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	6,988
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	823
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	960
Total	12,726
Grand Total	517,158

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliqes Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)	6,618
Les Alcooliqes Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format souple)	1,637
Les Alcooliqes Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)	961
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format relie)	1,508
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format souple)	1,548
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions	

(Twelve & Twelve - format poche)	1,318
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	605
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	2,240
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	4,832
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	688
Total	21,955

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,784
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	3,255
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,384
Total	6,423

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	11,770
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	3,760
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	14,829
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	2,209
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	603
Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans Votre Milieu de travail? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	896
Le membre des A.A. face aux medicaments et a la drogue (The A.A. Member - Medications & Other Drugs)	2,152
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	691
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	442
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	2,561
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	1,205
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	757
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	229
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	1,711
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	462
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	472
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	1,199
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,561
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	738
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,888
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	326
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	1,036
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	1,793
Les membres du clerge se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	718
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	718
Message a l'intention d'un detenu (Memo to an Inmate)	1,164
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	138
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	2,882

Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,113
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	1,270
Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	1,613
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,498
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,444
Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	703
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,195
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	950
L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	397
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	1,498
Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	1,262
Lettre a une femme alcoolique (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	2,012
Sondage sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	951
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	1,726
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	1,584
AA pour l'alcoolique plus age (AA for the older alcoholic)	1,693
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	6,408
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	2,667
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	801
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,788
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	440
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	216
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	3,091
Total	96,230

Divers (Miscellaneous)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	63
Le Gros Livre (cassettes album)	63
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	2,409
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	446
Video Cassettes	65
Notre Methode (How It Works)	10,121
Manuel de Groupe	35
Pochette de l'Information Publique	44
Pochette des Centres de Detention	16
Pochette de la CMP	7
Prière de la Sérénité (12x16) (Parchment Serenity Prayer)	51
Pochette des Centres de Traitement	7
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	103
Total	13,430
Grand Total	138,038



Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: One of the operating arms of the General Service Board, the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., publishes and distributes the A.A. Grapevine magazine, the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, and collections of Grapevine articles in books, CDs, and other formats and Spanish- and French-language editions of Grapevine books, signs, and recordings. The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., as a service to the General Service Board and the Fellowship, also publishes La Viña, the Spanish-language journal of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board has met seven times since the 54th General Service Conference. Three meetings were quarterly board meetings held during General Service Board week-ends, at which the board reviewed the corporation's finances and operations and reported its findings to the General Service Board. The other four were planning committee meetings, at which the directors discussed broad policy matters and developed plans for the corporation's future. Its fourth quarterly board meeting will be held this week at the General Service Conference.

Board Structure—There are nine Grapevine corporate directors: five trustees, including two general service trustees, two regional trustees, and one Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; three nontrustee directors; and the executive editor. This year, the board forwarded the name of Northeast regional trustee Mike Perry, a general service trustee, to succeed me as chair of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate board following the 2005 General Service Conference. The board forwarded the name of nontrustee director Ray Massey to fill the position of general service trustee left vacant when, after eight years of service, I rotate from the board in April. Western Canada regional trustee Tom Kraemer will fill the vacancy left when Pacific regional trustee Phyllis Halliday rotates in April. James Branscome was elected nontrustee director to fill the position formerly held by Ray Massey. Class A trustee Herbert Goodman was asked to fill the post that will be left open when Class A trustee Leonard Blumenthal takes on the responsibilities of chairperson of the General Service Board.

This year, as chair of the A.A. Grapevine Board, I appointed seven committees to support the board's oversight of the corporation. The nominating committee, chaired by Leonard Blumenthal, facilitated the selection of a new nontrustee director and the nomination of the board's incoming regional trustee. Chaired by Ray Massey, the finance and budget committee worked with the controller and executive editor to draft the corporation's 2005 budget and led the board's planning committee in a discussion of self-support. The subcommittee on La Viña, chaired by nontrustee director Dorothy Hurley, reviewed La Viña's relationship to the Grapevine and discussed its long-term goals. The risk management subcommittee, chaired by general service trustee Arnold Ross, took inventory of the corporation's copyright holdings and evaluated risks posed to its assets. Chaired by nontrustee director John Skilton, the Internet development committee reviewed the Web site's mission and considered its potential for carrying the A.A. message beyond the magazine's current readership. The committee on the International Conventions/Regional Forums, chaired by Mike Perry, discussed Grapevine's contributions to these events, while the committee

on board development reviewed the roles of the corporation's directors and proposed an annual assessment of the directors' manual and the board's performance.

The Grapevine Office—As the chief executive of the Grapevine, the executive editor defines the operational goals of the corporation and oversees its administration. Operations are divided among five departments: editorial, finance, customer service, Internet operations, and La Viña. The editorial staff, consisting of an acting managing editor, freelance art director, associate editor, and editorial assistant, is responsible for the content, design, and production of the Grapevine magazine and all other Grapevine publications. The finance department, supervised by a controller, is responsible for payroll, accounts payable and receivable, and financial reports, and assists in the preparation of the annual budget. The controller also oversees in-house shipping and the services performed by the fulfillment house. Customer service has been handled by a staff of four, two of whom are bilingual. To improve customer service and make ordering easier, some of this

work now will be done by the fulfillment house that receives and fulfills our orders. The in-house customer service staff will be reduced to two as of April 29.

Customer service reps currently report to the office manager, as does the GvR/RLV coordinator. The director of Internet operations manages the Grapevine's Digital Archive, Web site, and online catalog, while the publication and circulation of La Viña are managed by the editor of La Viña, with the assistance of a part-time art director, copy editor, and office assistant.

Circulation of both magazines is directed by the executive editor.

Financial Report—For the twelve months ended December 31, 2004, though we came in behind budget by \$44,159, the Grapevine Corporation still realized a net income of \$60,945, the second year in a row in the black.

Average monthly circulation for 2004 was 108,203. This is 4,464 lower than budgeted and 4,411 lower than 2003. Total magazine income for 2004 was \$1,895,960. This was \$44,778 lower than budgeted and \$36,714 lower than 2003 actual results. Direct costs of the Grapevine magazine for 2004 were \$721,841, which was higher than budgeted by \$17,313. Actual gross profit on the magazine for 2004 was \$1,174,119, below budget by \$62,091; 2003 gross profit on the magazine was \$1,156,152. Actual gross profit on the magazine for 2004 was ahead of the 2003 gross profit results by \$17,967.

Other publishing income of \$567,269 was \$191,730 lower than budgeted and \$37,063 lower than last year. The poster budgeted for 2004 was not produced and the publication of the I Am Responsible book was rescheduled for 2005. Cost of goods and delivery were \$163,140. This was under the budget by \$85,999. Gross profit on related items was \$404,129—\$105,731 lower than budgeted and \$14,386 lower than last year. Total gross profit was \$1,578,248, which was \$167,822 lower than budgeted and \$3,586 greater than last year. Editorial costs of \$441,491 were lower than budgeted by \$88,482 due to changes in personnel since the budget was prepared and an increase in web-relat-



ed expenses. Circulation and business expenses were \$929,967, which was less than the budget by \$32,463.

General and administrative expenses were \$198,955 or \$1,658 lower than the budget. This is due to professional fees of about \$12,000 that had been budgeted for legal/copyright matters and which were not incurred and \$8,000 for computer hardware that was not spent.

Total Grapevine expenses were \$1,570,413 or \$122,603 lower than the budget of \$1,693,016. Combined with cash flow and interest from the Reserve Fund of \$53,110, total income was \$1,631,358.

Editorial Overview—Marking its 60th anniversary, in June 2004, the Grapevine made all the stories, jokes, and letters published in the magazine over the last 60 years available in a Digital Archive on the Grapevine Web site at www.aagrapevine.org. Covering A.A. events as they happened, these articles trace the evolution of the Traditions, provide essential research for other key historic events, and contain sharing on almost every aspect of A.A., from humor to anonymity. The Digital Archive is still a pretty well-kept secret, however, and we need to work on getting the word out.

The Grapevine also published a special Victor E. poster, in English, Spanish, and French, to mark the event, while the magazine celebrated with a special anniversary issue featuring 16 additional pages of stories from each decade the magazine has been in print. Subsequent issues focused on carrying the message to alcoholics in the hearing-impaired, senior, and remote communities. The magazine also reported on G.S.O. and other A.A. work abroad, while continuing to provide stories from the Fellowship on the principles of A.A., the home group, newcomers, and sponsorship.

In the last quarter, the Grapevine published a Spanish-language edition of the updated *Best of Bill*, a collection of six Grapevine essays by A.A.'s co-founder Bill W., and *A Guide to the Grapevine: A Workbook for Grapevine and La Viña Representatives*. This spring, an updated edition of *The Home Group: Heartbeat of AA* will be available, and a new collection of Grapevine stories, looking at different aspects of the Responsibility Declaration, will be released at the International Convention in June.

Operations—In January 2005, the Grapevine office took responsibility for distributing the French-language editions of Grapevine publications, shipping most items from the warehouse in Canada that has handled both Grapevine and A.A.W.S. publications for many years. It also extended its contract with its current fulfillment house.

La Viña—This year, La Viña provided the Fellowship with six issues that focused on a variety of important topics, including the Traditions, carrying the message to the deaf alcoholic, and Peru's 50th anniversary. This past summer, La Viña published its first CD, *Historias de La Viña*, making stories written for La Viña available in audio format for those who travel and have trouble getting the magazine, as well as for those who have difficulty reading or who prefer recorded media to print. A second CD, *Historias de La Viña*, a collection of La Viña stories about Steps One through Six, was published this month. Now in its ninth year of publication, La Viña is beginning to make plans to celebrate its tenth anniversary with a special June 2006 issue—one day at a time, of course.

Financial results for La Viña show a net loss of \$108,051 for 2004, compared to a budgeted loss of \$118,695, which is \$10,644 better than expected. Average monthly circulation for 2004 was 9,316. This was 184 copies lower than budgeted, resulting in total magazine income of \$75,434. This is \$7,586 behind the budget of \$83,020. Gross profit for the

magazine was \$8,905 or \$4,513 lower than the budget of \$13,418. Sales of the La Viña CD were \$17,418 and costs were \$3,542. Gross profit from CD sales was \$13,876. There was no budget for this since it is a new item. Total Gross Profit for La Viña and the CD was \$22,781. Editorial costs were \$3,100 under budget. Circulation and business expenses were over budget by \$1,876. General and administrative expenses were \$57 under budget.

David Every, chairperson

Staff report: Making its 60th year of publication, the Grapevine has redoubled its efforts to fulfill its mission "to carry the A.A. message to as many people as possible, both inside and outside the Fellowship, through publication of its magazines and related items."

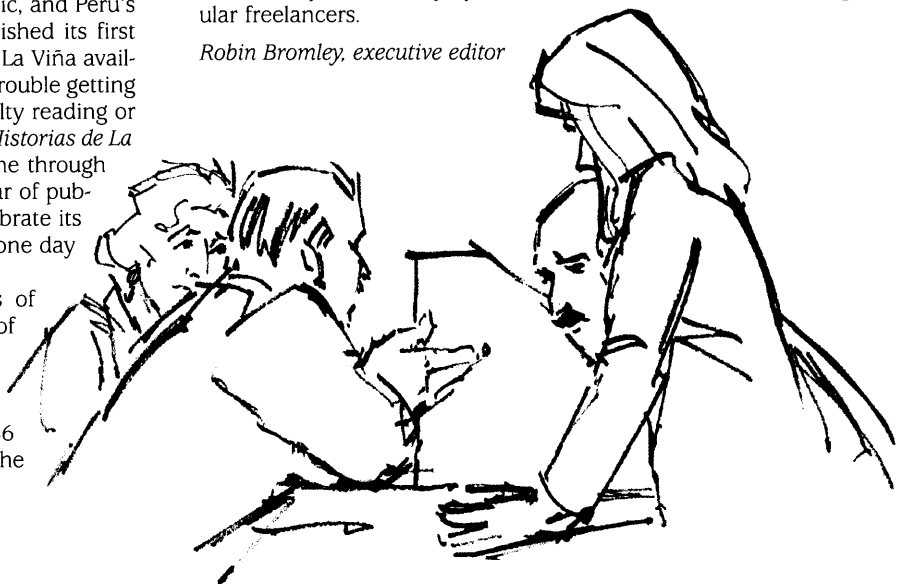
Special sections of the Grapevine this year have focused on carrying the A.A. message to deaf alcoholics, seniors, newcomers, and A.A.s in correctional facilities and in the military. Others have featured stories on sponsorship, home groups, and families with several generations in A.A. A special anniversary issue was published in June, a staple-free edition of the magazine for prisons came out in July, and a Victor E. anniversary poster was released in August. June also saw the launch of the Grapevine's Digital Archive, which makes all Grapevine articles, letters, and cartoons published from 1944 to 2004 available on the Web site by subscription or a \$2.00 monthly fee. Early this spring, the Web site was redesigned to make it a more effective tool of recovery and better integrated with the Digital Archive. A Spanish-language edition of *The Best of Bill* was released in December, and an updated edition of *The Home Group* is slated for publication this spring.

La Viña has expanded its service to the Fellowship as well. This year circulation reached a monthly average of 9,500, and the first two CDs with recorded stories from La Viña were made available to the Spanish-speaking Fellowship. The Spanish-language portion of the Web site has also been expanded.

Improving customer service and other fulfillment service continue to the top priorities. To speed delivery, magazines are going into production sooner, new subscribers' issues are being mailed earlier, and postal services have been upgraded. The staff continues to look for ways to support the magazine representatives in each group (GvRs and RLVs), with better communication and the publication of *A Guide to the Grapevine*, a revised workbook. To consolidate its publications, in January the Grapevine began distributing Grapevine publications that have been translated into French.

The corporation employs fourteen full-time staff and four regular freelancers.

Robin Bromley, executive editor



AA Grapevine Literature Distributed — 2004

ENGLISH

Book Units

Best of Bill (hardcover)	6,301
Best of Bill (softcover)	10,487
Best of the Grapevine I (softcover)	2,072
Best of the Grapevine II (softcover)	1,499
Best of the Grapevine III (softcover)	1,515
The Language of the Heart (hardcover)	7,232
The Language of the Heart (softcover)	2,814
The Language of the Heart/Big Book Set	216
The Home Group	3,980
A.A. Around The World	1,577
Thank You for Sharing	5,485
Spiritual Awakening	11,326
Total:	54,504

Cassette Tapes

Attitudes	308
Character Defects	299
Classic Tapes #1	210
Classic Tapes #2	207
Classic Tapes #3	137
Maintaining Spirituality	446
Pathways to Spirituality	445
Not for Newcomers Only, Vol. 1	156
Not for Newcomers Only, Vol. 2	136
Our Experience Has Taught Us	142
Practice These Principles	268
Back to Basics, Vol. 1	180
Back to Basics, Vol. 2	132
Sponsorship, Vol. 1	229
Sponsorship, Vol. 2	205
History Lights the Way	136
What We Were Like	204
Youth Enjoying Sobriety	105
Old-Timers Corner	180
Total:	4,125

CDs

Pathways to Spirituality	1,098
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 1	671
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 2	516
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 3	488
Not for Newcomers Only	762
Partners on the Journey	564
Total:	4,099

Miscellaneous

AA Preamble	2,328
Co-founder's Memorial Issue	18
Facsimile of first Grapevine	905
Grapevine Binder	521
Man on the Bed	1,736
Serenity Prayer	2,688
Slogans	1,519
Traditions Checklist	301
Wall Calendar 2005	12,368
Pocket Planner 2005	13,631
Victor E. Poster - English	358
Total:	36,373

SPANISH

El Lenguaje del Corazon (Language of the Heart)	4,862
Lo Mejor de Bill (The Best of Bill)	903
Sonidos de Sobriedad	16
Historia de La Viña	1,825
Victor E. Poster - Spanish	42
Preámbulo (Preamble)	353
Lemas (Slogans)	359
La Oración de la Serenidad (Serenity Prayer)	1,103
Tradiciones (Traditions Checklist)	157
Total:	9,620

FRENCH

Les Sons de la Sobriété (Sounds of Sobriety)	722
Victor E. Poster - (French)	8
Total:	730
Grand Total:	109,458

GRAPEVINE SUBSCRIPTIONS* — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	APRIL 2005	APRIL 2004	INCREASE/DECREASE
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	920	1,017	(97)
Alaska	563	535	28
Arizona	1,785	1,750	35
Arkansas	583	572	11
California	9,114	6,185	2,929
Colorado	1,736	1,748	(12)
Connecticut	1,611	1,619	(8)
Delaware	398	351	47
District of Columbia	200	184	16
Florida	5,235	6,069	(834)
Georgia	2,471	2,460	11
Hawaii	467	450	17
Idaho	625	574	51
Illinois	3,834	3,678	156
Indiana	1,490	1,567	(77)
Iowa	1,193	1,248	(55)
Kansas	1,211	1,188	23
Kentucky	934	996	(62)
Louisiana	869	900	(31)
Maine	670	641	29
Maryland	1,516	1,427	89
Massachusetts	2,817	2,445	372
Michigan	3,431	3,483	(52)
Minnesota	2,737	2,886	(149)
Mississippi	525	577	(52)
Missouri	1,773	1,790	(17)
Montana	628	699	(71)
Nebraska	949	944	5
Nevada	778	750	28
New Hampshire	770	744	26
New Jersey	2,795	2,867	(72)
New Mexico	678	712	(34)
New York	6,169	6,278	(109)
No Carolina	2,383	2,422	(39)
No Dakota	391	400	(9)
Ohio	2,827	2,904	(77)
Oklahoma	870	929	(59)
Oregon	1,498	1,454	44
Pennsylvania	5,055	4,597	458
Rhode Island	372	370	2
So Carolina	951	989	(38)
So Dakota	404	388	16
Tennessee	1,255	1,215	40
Texas	4,389	4,295	94
Utah	547	541	6
Vermont	407	408	(1)
Virginia	2,185	1,928	257
Washington	2,962	2,509	453
West Virginia	442	435	7
Wisconsin	2,490	2,057	433
Wyoming	296	283	13
Puerto Rico	35	82	(47)
U.S Possessions	177	73	104
Subtotal U.S.	91,411	87,613	3,798
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	771	780	(9)
British Columbia/Ykn	936	904	32
Manitoba	371	388	(17)
New Brunswick/Prince Edwards Island	241	150	91
Nova Scotia/New Foundland/Labrador	401	386	15
Ontario	2,571	2,983	(412)
Quebec	225	211	14
Saskatchewan	354	349	5
Subtotal Canada	5,870	6,151	(281)
FOREIGN	1,265	1,267	(2)
Grand Total*	98,546	95,031	3,515
LA Viña SUBSCRIPTIONS*			
	Jan/Feb. 05	Jan/Feb. 04	
	4,410	7,056	

(*exclusive of monthly orders)

Area Service Highlights — Panel 55 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

Alabama/Northwest Florida: My name is Cushing Phillips, III; A member in every sense of the word/Of the fellowship known 'round the world as A.A./It's as delegate that I stand here today/From Area One, the 55th panel,/(That's all of AL and the FL panhandle.)/ In Area One I am pleased to opine /We're working together one day at a time./In our home groups (which now number 525)/Recovery, unity and service still thrive /As we carry the message between here and there/And to the still-suffering drunk everywhere./In order to better cope with logistics/Our groups come together in twenty-four districts;/The first twenty-three geographically bounded/The last we've just added, Hispanically founded/To help bring together in language of heart/Those members linguistically long held apart./We work through committees (some sit and some stand)/They mirror the conference as much as they can;/And through workshops based on the conference theme/(about which New York sends me stuff by the realm!)/Providing a conscience that I may bring here/Thus serving in trust, and not driven by fear./We've started a project under Corrections/That bridges the gap by making connections/To make sure that the hand of A.A. will be there/When behind-the-walls members first breathe free air./It's barely begun—I've no word from the field/But I'll keep you informed as more is revealed./And then there's this district—number eighteen—/For years now (at quarterlies) they haven't been seen./But this year: a lone G.S.R. found our meeting/Stuck out his hand and offered a greeting./When he left out on Sunday, headed for home./He said he'd be back, next time not alone./So we're working and growing in Area One/(Thanks to Rule 62 we're even having some fun!)/I can't help feeling I've forgotten something/But my time's almost over, the bell's set to ring./You've all been most patient with a seussient pup./I'm grateful. I love you. And now I'll shut up. — *Cushing Phillips, III*

Arkansas: Area 4 has 245 groups divided in 12 districts. We hold two-day quarterly assemblies at a central location. Our state convention, The Old Grandad, will be held in Mountainview, Arkansas, in August. This is the oldest convention west of the Mississippi. Our archives is one of the finest and we take pride in the restoration work. Our corrections committee is active in coordinating meetings "behind the walls." The treatment facilities committee is active and has an established Bridging the Gap program. The Grapevine committee encourages subscriptions and has displays at conventions. Our past delegates are active; their experience and guidance are essential to me in carrying out my duties. I am truly humbled to be their trusted servant. — *Pete Roth*

British Columbia/Yukon: Area 79 has 46 districts, 750 groups and over 14,000 members. Our area covers more than 800,000 sq. miles, with the Yukon representing one third of our total size. Three quarters of our area is remote and seven of our districts are significantly remote with almost half of our 46 districts overcoming travel challenges. Our quarterlies and assemblies move around our entire area based upon a bid system. We serve any request for workshops or archives displays and all 14 area committee members travel. We are able to meet these requests because of the generous contributions from our groups. We are enthusiastic participants in our Western Regional Service Assembly and in the Pacific Regional Service Assembly. It is a privilege to serve Area 79. — *Connie McPherson*

California (Central): Area 93 has approximately 850 groups in 27 districts, 21 English-speaking and six Spanish-speaking. Area officers visit each district during their two-year commitment to explain their functions and ask how we can better serve. This is by request of the districts. Our Archives committee is locating, interviewing and audio taping the area oldtimers. We will be hosting the Pacific Regional A.A. Service Assembly in 2006. Our goal has always been communication and information exchange. The more home groups we are able to reach the more suffering alcoholics will be hearing the A.A. message. — *Vicki Bunnell*

California (Northern Coastal): Area 6 has 22 districts, approximately 155 subdistricts, 1,800 groups and over 50,000 members. Four of the districts serve Spanish-speaking groups. Each district has a visiting area officer every month. After the delegate's report at the Post-Conference assembly, almost every district has the opportunity to hear the delegate's report individually. We have professional translations at all assemblies and have had great success with record attendance. This prompted us to form a standing Translation Committee. There are 23 central offices/intergroups in the area (seven are Spanish-speaking). We encourage participation in our Pacific Region Service Assembly (PRAASA), as well as our Regional Forums. Our challenges: written translation of our newsletter, one remote district, and little participation in our subdistrict structure. I thank Area 6 for embodying service in such a loving way. — *Francisco Almada*

California (Southern): Area 5 has nearly 40,000 members spread over 33 districts, including four linguistic districts, three "combined" districts; two English-speaking and three Spanish-speaking central offices. There is cultural and language diversity, both within the communities and inside A.A. Meetings are known to be in Spanish, Korean, Farsi, Russian, American Sign Language and English. Communications seems at times an insurmountable challenge. Printed matter is available in both Spanish and English and both our area assemblies and committee meetings have simultaneous English/Spanish, and when needed, ASL interpretation. We often lack sufficient funds to perform all the services we would like to. Many remind me of the importance of continuing to seek the conscience of the groups in shaping what our vision entails. — *Jim Whipple*

Colorado: Area 10 has 618 active registered groups in 34 districts. Districts are divided geographically, except for one Spanish-speaking district, which encompasses all of the Spanish-speaking groups in Colorado. We have three assemblies per year and we encourage outlying districts, which generally have a smaller number of groups, to host assemblies. Experience shows that this can energize and unify a district. There are ten standing committees and an annual State Convention that rotates among the larger metropolitan areas. Most members of our Fellowship in Area 10 find that having a home group keeps them connected and is the perfect forum in which to learn about service and how the Seventh Tradition supports sending the G.S.R. to assemblies to represent us. — *Susan Taylor*

Connecticut: Area 11 is a vibrant and diverse community; we have 1,814 A.A. meetings a week. We have four annual area sponsored events and many district sponsored events, which include a bilingual one-day event that is well attended from throughout the Northeast region. Area 11 covers ten geographic

districts and one Spanish-speaking district. CSCYPAA hosts an annual weekend that is mindful of the needs of the younger alcoholic. We have an area office which houses our archives and provides a place to hold committee meetings and small functions. I am blessed to have the example of past trusted servants and the love and support of the people I serve. — *Amalia Castillo*

District of Columbia: Area 13 supports English and Hispanic groups in Washington, DC, Prince George's and Montgomery counties in Maryland, and Hispanic groups in Northern Virginia. We are in the process of redistricting our 38 districts and making an effort to get all meetings to register as groups. There are over 2,000 meetings per week, many of which started with a coffee pot and resentment and neglected to register with G.S.O. Our area struggles with participation of D.C.M.s and lack of representation of the majority of groups. We are working to increase participation. We hold a mini-conference prior to the Conference to prepare the delegate. We also sponsor an annual Gratitude breakfast, and have active service committees. — *Laura Jackson*

Florida (North): Area 14 has approximately 700 groups in 30 districts, with five districts having multiple D.C.M.s. Our Spanish linguistic district is one of the most active and fastest growing. We have four assemblies per year. In addition to our trustee's visit during a two-year term, the North and South Florida Area delegates visit each other's assembly. Our Accessibilities/Special Needs committee created a pamphlet and distributed it to all 93 delegate areas. Our Web site, aanorthflorida.org, now gets 15,000 hits per month. Many travelers use it to connect to a local intergroup and meeting list for their visit to Florida. The YPAAs (Young People in A.A.) held their international conference in Orlando, in 2004 with 2,300 in attendance. There is much our young people need to learn about general service from us and many things our trusted servants can learn from them. — *Michael Scott*

Florida (South Florida/Bahamas/Virgin Islands/Antigua): Area 15 is divided into 17 districts that serve 1,709 groups, with 36,236 members; there are 19 intergroup/central offices. We hold four quarterly meetings each year that are attended by more than of 500 and are translated into A.S.L. The G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s have a two-hour workshop and our current practice and finance committee all meet to discuss area affairs. We now have two Spanish districts with workshops in Spanish throughout the day. The area provides Spanish interpreters for the business meeting and the Spanish-speaking members provide interpreters for the work-

shops. Our new area Web site www.area15aa.org, should be up and running in a few months. Although we are recovering from three of four hurricanes hitting our area directly, our traditional "Spirit of Enthusiasm" continues to thrive! — *Steve Pacheco*

Hawaii: Area 17 serves 400+ groups in 16 districts. We hold four annual assemblies, and assemblies and committee meetings rotate among the districts. Our travel costs take up a substantial portion of our budget, since we have to fly between islands. We have four intergroups and the area is structured to support the Annual Hawaii State Convention. Last year we voted to add a new committee "Cooperation with the Elder Community" (CEC), to carry the message to senior centers, retirement homes, and others. We are grateful to have active past delegate participation. I am honored to be serving in such an informed service-oriented area. — *Keith Hashimoto*

Illinois (Chicago): Area 19 has over 3,800 weekly meetings, 22 districts, three of which are linguistic: two Spanish and the first Polish district in the United States. Our groups, districts and committees are active in hosting workshops, seminars and conferences on all three of our legacies. Last year, Chicago had its first annual round up with over 1,100 attendees. Our area newsletter "Here's How" is published six times a year. Our 24-hour telephone answering committee has a member available for forwarded calls from 9:00 pm and 9:00 am. Every September for the past 66 years Chicago celebrates the anniversary of its first group with the All Chicago Open. With attendance ranging from 7,000 – 10,000 it is clearly Chicago's largest meeting. As always, frequent contact with each other and newcomers is the bright spot of our lives. — *Mark Cruz*

Illinois (Southern): Area 21 encompasses two-thirds of Southern Illinois and consists of small rural farming towns as well as large industrial cities. We hold four assemblies a year at which the standing committees have a sharing session, and a report from each committee is presented during the business meeting. We had a spring service conference and a state conference that rotates each year between Chicago, Area 19, Northern Illinois, Area 20 and Area 21. A large correctional institution population is found in our area and last fall we devised, along with Areas 19 and 20, our first A.A. plan to support the Illinois Department of Corrections. I believe the unity of the three areas of Illinois is our most valuable asset. Our most recent challenge is an ad hoc committee for possible mini-forums and/or service workshops that would rotate through Area 21. — *Carl Mizell*



Indiana (Northern): Area 22 encompasses the northern half of Indiana. We hold quarterly area assemblies. This year, following the theme of the 55th Conference, we are planning to have participants divide into mock home groups, and each group will have a group problem to discuss and arrive at an informed group conscience. This should generate much discussion, debate, and a lot of fun. We also host two D.C.M. conferences and recently held a meeting to help our area officers and committee chairpersons understand the duties of their positions and have more effective agendas at assemblies. Area 22 hosts the Indiana State Convention on a rotating basis with Area 23 Southern Indiana. Thank you all for the opportunity to be of service. Area 22 is striving to be available to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Meri Ray*

Iowa: Area 24 consists of 650 groups in 21 districts. We hold three area committee meetings each year. Our March event expands into a Service Weekend inviting G.S.R.s to attend; we go over the Conference Agenda so our delegate can gather a sense of our area. This year we are also including workshops for the G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. Our Archives is set up to be a traveling display. Our Literature and Grapevine chairs set up displays at district and area functions. Corrections carries the message into federal, state and local facilities with meetings and literature furnished with funds from our Pink Can donations. Area 24 is an enthusiastic area, committed to carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic and living the principles of the Three Legacies. — *Terry Coates*

Louisiana: Despite the erosion of our Louisiana coastline, and annual disappearance of several hundred acres of land into the Gulf of Mexico, A.A. is very much alive and growing in Louisiana. We have 31 districts, serving approximately 500 groups. The calendar of A.A. events around Louisiana is very full. Our state convention rotates to a new location every two years, and will be in New Orleans this year and next. We recently hosted our First Annual Corrections Conference, which was well attended and successful. We will host the ICYPAA Convention over Labor Day weekend and the Tenth Annual National Archives Conference on September 24 through 27—both in New Orleans. We are blessed with highly motivated officers and committee chairs. Our area committee has learned though the example of earlier committees and our elder statespersons and trusted servants—including our own Charlie B., A.A.'s current trustee-at-large for the U.S. I am honored and challenged to serve as our Panel 55 delegate. — *Don Massey*

Massachusetts (Eastern): Area 30 has more than 2,200 groups, 26 districts and two Spanish-language districts. Our conference and standing committees meet regularly. We are in the Boston area, home of the Big Dig, the no longer cursed Boston Red Sox and the mighty New England Patriots. Our five English, and one Spanish, intergroups provide vital local A.A. services—from the tip of Cape Cod and the Islands to our northern shores of Cape Ann and West beyond the hills of Worcester. At our state convention, co-hosted with Western Massachusetts, we adopted the custom of parading our oldtimers into a big meeting to a live sax rendition of "When The Saints Go Marching In." Little by slow participation is booming—first at area meetings, then with G.S.R.s at assemblies. We hosted NERAASA 2005. We were grateful for the opportunity to share the love of our general service structure, and its importance to A.A.'s future, with our members and our region. We pray for the humility to continue the journey, ensuring that A.A.'s message is heard. — *Nancy Poillucci*

Michigan (Central): Area 32 has 776 groups, 14 districts and approximately 16,000 members. Our area consists of the eastern half of lower Michigan except for the greater Detroit area. Every March the three Michigan delegate areas have a mock Conference, put on by recent past delegates and chaired by a past trustee. Each member has the opportunity to be delegate for a day and go over the Conference agenda items and background material. The three Areas (32, 33, and 34) meet four times a year to pass on information and share experience, and the areas rotate in hosting the Michigan State Convention. A little over 11 years ago when I walked through the doors of my first meeting and they said keep coming back and don't miss out on the miracle, I didn't have a clue of what a journey we were going on. I am forever grateful for A.A. and the men and women in Area 32, my home group, sponsor and Charles D., Panel 19 delegate for encouraging and supporting me. — *Jesse Perry*

Michigan (Southeast): Area 33 encompasses the southeast part of Michigan, with 25 districts and one Spanish-speaking district. We cover five counties, 809 groups, and an estimated membership of 18,000. We have six area officers, 13 service committees and four intergroup liaisons. Our Web site includes a guide of all the meetings in Area 33; C.P.C. has launched an "Adopt a Doctor" Program, and the Treatment committee's Bridging the Gap now supports eight facilities with 194 volunteers. We hold a convention once a year called the "March Roundup" and in 2006 will be hosting the East Central Regional Convention. We are one of three areas in Michigan and we participate with Areas 32 and 34 in an annual statewide convention, as well as a mock conference at the end of March to prepare the delegates for the Conference. Like many areas, we face the problem of too many avenues to pass the message and not enough volunteers to do the work. Hopefully, we will continue to attract new members into service. Grateful to be sober and thank you for the opportunity to serve. — *Gene Kroll*

Minnesota (Southern): Area 36 consists of 26 districts serving about 1,000 registered groups. We have an annual service conference in January, followed by a delegate's workshop, three one-day assemblies and four area committee meetings each year. The theme for the January service conference focused on the Conference theme and used the same presentation topics. At this event, we also provide orientation for new G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and district standing committee chairs. Area officers meet monthly; our 13 standing committees meet quarterly. We are in the process of forming a Spanish linguistic district. Our past delegates are active and have voting privileges at area committee meetings and assemblies. As a result of the consistent efforts of our area committee and G.S.R.s, group contributions have increased significantly in the past five years. We are grateful for the support of our local intergroups, whose cooperation supports our Temporary Contact Program. Area 36 has truly been blessed with wonderful trusted servants whose dedication helps carry the message to those who still stumble in the darkness. — *Mark Miller*

Missouri (Eastern): Area 38 covers approximately 32,000 square miles, and has 23 districts, made up of 520 groups, representing the 8,873 alcoholics registered with G.S.O. Eleven of our districts are considered as metropolitan and 12 are considered as rural, for purposes specified within our Area Procedures Manual. We hold four area assemblies each year and area sharing sessions, which are open to D.C.M.s, committee chairs, area officers and past delegates. We have eight standing committees and have added a Bridging the Gap committee, based on need, and to handle the high number of inmates being released from correctional

programs throughout the state. It is expected that the Missouri Department of Corrections will release over 20,000 clients from their programs over the next two years. This November St. Louis will be home to "The 2005 Spiritual Homecoming," a celebration of the 50th Anniversary of A.A.'s Coming of Age, which looks to be an event that people will remember. — *Chip Berkley*

Missouri (Western): Area 39 consists of 16 districts serving approximately 215 groups. We have two central offices, in Kansas City and Springfield. We have four two-day assemblies each year, held in Sedalia, a central location, where we have a D.C.M. meeting, G.S.R. meeting, and 13 committee meetings. Several past delegates attend our assemblies. Their experience and wisdom are invaluable. I feel I have been blessed through all of my service commitments by having followed someone who was willing to share their experiences with me. I have found this to be true in my position as delegate, as well. I look forward to visiting all the districts in our area and sharing my experiences from the General Service Conference over the next two years. I never believed I was qualified to represent my area in holding such a position as delegate, but my fellow alcoholics and God must have believed differently. — *Rondell Miller*

Montana: Area 40 has 285 registered groups in 14 districts that span over 145,000 square miles. There are literally hundreds of miles between meetings in the Big Sky country. We have two area assemblies per year with approximately 100 voting members. We also have three pre-assemblies in the spring held in geographically distant cities, so that members who cannot attend the assembly may learn of Conference Agenda items and have input through sessions to accomplish our informed group conscience. With the new panel of G.S.R.s, some of the past delegates and area committee members hold "G.S.R. schools," which are well attended. This year we will host a Regional Forum in Great Falls, September 30th through October 2nd. Thank you to Area 40 for allowing me the chance to be your contribution to the General Service Conference. — *Scott Weiss*

Nevada: Area 42 has a diverse membership with 22 districts, two of which are Hispanic, 516 registered groups and approximately 1,800 meetings. Our area encompasses all of Nevada and parts of California. Due to our vast size, we have a Northern and Southern area service structure. The Northern area holds six meetings a year, rotating their service meetings within the eleven Northern districts. The Southern area's eleven districts, holds four meetings yearly in Las Vegas. Twice a year, the North meets the South, lovingly, in the small historical mining town of Tonopah. Here we hold the pre-Conference assembly the 4th weekend in March and the fall assembly in September. Area 42 is privileged to have two past Class B trustees and between 8 to 10 past delegates actively involved in our assemblies. We are now in the process of developing our Web site. We held our First Native American Conference, Oct. 2004 in Carson City. It is with gratitude and pride I am allowed to represent and serve Area 42. — *Joyce Pettitt*

New Jersey (Northern): Area 44 has 42 districts serving approximately 1,250 groups, which are represented by 38 D.C.M.s (4 districts are clustered). The districts are divided into six sections. Two districts are Spanish-speaking and are very active. Our Ad Hoc Committee on Translation has become a permanent committee. Northern New Jersey is served by one intergroup, with a 24 hour, seven days a week 800 number. We have seven joint committees with intergroup and hold a quarterly Joint Unity Meeting. We have three area assemblies and one mini-conference a year, hosted by a different district or section, plus six area

committee meetings. Our Work Weekend, the first weekend of December, is held on a beautiful retreat property, where the entire area committee works on a year-end inventory process. Highlights of the year are our Annual Mid-Winter Luncheon in February, our Area Convention in September, and a Literature/History and Archives Joint Workshop. You may visit us through our Web site, www.nnjaa.org. Until then, may God bless us and keep us in His grace and everlasting light. — *Debbie Temple*

New York (Central): At my first area assembly, February 1984, a courtly little man named Louis from Syracuse talked about the Second Tradition with such eloquence that I couldn't wait to go back again the following month. Perhaps he would enlighten us on the Third Tradition. Thus began my ten plus years of always exciting service on the area level. We are the beautiful land of the Finger Lakes, with gorges and waterfalls too numerous to count, and a Fellowship of people staying sober together in 700 groups. On the second Sunday of each month G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, and group members drive to one of seven clustered districts for a general workshop. This will be followed by committee meetings and the two-hour assembly. Attendees may speak at the open forum for two minutes on any subject. Our trusted servants are a happy mix ranging from fairly new A.A. members to those with a long history of service. — *Liz Croop*

New York (Southeast): Area 49 is an active representation of the diverse face of A.A., with as many as 2,000 groups and more than 57,000 members. The area includes the five counties of the city of New York, Long Island and the five upstate counties, each with a D.C.M. chair. To this is added a nongeographical Spanish district. We have meetings mainly in English and Spanish, and meetings that speak to special needs, including deaf or hearing impaired, homebound members, members with special interests, and institutionalized and incarcerated members. There are also 13 independent intergroups, central offices or answering services which work cooperatively with SENY. Our assembly meets five times a year. Our Web site, is available in English and Spanish as is our newsletter, *The Link*. Southeast N.Y. is fortunate to enjoy both member participation and the material support from groups that needed to keep these activities going. — *William Ciccaroni*

North Carolina: Area 51's approximate membership is 15,000, with 960 groups, 62 of which are in correction facilities. There are 36 districts; one a Spanish District. We now make simultaneous translation available at all area functions, which has better than tripled the participation of our Spanish-speaking members. Our Correctional Facilities Committee has held a Conference, which last year had 289 attendees from 13 states. Some C.P.C./P.I. committees have made inroads with local community colleges, giving seminars on alcoholism and recovery to their nursing students. Last October we provided a seminar on alcoholism, recovery, and how to make an effective A.A. referral to The North Carolina Academy of Trial Lawyers, which covered the State Bar Association's mandated yearly continuing education on substance abuse. We are working on providing the same type seminars to the School of Government for the Judges' continuing education program and The North Carolina Academy of Physician Assistants. In the spirit of unity, Area 51 is moving confidently forward to fulfill our primary purpose and carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. — *Dick Frohock*

North Dakota: The 3,000 plus members of A.A. meet in more than 150 home groups, which are divided into 12 districts; area committee and G.S.R.s meet three times a year. Area 52's cor-

rectional system operates one main penitentiary, which has five meetings per week; several small satellite facilities may house women or individuals on work release. County correctional facilities, of which we have 34, have weekly meeting where individual A.A. members visit and provide literature. We attempt to co-operate with at least four inpatient facilities, eight residential locations, 18 day treatment programs and 35 outpatient programs. P.I. activities include providing A.A. literature and Grapevine in locations ranging from county court houses to laundromats. At a recent P.I. coffee a district judge made the 100-mile round trip to be with us. The result: literature racks were placed in three different county court houses, and are then maintained by local groups. We take this opportunity to thank all at G.S.O., the Fellowship and our friends, for the work they do in helping to get the message to those who have not heard there is a solution. — *Mike Nelson*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Area 82 has 16 district—5 in Newfoundland, 1 in Labrador, and 10 in Nova Scotia. There are 243 registered groups, with approximately 3,200 members that put on 389 meetings a week. Winter conditions and long distances between communities, towns and cities can often necessitate travel by boat and aircraft. We meet as an assembly in the fall, with a service weekend in each province after the Conference. In spite of distances and expense, the attendance of G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, and alternates is very good. Communication by telephone, sharing of minutes from district meetings and a wider use of the Internet keep service people and members well informed. Our Area Remote Communities Committee continues to help carry the message to the remote areas of our two provinces. I was so grateful to have been able to attend the Special Forum held in Goose Bay, Labrador, June 5-6, 2004 and to see A.A.s carry the message of hope to the Inuit and their communities. Our focus is on how to get new G.S.R.s and members interested in service, and keep them in service, enabling us to maximize our ability to carry the message. — *Una Healey*

Ohio (Central Southeast): Area 53 has 42 districts, approximately 500 groups and 16 active districts. Four one-day assemblies are held a year and four committee meetings. The committee consists of the current area officers, standing committee chairs, D.C.M.s and past delegates. Various districts host the quarterly committee meeting and also our weekend mini-conference at different locations. This year we will hold the Ohio State Southeast Michigan Convention, which rotates within the four areas in Ohio. There are 23 institutions within our area and we are servicing 19 with softbound books, Grapevines and literature. The money is donated through Spare Change Jugs in the groups. This past year over 10,000 pieces of literature were distributed to the A.A. groups confined to institutions. Our Primary Purpose is to be of service when anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help. — *Madeline Humphreys*

Ohio (Northeast): Area 54 has over 1,450 registered groups in 62 districts, including a Spanish district-at-large, and 10 intergroup and district offices. The area has a Web site with a G.S.R. fact file, scheduled events, and how to reach officers or chairs. Of the 11 standing committees four have past delegates as the chairperson. The newest committee is Group Services, which we believe will be a valuable tool for informing and teaching about the Third Legacy. The challenge remains to get and keep groups active, as well as practicing the Seventh Tradition. We are hosting our annual mini-conference, to allow all to see the process at work, and by using some of the actual agenda items; more information leads to a better understanding and allows our delegate

to have an informed group conscious. I feel honored and grateful (a drunk like me) to serve A.A. and Area 54. Thank you for my life. — *Alice Health*

Oklahoma: Area 57 has approximately 400 groups with close to 6,200 members. Eight districts, with six D.C.M.s for each district, serve the groups. We are currently going through growing pains in looking at redistricting. Many are fearful of this change as we have had our current structure for almost 30 years. However, we have the utmost confidence in our D.C.M.s, who are our area committee's conscience and trust that our Higher Power will guide us in a decision that will best serve the alcoholic that still suffers. This year the area committee has become more involved with our two intergroup offices and are inviting them to become more involved with the area service structure. Our voting area committee members, the D.C.M.s, sponsor an Area Conference each May for the delegate to give their Conference Report. We invite and sponsor our regional delegate, and also invite and sponsor a staff member from G.S.O. — *Jack Taylor*

Ontario (Eastern): Area 83 encompasses an extensive land area from Oakville on the west to the Quebec border on the east, northerly to Algonquin Park and south to Lake Placid. We have 502 groups in 28 districts and four intergroups. We hold two assemblies and three area committee meetings annually. An area archives chairperson has been elected to begin the process of assisting districts with their A.A. history. The next step is to find an archivist. A.A. is alive and well in Area 83. There are more members letting their name stand for service work positions at the area level than at any time in our history. Also, we are delighted to be assisting the G.S.O. by gathering 4,000 volunteer members to help at the International Conference to be held in Toronto. We look forward to seeing you there. — *Barbara Kelly*

Ontario (Northeast): Area 84 has 8 districts (7 English and 1 French), serving 186 registered groups. When we talk about our small numbers, we refer to the number of districts and membership in comparison to the vast area that needs to be covered. We have a small population base, great distances between towns and remote areas. Some areas are accessible by chartered flight or by waiting for the ice to freeze over so we can travel by snow roads. The long distances to travel and resultant financial burdens were disheartening. However, in the last 5 years or so, an ember has been sparked in some of the old and new members. We have been reigniting one district at a time. We have one intergroup staffed solely by A.A. volunteers. It has been trying at times, but on a better note, and by the Grace of God, services have always been met. The gift I have received from the Area 84 committee is the confidence entrusted in me to represent them in New York as their delegate and my gift to them is what I will do in that position. It will be an honor and a privilege to serve them for the next two years. — *Francyne Bigras-Galipeau*

Ontario (Northwest): Area 85 has 8 districts, 75 groups and approximately 1,600 members. It is an ongoing challenge to cover our 260,000 square mile area. We hold two assemblies a year. This means that some of our service members travel in excess of 500 miles one way—a challenge in sub-zero temperatures. However, this makes travel by ice roads feasible and affordable. Airplanes on skies or floats and logging roads are additional avenues of how we carry the message of hope to remote communities. Our area has more aboriginal communities than the whole of Ontario. Our remote community chair is a native A.A. member who speaks, reads and writes both Ojibway and English, fluently. Several A.A. and Al-Anon members in some

districts are being invited into First Nation schools and treatment facilities to carry the message. Due to the vastness of our area and the challenges presented within, I am grateful for the renewed experience of the power of our program, the Fellowship at large and all members of Area 85. — *Reiner Rehbein*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): Area 59 has 47 districts, over 1,400 groups and approximately 32,000 members. The area committee conducts most of its work through eight standing subcommittees and one ad hoc committee for Special Needs/Remote Communities. Area 59 is well-served by eleven intergroups and one borderless/intergroup, which addresses the needs of our Hispanic members. We have a Web site, simultaneous translation and amplification equipment, and an innovative outreach by our C.P.C. subcommittee to local tow truck companies. The ethnic composition of our area continues to evolve with the election of our first area officer of Hispanic descent. We are looking forward to the possibility of hosting a Special Forum targeting the impoverished population of inner-city Philadelphia. We trust that the God of our understanding will continue to guide us in our efforts to carry the message to those that still suffer. — *Gary Lutz*

Pennsylvania (Western): Area 60 has approximately 800 registered groups in 45 districts, covering 27 counties. We hold four quarterly meetings, three assemblies and a weekend of sharing (known as the Getaway Weekend). We have added two committees, Web site and Special Needs/Remote Communities to our standing committees and have combined P.I. and C.P.C. Our Literature, Grapevine, Archives and Web site committees have traveling displays that are taken to various events. We hold our Weekend in conjunction with our Conference Assembly, where we have presentations and discussion on Conference agenda items. Area 60 continues to increase our communication with our groups, districts and members, so that we can all achieve our primary purpose. This past year we hosted the Northeast Regional Convention in Pittsburgh. I am honored to be a small part of Area 60 and to be given the privilege to serve the area as their delegate for Panel 55. — *Chuck Hood*

Québec (Northeast): Six years ago there were 366 groups and over 7,300 members. Now, in 2005, almost ten percent of members have left us and an equal percentage of groups have disappeared. Now we have 324 groups and 6,500 members. Strangely, the financial health of the area is increasing. After assuming our financial responsibilities, we have been able to send G.S.O. almost \$6.30 per member, six times more than six years ago. We rotate our four general assemblies through the area's four geographic zones. Love of service and sharing of area members are our greatest value. It's a privilege to serve and represent them here. — *Michel Pelletier*

Québec (Southeast): Area 88 has 18 districts, approximately 184 groups, and 3,000 members. We have quite a large area geographically. Most of our members are French speaking. The area is being restructured to better carry the message and answer the needs of its members. We have four area meetings each year plus an annual one. We also participate in three inter-area meetings, with the four Quebec areas. We have two gratitude dinners where the delegate gives his/her Conference report. One month or so before the Conference, each district hold a sharing day on Conference agenda items, so the delegate has a better idea of

the group conscience. We have a Web site and the P.I. committee is responsible for it. I am happy to be a delegate; thanks to the members who were there before me and who are always available to support me in this wonderful adventure of services. — *Patricia Roy*

Texas (Northeast): Area 65 has 26 districts (including five Spanish-speaking), and approximately 430 groups. Our alternate chairperson coordinates workshops for districts based on the Conference theme and other requested A.A. topics. We have strong leadership in our D.C.M.s. Our Archives committee has traveled many miles to districts and groups with presentations and displays. Our Video chairperson utilized Conference-approved videos to carry the message to A.A.s in their home groups and districts. Our goal for 2005 is to locate groups that seem to want to be invisible, talk with the members, and find out how we can be of service. I am grateful to have been given the gift of sobriety through Alcoholics Anonymous and it is a privilege to be the member of the 55th General Service Conference from Northeast Texas. — *Naomi J. Zeiller*

Texas (Southeast): Houston is in the center of Area 67 and most of our 17 districts are in the metropolitan area serving about 600 groups. Recently the two original Spanish districts split into two new districts. The P.I. committee makes presentations at schools, professional organizations, police training academies and medical facilities. Corrections is carrying the message into many jails and prisons. The multilingual committee provides translations of the agenda, newsletters and other material, and translation equipment is available during area assemblies, conventions and other functions. A Temporary Contact Database helps people coming out of treatment find contacts in their hometown. The area Web site has maps of meeting locations, change forms and A.A. event information. Last October we hosted the Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly in Houston with 1,000 members from seven states and eleven areas attending. In June 2006 we will host the Texas State Convention in Houston. — *Charles Pederson*

Utah: Area 69 has approximately 260 A.A. groups, forming 11 districts, and is served by our area committee of six officers and nine standing committee chairpersons. We are discussing a Linguistic District, as Spanish-speaking members reside in all 11 districts. Our most recent triumph is our Web site — UTAHAA.org. We hold three area assemblies, two area workshops and two area committee meetings annually. The location varies. Unfortunately, attendance at the assemblies and workshops for the G.S.R.s is sparse; attendance for the D.C.M.s is just slightly better. Utah is a wonderful place to be sober. The opportunities for service are abundant and the people I serve in Area 69 are closer to me than most of my relatives. — *Mike Ohlson*



Virginia: Area 71 has 45 districts with approximately 1,200 groups. We have two assemblies a year and 11 active committees, plus seven special assignments: We had one district fold a year ago, so the Growth Committee is working with those groups to restart or join surrounding districts. We are trying to get inactive groups to get involved. D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s and other member are attending these groups to see why they need to be represented. At present Growth is also gathering inventory questions so we can again look at our area. The last inventory, about 6-7 years ago, revealed lack of communication. I want to thank all for allowing me to serve. — *Gail Lee*

Washington (Western): Area 72 has over 1,400 registered groups in 40 districts, including one area-wide Hispanic district. We hold three area committee quarterlies plus one annual assembly. Five pre-Conference regional meetings are used to inform the groups about the Conference agenda items, and our April quarterly will invite the G.S.R.s to share their group conscience on the agenda items. We hold 4-6 regional preassemblies to inform the groups on our assembly agenda items. The 2004 assembly approved the establishment of an Accessibility Committee. We will also host the 2006 Pacific Region Forum in Seattle on June 23-25. The Greater Seattle area is served by three intergroups and the balance of the area has central offices. The districts are busy with treatment, corrections and jail meetings. Group level involvement is encouraged. I thank you for this opportunity to serve such a great Fellowship. — *Dick Donahue*

West Virginia: Area 73 has approximately 300 groups in 17 districts. We have an assembly in the spring and fall in addition to two yearly agenda meetings. At our assemblies, we usually have 100% district representation. We have an active committee system that insures that the message is being carried effectively to the professional, the public, behind the walls, and to alcoholics in treatment or hospitalized. We have a statewide 800 telephone number that can be utilized by the newcomer for an A.A. contact or a meeting. A.A. is alive and well in Area 73 and I am humbled and honored to serve as delegate. Whether you are passing through our area on business or for pleasure, please look us up. We would love to have you join us. May God bless and keep you until then. — *Alan Siebel*

Wisconsin (Southern): Area 75 has over 900 registered groups and 32 districts. We hold two agenda planning meetings and two pre-Conference assemblies, and two additional assemblies. Two annual conferences are also organized in cooperation with Area 74 A.A. members. We also have a Corrections Conference and the Unity Conference. One special event for 2004 was a Spanish Sharing Session. Our Corrections committee funds A.A. literature for the facilities through our Rainbow Can project, and provides many Grapevine and La Viña subscriptions to inmates through our Count On Us program. C.P.C.'s big event for 2004 was the national meeting of Drug Court Professionals held in Milwaukee last summer. We now have an archivist, and an archives chairperson, and are in search of space to store our expanding collection. We face the ongoing challenge of introducing more members to the joy of general service. One helpful tool is our G.S.R. school, which travels on request to districts throughout the area. With God's help, we will continue to fulfill our spiritual responsibility to carry the A.A. message to those who still suffer. — *Nancy Gusner*

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation form and suggested that a heading be added to section #7 on page 5 regarding improving next year's Conference.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and suggested adding a reference to the G.S.O. Archives Web site under the "Reference Information and Resources" section of the workbook.
- The trustees provided updates to the Conference committee on the following ongoing projects: preparations for the International Convention, Ownership of Material, the current status of the audio preservation, and distribution increase of *Markings* newsletter.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed shared experience on ways local committees approach professionals in addition to writing letters.
- The committee discussed the need for a pamphlet directed to the criminal justice system and requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities review current C.P.C. literature to see whether it provides easily accessible information on singleness of purpose, open and closed meetings, proof of attendance at meetings, anonymity and how to contact A.A. locally, and report to the 2006 Conference Committee on C.P.C.
- The committee considered a request to create a video for professionals. They asked that trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities consider the cost and feasibility of producing short video segments directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields that could be streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

The committee shared that PowerPoint® presentations offer a simple and inexpensive way to provide A.A. information to professionals. They noted that locally produced examples of such presentations are currently available from the C.P.C. desk at G.S.O. They requested that the C.P.C. staff member gather additional samples that might be combined into a service piece and included in the C.P.C. Kit.

- The committee reviewed the new three-ring binder format of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and asked that the following be included in the C.P.C. Workbook: a guide letter to the legal community, a note suggesting that C.P.C. committees contact the C.P.C. desk for samples of locally developed C.P.C. pieces, and the suggestion that some committees have found a list of local open meetings helpful in doing C.P.C. work.
- The committee considered ways that members share information about A.A. one-on-one with professionals, for possible inclusion in C.P.C. material. They felt that additional information on



how committees can encourage individuals to work with the professionals in their lives should be included in the C.P.C. Workbook, along with lists of literature appropriate to approaching various professionals. This information would note that examples of how some areas have done this are available from G.S.O.

- The committee requested that the section "Guidelines for A.A. Sponsors" on page 15 of the C.P.C. Workbook be rewritten using terms such as building or developing relationships with professionals. They agreed that the word "sponsorship" may be confusing to A.A. members and professionals in describing their relationship.

- The committee requested that a list of professions that have been approached by local committees be gathered for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Kit.

- The committee requested that the C.P.C. staff person gather sharing, for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Kit, on ways that C.P.C. committees have solved the challenges of rotation in A.A., ensuring that the committee works without breaks in continuity.

- The committee noted that the following have been helpful in doing C.P.C. work:

Approaching professionals in twos; as in Twelfth-Step work, bring a newcomer.

Creating calling cards with C.P.C. committee contact information.

Finding A.A. members with appropriate professional or recovery experience to do C.P.C. work.

Remembering that A.A. is a valuable resource to professionals.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee requests that the font size in the pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals" be increased to be consistent with other Conference-approved pamphlets for professionals.

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the draft service piece on "Guidelines for the Development of Workshops Introducing A.A. in Training Programs for Correctional Personnel" and suggested that the trustees' Committee on Corrections continue to develop the piece. The committee requested that the draft be addressed to training programs for corrections personnel, rather than being limited to training academies; that a

revised draft be circulated to Correctional Facilities, Hospitals and Institutions, and Bridging the Gap area committee chairs for additional sharing; and that the trustees' Committee report back to the 2006 Conference Committee on Corrections.

FINANCE

- The Conference Finance Committee requests that the trustees' Finance Committee develop a "draft finance card" to be used by the groups similar in concept to the "Blue Card" that can explain that in addition to group expenses all levels of service require money to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. This may include a discussion on the spiritual principles of self-support as described on pages 5 and 6 in the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix," and the April 1956 A.A. Grapevine article "More Than Donuts."

- The committee discussed a request to include information on how to obtain a tax ID number in the "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" pamphlet and took no action as the information is currently available in other literature.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board the request that a collection of A.A. Grapevine stories for young people be produced in the year 2006 or later.

- The committee agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that an audio compact disc of La Viña stories on Steps Seven through Twelve be produced in the year 2006 or later.

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Grapevine Workbook and suggested that certain editorial changes be made prior to reprinting.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The committee discussed the 2005 International Convention and heard updates from the 2005 International Convention coordinator and our professional convention consultant, Gregg Talley.

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested the following:

That groups, districts, and areas develop flyers using the information regarding Regional and Special Forums posted on the web by the General Service Office.

That members consider organizing bus/van trips to Forums.

That more members, particularly sponsors and trusted servants in each region, personally encourage and invite new members to attend Forums with them.

- The committee discussed the concept of restructuring and/or increasing Forums (Regional/Special) and requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums prepare a report on this topic for the 2006 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the revised draft manuscript of the pamphlet "Too Young?" and requested that the Publications Department rewrite the manuscript taking into consideration suggestions from the committee and present the rewritten manuscript to the 2006 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.
- The committee reviewed the draft manuscript developed to replace the pamphlet "It Happened to Alice!" and requested that the Publications Department rewrite the manuscript taking into consideration suggestions from the committee and present the rewritten manuscript to the 2006 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.
- The committee considered the request to develop a publication oriented toward and addressing the concerns of A.A. members with long-term sobriety and took no action.
- The committee considered the request to revise the table of contents in *Living Sober* by creating "unity," "service," and "recovery" sections and by including a subtitle under chapter titles and took no action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee accepted with appreciation the report from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference regarding the use of laptop computers at the General Service Conference.
- The committee discussed regional structure and realignment and requested that the General Service Board furnish a report to the 2006 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee on the feasibility of more balanced composition/structure of regions.
- The committee considered a request that a second Conference Committee on Literature be formed and unanimously agreed to take no action.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee considered the 2004 annual report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, as requested by the 2004 General Service Conference, and expressed their appreciation for the comprehensiveness of the report.
- The committee reviewed with appreciation the information on centralized redistribution, tracking and evaluation of the "We Know What It's Like" Public Service Announcement (P.S.A.).

- The committee suggested adding additional clarification to the category "Introduction to A.A." on the Membership Survey pamphlet to indicate that "the total responses may add up to more than 100 %."
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* with appreciation, and selected several items to be brought back with additional background for review by the 2006 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee reviewed the *Final Conference Report* and noted with appreciation the timely distribution of the *2004 Final Conference Report* to the General Service Conference Areas. The committee also considered cost reduction efforts involving the *Final Conference Report* and suggested they be primarily focused on the format and not affect the content.
- The committee considered placement of a central office serving Native North American People in the A.A. directories and took no action.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the results of the 2004 Treatment Facilities Committee Survey and noted that in many areas, inpatient treatment services have decreased and outpatient services have increased; and, many local Treatment Facilities Committees bring A.A. meetings into other institutions such as nursing homes, halfway houses and homeless shelters.
- The committee requested that a summary of the survey results be prepared and that relevant shared experience from the summary be added to the Treatment Facilities Workbook. The revised text will be presented to the 2006 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities. The committee reviewed the contents of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook and made no additional changes.
- Though A.A. experience with the treatment field has undergone considerable change during the past decade, the committee felt that there is still a strong need for the A.A. message to be brought to treatment professionals and to the alcoholic in treatment settings. The committee discussed the importance of strong Treatment Facilities area chairs.
- In light of A.A.'s recent experience with changes in the treatment field, the committee requested that the 2006 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities reconsider both the scope and name of the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities.
- The committee considered the request that the "Singleness of Purpose" statement currently used in six Cooperation With the Professional Community pamphlets be added to the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities," and took no action.
- Noting that a variety of A.A. literature exists for Treatment Facilities Committees, the committee requested that the Publications Department add an Additional Resources section to the last page of the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities."

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for East Central and Southeast regional trustee and for trustee-at-large/U.S.
- The committee discussed at length the suggestion, "That an appointed committee member not be eligible as a regional trustee or nontrustee director candidate until one year after his or her last service as an appointed committee member," and took no action.
- The committee suggested that the first sentence of the "Composition" section of its Composition, Scope and Procedure, which currently states, "There are not more than nine voting members of this committee and a non-voting secretary," be corrected to read as follows: "There are at least nine voting members of this committee and a non-voting secretary."

NOTE: A 1979 Conference Advisory Action recommended that "The Conference Committee on Trustees always have at least nine members so that there will always be enough to constitute one-half of the committee votes in regional elections."

- The committee reviewed the selection process for adding new members to the 2004 Conference Committee on Trustees and noted that, at that time, only three Panel 54 delegates were selected, creating a committee of eight members. Also, the committee noted that, in order to restore the committee to at least nine members, as outlined in the committee's composition, during the 2005 selection process, six Panel 55 delegates were selected. The committee strongly suggests that four Panel 56 delegates be selected during the selection process for the 2006 Conference Committee on Trustees and that five Panel 57 delegates be selected during the selection process for the 2007 Conference Committee on Trustees, thus restoring the committee to its designated composition.

NOTE: The current "Composition" section of the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Trustees states the following: "The members of the committee will include: Not more than five delegates from the previous year's panel (they continue to serve on this committee for their second year), and not more than five delegates from the current year's panel."

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

CORRECTIONS

- The committee recommended that the draft manuscript of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* that includes revisions suggested by the committee be approved and that the Publications Department maintain editorial responsibilities such as:

Cover and jacket design	Illustrations
Jacket copy	Title page
Preface, if any	Contents page

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- That the "Singleness of Purpose" statement currently used in six Cooperation With the Professional Community pamphlets, as well as in the Conference Committee on Corrections pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals" (and their workbook) be added to the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" plus the Treatment Facilities Workbook. (Not approved)
- "Alcoholism is a disease that ignores sexual preference" be changed to "Alcoholism is a disease that ignores sexual preference (orientation)" on page 10 in the pamphlet "A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic." (Not approved)
- That any further "editorial changes" to *The A.A. Service Manual* be included as background material sent to all delegates. (Not approved)
- The updated "Alcoholics Anonymous 2004 Membership Survey" pamphlet be approved with the addition of the following new question/category:
Sexual Orientation: Homosexual Heterosexual.
(Conference voted not to consider)
- The title of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* be changed to "A.A. member to A.A. member." The stories be focused on A.A. members who found sobriety inside the walls and continued sobriety on the outside. (Conference voted not to consider)
- That the title of the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be changed to "Questions and Answers on Recovery and Service Sponsorship." (Conference voted not to consider)
- That the A.A. directories include the listing of a central office serving Native North American people. (Conference voted not to consider)



The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION

December 31, 2004 (with comparative totals for 2003)

	General Service Board of A.A.							
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Convention Fund	A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2004	Consolidated 2003
ASSETS								
Cash	\$ 891,886	\$ 345,512		\$ 426,360	\$ 1,306,668	\$ 330,849	\$ 3,301,275	\$ 2,317,556
Accounts and interest receivable		91,914			239,373	64,613	395,900	427,984
Intercompany balances	(864,420)	(1,064,300)		847,077	(429,132)	1,510,775	-	-
Inventories								
Books, pamphlets, etc.					2,410,037	189,316	2,599,353	1,984,061
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.					102,848	22,560	125,408	396,370
Investments - at fair value								
U.S. Treasury Notes and Bills due 2005/2014 (Cost: 2004 - \$9,441,843, 2003 - \$9,708,689)		9,702,384					9,702,384	10,114,710
Property and Equipment								
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software, (net of accumulated depreciation - 2004 - \$3,121,739; 2003 - \$2,917,866)			\$ 582,904				582,904	717,227
Deferred charges and deposits	29,765				84,894	43,511	158,170	156,005
Prepaid conventions - 2005/2010/2015				994,378			994,378	377,531
Total Assets	<u>57,231</u>	<u>9,075,510</u>	<u>582,904</u>	<u>2,267,815</u>	<u>3,714,688</u>	<u>2,161,624</u>	<u>17,859,772</u>	<u>16,491,444</u>
LIABILITIES								
Accounts payable	\$ 218				\$ 540,414	\$ 96,341	\$ 636,973	\$ 1,020,598
Accrued royalties					32,225		32,225	33,344
Deferred income								
- Orders and subscriptions					20,248	1,579,787	1,600,035	1,633,206
- 2005 Convention				\$ 2,267,815			2,267,815	-
Accrued postretirement health benefits		\$ 4,334,810					4,334,810	3,853,682
Accrued pension benefits		\$ 1,964,804					1,964,804	1,031,575
Total Liabilities	<u>218</u>	<u>6,299,614</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>2,267,815</u>	<u>592,887</u>	<u>1,676,128</u>	<u>10,836,662</u>	<u>7,572,405</u>
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	<u>57,013</u>	<u>2,775,896</u>	<u>582,904</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>3,121,801</u>	<u>485,496</u>	<u>7,023,110</u>	<u>8,919,039</u>
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	<u>57,231</u>	<u>9,075,510</u>	<u>582,904</u>	<u>2,267,815</u>	<u>3,714,688</u>	<u>2,161,624</u>	<u>17,859,772</u>	<u>16,491,444</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2004 (with comparative totals for 2003)

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. Grapevine, Inc.				
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	A.A. World Services, Inc.	English	Spanish Magazine	Consolidated 2004	Consolidated 2003
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE								
Gross Sales				\$ 11,620,495	\$ 2,521,148	\$ 92,852	\$ 14,234,495	\$ 13,181,596
Less: Discounts				322,934	57,919	-	380,853	352,778
Net Sales				11,297,561	2,463,229	92,852	13,853,642	12,828,818
Cost of Literature Distributed								
Printing				(4,152,762)	(444,980)	(40,272)	(4,638,014)	(4,719,297)
Royalties on books				(164,985)	-	-	(164,985)	(139,765)
Direct shipping and warehousing				(1,268,972)	(440,001)	(29,799)	(1,738,772)	(1,679,914)
Gross Profit from Literature				5,710,842	1,578,248	22,781	7,311,871	6,289,842
CONTRIBUTIONS - A.A. Groups and Members	\$ 5,191,634						5,191,634	5,100,338
INVESTMENT INCOME	913	\$ 156,421		1,758	53,110	-	212,202	183,968
Total Income	5,192,547	156,421		5,712,600	1,631,358	22,781	12,715,707	11,574,148
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)								
Program	4,801,545			2,042,563	1,024,081	130,832	7,999,021	7,501,245
Supporting services	2,820,743	1,414,358	\$ 203,873	1,552,467	621,174	-	6,612,615	4,871,472
Total Expenses	7,622,288	1,414,358	203,873	3,595,030	1,645,255	130,832	14,611,636	12,372,717
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(2,429,741)	(1,257,937)	(203,873)	2,117,570	(13,897)	(108,051)	(1,895,929)	(798,569)
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS								
GSB La Viña support	(108,051)	-	-	-	-	108,051	-	-
Other Transfer	2,537,792	(811,841)	69,550	(1,870,343)	74,842	-	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	(2,069,778)	(134,323)	247,227	60,945	-	(1,895,929)	(798,569)
NET ASSETS								
Beginning of year	57,013	4,845,674	717,227	2,874,574	424,551	-	8,919,039	9,717,608
NET ASSETS								
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	2,775,896	582,904	3,121,801	485,496	-	7,023,110	8,919,039

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2004 (with comparative totals for 2003)

	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	International Convention	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	Spanish Grapevine	Supporting Services	2004 Total	2003 Total
OPERATING EXPENSES												
Salaries	\$ 613,024	\$ 753,971	\$ 120,319		\$ 112,093	\$ 141,954	\$ 1,154,917	\$ 425,644	\$ 33,104	\$ 2,165,057	\$ 5,520,083	\$ 5,389,431
Payroll taxes	43,954	55,536	8,718		7,602	9,353	79,272	38,527	3,074	163,776	409,812	393,329
Health and group insurance	106,771	111,003	13,623		9,193	13,624	133,292	71,734	6,067	471,639	936,946	978,787
Retirement expense - funding	54,270	67,977	10,747		9,720	11,531	97,243	1,114	84	170,161	422,847	348,458
Other program printing	255,418	128,063	68,186	\$ 10,673		32,629	34,257			19,275	548,501	499,719
Mailing labor	110,081	4,977				35,152	12,023		6,808	-	169,041	113,115
Postage and express	250,641	64,432	40,442		708	38,835	68,283	-	1,516	56,659	521,516	513,501
Writers fees	11,134	14,050	7,100	490		1,050	44,852			9,908	88,584	110,565
Foreign literature assistance		188,662								-	188,662	159,544
Selling expenses	1,775						169,605	105,989	10,908	781	289,058	219,820
Professional fees									240	228,143	228,383	263,021
Contracted services	11,974	271,573	2,869	9,731	1,353	20,193	39,849	129,601	65,460	266,390	818,993	575,647
Occupancy	82,910	111,933	8,682		6,855	9,488	143,921	82,121		310,644	756,554	700,326
Telephone	15,782	14,613	2,177		506	1,638	15,699	13,091		55,271	118,777	121,864
Equipment maintenance	165	600					13,232			64,080	78,077	78,986
Furniture and equipment	280	14,200			570	1,495	7,313		707	54,018	78,583	61,915
Stationery and office supplies	85,876	8,841	9,259	3,006	455	5,795	6,767	40,709	162	82,876	243,746	222,222
Office service and expense	9,665	7,114	15,217	9,132	839	9,948	9,275	40,709	957	299,920	402,776	386,856
Travel, meals and accommodations	887	51,406	470,567	175,711	(125)	67,201	12,763		1,285	442,597	1,222,292	1,051,473
Bad debts									460	22,305	22,765	30,232
Delegate fees			(137,511)	(120,806)							(258,317)	(126,835)
Total Operating Expenses	<u>1,654,607</u>	<u>1,868,951</u>	<u>640,395</u>	<u>87,937</u>	<u>149,769</u>	<u>399,886</u>	<u>2,042,563</u>	<u>949,239</u>	<u>130,832</u>	<u>4,883,500</u>	<u>12,807,679</u>	<u>12,091,976</u>
Postretirement health benefits										481,128	481,128	155,530
Retirement expense adjustment										933,229	933,229	(235,680)
Severance benefits										110,885	110,885	109,671
Digital Preservation Project								74,842			74,842	119,932
Depreciation										203,873	203,873	131,288
Total Expenses	<u>1,654,607</u>	<u>1,868,951</u>	<u>640,395</u>	<u>87,937</u>	<u>149,769</u>	<u>399,886</u>	<u>2,042,563</u>	<u>1,024,081</u>	<u>130,832</u>	<u>6,612,615</u>	<u>14,611,636</u>	<u>12,372,717</u>
Allocation of supporting services to activities	<u>1,529,665</u>	<u>1,727,824</u>	<u>592,038</u>	<u>81,297</u>	<u>138,460</u>	<u>369,690</u>	<u>1,552,467</u>	<u>621,174</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>(6,612,615)</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>
Total Allocated Expenses	<u>3,184,272</u>	<u>3,596,775</u>	<u>1,232,433</u>	<u>169,234</u>	<u>288,229</u>	<u>769,576</u>	<u>3,595,030</u>	<u>1,645,255</u>	<u>130,832</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>14,611,636</u>	<u>12,372,717</u>
Services	\$3,184,272	\$3,596,775	\$1,232,433	\$ 169,234	\$288,229	\$769,576					\$9,240,519	\$7,139,193
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$ 3,595,030				3,595,030	3,366,884
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-		\$1,645,255	\$130,832		1,776,087	1,866,640
											<u>14,611,636</u>	<u>12,372,717</u>
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2003	<u>\$2,661,874</u>	<u>\$2,835,669</u>	<u>\$ 1,050,955</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>\$46,338</u>	<u>\$544,357</u>	<u>\$3,366,884</u>	<u>\$1,746,080</u>	<u>\$120,560</u>		<u>\$12,372,717</u>	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
 Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
 Year Ended December 31, 2004
 (with comparative totals for 2003)**

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>2004</u>	<u>2003</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ (1,895,929)	\$ (798,569)
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	140,336	228,827
Amortization of bond premiums	4,152	5,390
Depreciation	203,873	131,288
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	32,084	52,812
Inventories	(344,330)	(49,167)
Deferred charges and other assets	(619,012)	26,157
Accounts and accruals payable	(384,744)	(116,640)
Deferred income	2,234,644	17,651
Accrued pension benefits	933,229	(235,680)
Postretirement health benefits obligation	481,128	155,530
 <u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u>		
<u>By Operating Activities</u>	<u>785,431</u>	<u>(582,401)</u>
 FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Purchases of property and equipment	(69,550)	(437,525)
Proceeds from sales of investments	9,774,663	9,475,130
Purchases of investments	(9,506,825)	(8,967,333)
 <u>Net Cash Flows Provided</u>		
<u>By Investing Activities</u>	<u>198,288</u>	<u>70,272</u>
 Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash	983,719	(512,129)
 Cash, beginning of year	<u>2,317,556</u>	<u>2,829,685</u>
 Cash, end of year	<u><u>3,301,275</u></u>	<u><u>2,317,556</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

March 4, 2005

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10015
Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2004 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2003 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated March 1, 2004, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2004 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Respectfully submitted,

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants
New York, N.Y.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 2004

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in four separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND - This fund was established in 1954 for

the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND - This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND - A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of international A.A. conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

Amounts shown as prepaid expenses in the Convention Fund on the consolidated statement of financial position represent funds paid in advance for future conventions. These costs include site selection expenses, deposits on facilities and professional convention management expenses.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$755,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund.

The GENERAL FUND - This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the international literature fund are also treated as unrestricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers have been eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to

the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are considered to be immaterial and are charged to expense in the year of purchase.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2004 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$2,105,871	\$ 48,042	\$1,913,707
Furniture	8 Years	689,598		689,598
Computer - hardware	5 Years	402,099	61,371	402,099
- software	5 Years	507,075	94,460	116,335
		<u>3,704,643</u>	<u>203,873</u>	<u>3,121,739</u>

Investments: As described above, all of the investing activity of the operating entities is consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity. The investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

Investment income for 2004 and 2003 is comprised of the following:

	2004	2003
Interest	\$356,222	\$417,378
Realized gains on redemptions	5,144	2,500
Change in unrealized appreciation	(145,480)	(231,327)
Investment expenses	(3,684)	(4,583)
	<u>212,202</u>	<u>183,968</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to

the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the Box 459 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense is recorded in accordance with SFAS 87, in which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, SFAS 87 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pen-



sion cost under SFAS 87 is recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjustment to retirement expense since it is a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2004:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 11,522,464
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>16,377,046</u>
Funded status	<u>(4,854,582)</u>

Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	\$ <u>1,964,804</u>
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The difference between the Plan's funded status and recognized pension benefit liability is attributable to deferral and amortization of Plan assets and obligations as prescribed under SFAS 87, as well as unrecognized actuarial losses.

Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)	
Discount rate	6.25%
Expected return on plan assets	9.0%
Rate of compensation increase	5.0%
Benefit cost	\$1,327,570
Employers' contributions	\$ 394,341
Benefits paid	\$ 1,027,099

Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 394,341
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	<u>933,229</u>
	<u>1,327,570</u>

The expected benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2005	\$1,036,000
2006	954,000
2007	945,000
2008	923,000
2009	938,000
2010 - 2014	5,339,000

The employers' contributions for 2005 are expected to be comparable to 2004.

Plan assets at December 31, 2004 were composed as follows:

Short term cash	\$ 134,709
Mutual funds	<u>11,387,755</u>
	<u>11,522,464</u>

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2004, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$471,128 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2004 is \$2,275,957.

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

For employees hired after January 1, 2004 there is a three-tier structure in the level of group medical insurance premiums paid for on behalf of employees who retire directly from GSO. For employees with 5-9 years of service GSO will pay 25%, 10-15 years 50% and more than 15 years 75%.

The plan is unfunded. The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 5%. A discount rate of 6.25% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B. The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 2004:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	\$4,334,810
Benefit cost	<u>\$ 699,870</u>
Benefits paid	<u>\$ 218,742</u>

The excess of cost of benefits over the payments for benefits of \$481,128 has been reported on Exhibit C as a non-operating expense since it does not affect the current outlay of cash.

The expected postretirement benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2005	\$ 229,679
2006	241,163
2007	253,221
2008	265,882
2009	279,176
2010 - 2014	1,619,757

The Organizations have elected to defer accounting for the effects of the Medicare Prescription Drug, Improvement and Modernization Act (The Act) of 2003 pending authoritative guidance for the Act's federal subsidy. Accordingly, the benefit obligation shown above does not reflect any possible impact of the Act on the plan's cost.

Note 6 Tax Status: The Organizations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

The Budget Highlights

2005 G.S.O. Budget

This budget describes the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office. It includes expenses of A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities). It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund, or the Capital Projects Fund. The Grapevine operations are described below in a separate report.

Income: The 2005 budget projects net sales of \$11,125,000, an increase of approximately \$450,000 (4%) from the 2004 budget but \$173,000 less than the 2004 actual results. The 2005 budget includes increases in the price of books and booklets (effective 7/1/05) (with the exception of the Big Book, which was restored to the \$6.00 level effective 7/1/04). In addition, a small shipping and handling charge is proposed, also effective 7/1/05.

After accounting for leveling in unit sales of the 4th edition and the "Anthology of Stories dropped from earlier editions," generally sales of other products are expected to be flat. One should remember that when introduced, the price of the 4th edition of the Big Book was set at \$5.00, less than the \$6.00 price on the 3rd edition, with the expectation of reducing Gross Profit and the Reserve Fund as well. It was expected that, depending on increases in Contributions, Prices would need to be increased in a few years.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted slightly less than 2004. Part of the reduction allows for a mix of costs resulting from the expected leveling of 4th edition and "Anthology" sales. Some is attributable to estimates for better cost of product. Royalties are budgeted at \$175,000.

Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted somewhat less as well. While there may be expected increases in operational costs due to inflationary pressures, we intend to ship products using less expensive methods even if it takes a day or two longer to reach their destination. In addition there is some expected recovery from the shipping and handling charge imposed, as mentioned above.

After subtracting manufacturing costs, royalties and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$5,733,600 or 51.5%. This is just \$23,000 more than 2004. The Gross profit compares with 50.5% and \$5,710,800, for 2004. It should also be remembered that as we continue to strive to have literature available for our Service Conference in the Spanish and French languages as well as English, lower print runs in those languages result in higher production costs. Because we strive to have similar selling prices regardless of our manufacturing cost, lower overall gross profits could occur and thus price increases become necessary.

Prudence dictates that even though contribution revenue has seen favorable upward movement during the last several years, other actions have been necessary. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations as well as assess the services supplied.

Contributions for 2005 have been budgeted at \$5,275,000 in total. Contributions received for the year 2004 were slightly ahead of 2003.

During 2004, contributions from groups and individuals of \$5,064,000 were \$37,000 (less than 1%) under budget but \$67,000 (1.3%) greater than 2003. Contributions received from World Service Meeting countries toward the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund amounted to \$128,400, approximately \$25,000 more than in 2003.

Total Operating Revenue for the period is anticipated at \$11,011,100, approximately 4% more than the 2004 budget and 1% greater than the 2004 actual results.

Total Operating Expenses for 2005 have been budgeted at \$10,940,000, approximately \$277,300 or 2.5% less than 2004 and \$377,000 or 3.3% less than the 2004 budget as well. This year's decrease represents serious efforts to reduce costs without significantly affecting service.

For 2005 the GSO has budgeted excess of revenue over expense of \$71,083. This compares with an actual loss for 2004 of \$312,171, and the \$760,991 loss budgeted.

The GSO operating losses as well as other withdrawals from the Reserve Fund (La Viña, Computer projects) all have worked to reduce the Reserve Fund balance.

2005 Grapevine Budget

The 2005 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation 106,500 approximately 6,000 copies fewer than the 2004 budget and approximately 1,700 copies fewer than the 2004 paid circulation number of 108,203. Circulation for 2003 was 112,614, 2002 was 115,753, 2001 was 115,034, 115,734 in 2000, 116,000 in 1999 and 117,300 in 1998.

Income: Magazine income of \$1,883,300 is expected, about \$12,000 less than 2004. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$651,000, approximately \$84,000 higher than 2004. The increase in the "other items" category anticipates sales of new products.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, the gross profit of \$1,587,150 is budgeted compared to \$1,578,250 achieved for 2004 and the 2004 budget of \$1,746,000.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 2005 are budgeted at \$1,621,400, approximately \$51,000 more than the 2004 actual of \$1,570,413.

For 2005 the Grapevine anticipates a profit of \$17,800. This compares with a 2004 budgeted profit of \$105,100 and an actual profit from operations of \$60,945.

2005 Spanish Grapevine Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board of Directors and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards will review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture. In 2001 the board recommended and the 2001 Conference approved that the Spanish magazine continue to be published by the Grapevine but Funded by the General Fund instead of continuing to draw funds from the Reserve Fund.

For 2005 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$9,783 compared with a \$8,900 gross profit for 2004. Circulation for 2005 is estimated at 9,500, slightly higher than the 2004 average of 9,316. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$131,373 for 2005, compared with \$130,800 for 2004. The 2005 budget projects a net loss of \$93,838 compared with a loss of \$108,051 for 2004, a loss of \$111,638 for 2003, \$103,815 in 2002, and \$119,385 loss for 2001.

To date the La Viña project has incurred start-up costs/operating losses of \$887,569 as follows: \$29,500 in 1995, \$138,290 in 1996, \$102,140 in 1997, \$66,182 in 1998, \$59,224 in 1999, \$49,570 in 2000, \$119,385 in 2001, \$103,815 in 2002, \$111,638 in 2003 and \$107,828 in 2004.

The General Service Office 2005 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	2004 Budget	2004 Actual	2005 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$10,975,700	\$11,620,496	\$11,400,000
Discounts allowed	309,000	322,934	275,000
<u>Net Sales</u>	10,666,700	11,297,562	11,125,000
Cost of Literature Distributed			
Manufacturing	3,800,000	4,152,763	4,000,000
Royalties	145,000	164,985	175,000
<u>Gross Margin</u>	6,721,700	6,979,814	6,950,000
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	1,343,600	1,268,972	1,216,373
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	5,378,100	5,710,842	5,733,627
Contributions Received	5,175,000	5,191,634	5,275,000
Interest Income	3,000	2,671	2,500
<u>Total Revenue</u>	10,556,100	10,905,147	11,011,127
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Salaries	4,882,500	4,870,200	4,864,000
Payroll taxes	332,500	342,790	343,000
Insurance	898,500	804,471	791,300
Retirement expense	321,000	420,654	436,800
Other program printing	515,950	548,501	492,900
Mailing, labor, etc.	134,300	162,692	164,707
Postage & express	496,750	504,476	444,412
Writers' fees	140,500	88,584	61,500
Other literature assist	267,500	188,662	200,000
Selling expenses	125,700	172,160	131,500
Professional fees	179,000	176,056	173,500
Contracted services	488,100	623,931	634,700
Occupancy	606,966	636,844	647,400
Telephone	114,000	100,838	97,000
Equipment maintenance	182,300	78,077	48,200
Furniture & equipment	53,000	43,948	46,500
Stationery & office expense	179,850	202,875	162,800
Office service & expense	393,575	339,194	353,925
Travel, meals, & accommodations	995,100	902,630	835,900
Bad debts	10,000	9,735	10,000
<u>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</u>	\$11,317,091	\$11,217,318	\$10,940,044
INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	(760,991)	(312,171)	71,083

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2005 BUDGET

	ENGLISH			SPANISH		
	2004 Budget	2004 Actual	2005 Budget	2004 Budget	2004 Actual	2005 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION —						
AVERAGE # OF COPIES	<u>112,667</u>	<u>108,203</u>	<u>106,500</u>	<u>9,500</u>	<u>9,316</u>	<u>9,500</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE						
Subscription income	\$1,891,740	\$1,817,898	\$1,816,678	\$67,500	\$69,186	\$68,259
Single copies and back issues	49,000	78,062	66,600	15,520	6,248	9,000
<u>Total magazine income</u>	<u>1,940,740</u>	<u>1,895,960</u>	<u>1,883,278</u>	<u>83,020</u>	<u>75,434</u>	<u>77,259</u>
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>704,530</u>	<u>721,841</u>	<u>758,051</u>	<u>69,602</u>	<u>66,529</u>	<u>67,476</u>
Gross Profit on Magazine	<u>1,236,210</u>	<u>1,174,119</u>	<u>1,125,227</u>	<u>13,418</u>	<u>8,905</u>	<u>9,783</u>
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	758,999	567,269	650,970	0	17,418	34,836
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>249,139</u>	<u>163,140</u>	<u>189,047</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>3,542</u>	<u>7,084</u>
Gross Profit on Special Items	<u>509,860</u>	<u>404,129</u>	<u>461,923</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>13,876</u>	<u>27,752</u>
Total Gross Profit	<u>1,746,070</u>	<u>1,578,248</u>	<u>1,587,150</u>	<u>13,418</u>	<u>22,781</u>	<u>37,535</u>
COSTS AND EXPENSES						
EDITORIAL COSTS						
Salaries, including temporary help	336,267	257,534	251,730	67,683	65,457	66,707
Payroll taxes and benefits	86,130	63,293	74,984			
Occupancy costs	71,122	70,075	74,679	0	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	26,454	20,333	19,100	1,200	326	1,028
Product development	10,000	30,256	46,264	0	0	0
<u>Total Editorial</u>	<u>529,973</u>	<u>441,491</u>	<u>466,757</u>	<u>68,883</u>	<u>65,783</u>	<u>67,735</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS						
Salaries, including temporary help	430,939	451,738	447,852	33,694	33,104	34,038
Payroll taxes and benefits	134,278	129,172	132,242	10,015	9,142	8,726
Kable fulfillment	109,000	99,345	103,200	6,962	6,890	7,500
Occupancy costs	68,090	67,574	71,496	0	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	52,455	61,085	46,820	0	0	0
Subscriber services	0	0	0	0	0	0
Selling expense-regular	49,700	66,158	141,850	7,815	10,908	7,700
-GvR program	105,150	39,831	35,400	0	0	0
Postage	12,818	15,064	16,520	1,200	1,518	1,179
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	<u>962,430</u>	<u>929,967</u>	<u>995,380</u>	<u>59,686</u>	<u>61,562</u>	<u>59,143</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE						
One-time charges-Employee's Severance	0	18,392	0	0	0	0
Insurance	4,891	7,512	9,500	470	795	795
Professional fees	71,103	52,087	42,850	413	240	240
Meetings and conferences	54,242	60,060	54,000	2,500	1,285	2,500
Furniture and equipment	43,725	33,928	20,500	0	707	500
Canadian exchange and other	5,440	-14	5,440	0	0	0
Bank service charges	7,500	14,419	14,419	0	0	0
Bad debts	13,712	12,571	12,571	161	460	460
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	<u>200,613</u>	<u>198,955</u>	<u>159,280</u>	<u>3,544</u>	<u>3,487</u>	<u>4,495</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,693,016</u>	<u>1,570,413</u>	<u>1,621,417</u>	<u>132,113</u>	<u>130,832</u>	<u>131,373</u>
Interest earned	52,050	53,110	52,050			
NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD	<u>105,104</u>	<u>60,945</u>	<u>17,783</u>	<u>(118,695)</u>	<u>(108,051)</u>	<u>(93,838)</u>

2004 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings — by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS	SPECIAL MEETINGS	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
01.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	418	230	55.0%	\$39,073.33	8,641	\$4.51	\$274.45		\$628.78	\$93.00	\$40,069.56	\$4.64
02.	Alaska	188	92	48.9	\$15,987.69	3,302	4.84	\$740.90		\$298.70	\$40.00	\$17,067.29	\$5.17
03.	Arizona	903	386	42.6	\$91,452.15	21,369	4.28	\$7,512.46	\$3,120.00	\$2,937.85	\$329.83	\$105,352.29	\$4.93
04.	Arkansas	250	135	53.9	\$16,869.54	4,503	3.74	\$96.95	\$550.00	\$287.27		\$17,803.76	\$3.95
	California												
05.	Southern	1,147	399	34.7	\$103,512.37	40,295	2.56	\$11,199.91	\$2,310.00	\$1,051.86	\$602.10	\$118,676.24	\$2.95
06.	N. Coastal	1,818	1,098	60.3	\$243,724.67	55,965	4.35	\$12,771.37	\$1,052.00	\$1,465.20	\$867.72	\$259,880.96	\$4.64
07.	N. Interior	782	415	53.0	\$72,238.20	21,833	3.31	\$2,693.55	\$10.00	\$4,424.78	\$109.20	\$79,475.73	\$3.64
08.	San Diego/Imp.	812	353	43.4	\$75,621.65	24,743	3.06	\$5,865.63	\$650.00	\$197.54		\$82,334.82	\$3.33
09.	Mid-South	1,827	787	43.1	\$168,584.45	57,743	2.92	\$5,926.70	\$75.00	\$3,430.55	\$290.28	\$178,306.98	\$3.09
10.	Colorado	669	359	53.7	\$90,283.62	15,542	5.80	\$6,889.52	\$35.00	\$32,306.66	\$136.39	\$129,651.19	\$8.34
11.	Connecticut	1,448	598	41.2	\$102,037.55	35,369	2.88	\$6,398.33	\$1,060.00	\$14,814.71	\$638.50	\$124,949.09	\$3.53
12.	Delaware	207	126	60.8	\$29,323.38	3,280	8.94	\$155.00		\$200.00	\$40.00	\$29,718.38	\$9.06
13.	D.C.	412	202	48.9	\$43,274.94	14,070	3.08	\$450.65	\$50.00	\$10,819.56		\$54,595.15	\$3.88
	Florida												
14.	North	744	358	48.0	\$74,763.95	15,732	4.74	\$5,362.72	\$525.00	\$12,270.20	\$183.00	\$93,104.87	\$5.92
15.	South	1,657	818	49.4	\$166,194.59	36,465	4.56	\$10,897.15	\$1,237.00	\$44,060.30	\$414.69	\$222,803.73	\$6.11
16.	Georgia	713	425	59.6	\$79,803.73	16,079	4.96	\$2,238.95	\$20.00	\$439.00	\$8.40	\$82,510.08	\$5.13
17.	Hawaii	274	145	52.8	\$29,846.91	5,096	5.85	\$1,413.56		\$887.70	\$18.00	\$32,166.17	\$6.31
18.	Idaho	209	99	47.4	\$17,942.62	3,867	4.63	\$1,526.67		\$1,486.85		\$20,956.14	\$5.42
	Illinois												
19.	Chicago	1,102	290	26.3	\$70,555.42	26,445	2.66	\$4,116.72	\$33.52	\$2,548.36	\$124.60	\$77,378.62	\$2.93
20.	North	1,118	433	38.7	\$58,286.47	22,967	2.53	\$544.00	\$448.75	\$6,840.71	\$125.00	\$66,244.93	\$2.88
21.	South	468	169	36.0	\$24,858.00	7,858	3.15	\$285.00		\$50.00		\$25,193.00	\$3.21
	Indiana												
22.	North	654	263	40.2	\$33,709.88	9,502	3.55	\$835.56		\$6,051.98		\$40,597.42	\$4.27
23.	South	588	287	48.8	\$37,526.57	10,454	3.59	\$554.72		\$244.96	\$70.00	\$38,396.25	\$3.67
24.	Iowa	663	280	42.2	\$40,646.87	14,016	2.89	\$416.01	\$131.88	\$787.00		\$41,981.76	\$3.00
25.	Kansas	373	187	50.1	\$27,599.14	9,410	2.92	\$1,272.40	\$400.00	\$6,341.92	\$100.00	\$35,713.46	\$3.80
26.	Kentucky	673	279	41.4	\$60,023.50	10,827	5.54	\$3,127.60	\$40.00	\$1,543.45	\$28.34	\$64,762.89	\$5.98
27.	Louisiana	553	187	33.7	\$35,865.28	11,710	3.05	\$536.00	\$4,808.78	\$25.00		\$41,210.06	\$3.52
28.	Maine	468	159	33.9	\$17,803.48	7,831	2.26	\$339.75		\$1,716.67	\$234.22	\$20,119.12	\$2.57
29.	Maryland	965	386	39.9	\$77,501.80	15,815	4.89	\$3,248.85	\$140.00		\$63.00	\$80,953.65	\$5.12
	Massachusetts												
30.	East	1,447	528	36.4	\$106,764.01	49,289	2.16	\$5,597.30		\$3,120.00		\$115,481.31	\$2.34
31.	West	254	140	55.0	\$18,851.81	4,716	3.99	\$473.25	\$502.97			\$19,828.03	\$4.20
	Michigan												
32.	Central	577	258	44.6	\$41,630.06	13,372	3.11	\$1,964.63	\$520.00	\$1,340.32		\$45,455.01	\$3.40
33.	Southeast	798	293	36.6	\$64,782.48	19,692	3.29	\$2,060.75		\$600.89		\$67,444.12	\$3.42
34.	West	524	226	43.0	\$41,963.36	10,613	3.94	\$546.35	\$200.00	\$2,367.97		\$45,077.68	\$4.25
	Minnesota												
35.	North	535	245	45.8	\$23,684.00	8,432	2.80	\$1,248.10	\$25.00	\$555.64	\$85.80	\$25,598.54	\$3.04
36.	South	1,020	407	39.9	\$66,464.03	24,633	2.70	\$1,454.00	\$50.00	\$1,846.00	\$94.58	\$69,908.61	\$2.84
37.	Mississippi	231	84	36.4	\$14,412.95	4,566	3.16	\$306.00		\$200.00	\$170.00	\$15,088.95	\$3.30
	Missouri												
38.	East	525	242	46.0	\$50,236.20	8,771	5.73	\$5,555.53	\$750.00	\$2,717.59		\$59,259.32	\$6.76
39.	West	206	96	46.5	\$14,739.84	6,282	2.35	\$295.00		\$150.00		\$15,184.84	\$2.42
40.	Montana	279	126	45.1	\$20,430.73	4,487	4.55	\$512.00		\$500.00		\$21,442.73	\$4.78
41.	Nebraska	680	322	47.3	\$50,831.12	15,108	3.35	\$460.30		\$1,382.50		\$52,673.92	\$3.49
42.	Nevada	489	184	37.6	\$28,686.57	11,517	2.48	\$731.08	\$1,000.00	\$2,915.16		\$33,332.81	\$2.89
43.	New Hampshire	559	246	44.0	\$31,344.42	10,702	2.93	\$922.65		\$4,305.79	\$120.00	\$36,692.86	\$3.43
	New Jersey												
44.	North	1,297	466	35.9	\$82,532.59	32,178	2.55	\$6,502.06	\$2,290.00	\$1,041.00	\$331.00	\$92,696.65	\$2.88
45.	South	503	269	53.5	\$58,625.43	7,855	7.46	\$938.00	\$955.00		\$35.00	\$60,553.43	\$7.71
46.	New Mexico	322	154	47.7	\$27,690.95	6,020	4.59	\$299.05		\$2,256.35		\$30,246.35	\$5.02
	New York												
47.	Central	715	244	34.0	\$37,752.77	11,404	3.30	\$2,383.84	\$125.00	\$5,888.78	\$59.16	\$46,209.55	\$4.05
48.	H./M./B.	710	288	40.6	\$34,946.75	11,146	3.14	\$1,253.70	\$325.00	\$1,540.00		\$38,065.45	\$3.42
49.	Southeast	1,765	719	40.6	\$202,961.51	57,714	3.52	\$8,021.20	\$4,080.00	\$1,235.38	\$1,000.87	\$217,298.96	\$3.77
50.	West	328	86	26.1	\$10,930.02	5,865	1.85	\$133.40	\$125.00	\$135.00		\$11,323.42	\$1.93
51.	N. Carolina	917	422	45.9	\$79,265.78	14,925	5.30	\$1,557.31	\$300.00	\$2,105.00		\$83,228.09	\$5.58
52.	North Dakota	149	73	48.9	\$8,707.22	3,074	2.82	\$73.79		\$2,329.25		\$11,110.26	\$3.61
	Ohio												
53.	Cent. & S.E.	668	190	28.4	\$24,085.09	9,709	2.48	\$437.79	\$125.00	\$50.00	\$33.00	\$24,730.88	\$2.55
54.	Northeast	1,444	329	22.8	\$42,053.90	22,187	1.89	\$3,157.50		\$1,542.00		\$46,753.40	\$2.11
55.	N.W. Ohio/ S.E. Mich.	288	104	36.0	\$11,668.30	4,199	2.77	\$107.00				\$11,775.30	\$2.80
	Oklahoma												
56.	S.W. Ohio	526	242	45.9	\$40,135.03	10,697	3.74	\$476.02		\$183.01	\$25.20	\$40,819.26	\$3.82
57.	Oklahoma	392	176	44.8	\$29,235.96	6,916	4.22	\$1,147.30	\$30.00	\$35.00		\$30,448.26	\$4.40
58.	Oregon	871	366	42.0	\$59,591.01	17,247	3.45	\$3,061.40		\$655.00	\$382.24	\$63,689.65	\$3.69

Pennsylvania													
59.	East	1,422	676	47.5	\$142,481.50	31,584	4.50	\$2,619.61	\$3,697.00	\$10,077.98	\$27.00	\$158,903.09	\$5.03
60.	West	805	389	48.3	\$46,330.48	11,816	3.91	\$1,934.15	\$2,050.00	\$1,025.00		\$51,339.63	\$4.34
61.	Rhode Island	253	115	45.4	\$18,365.56	5,350	3.42	\$385.00		\$1,146.38	\$200.00	\$20,096.94	\$3.76
62.	South Carolina	327	182	55.6	\$39,012.18	7,264	5.36	\$820.00		\$1,348.37	\$28.00	\$41,208.55	\$5.67
63.	South Dakota	167	63	37.7	\$8,986.93	3,961	2.26	\$41.00	\$250.00	\$740.00		\$10,017.93	\$2.53
64.	Tennessee	493	237	48.0	\$41,871.76	11,534	3.63	\$2,333.00	\$125.00		\$125.00	\$44,454.76	\$3.85
Texas													
65.	Northeast	481	207	42.9	\$54,679.89	20,244	2.70	\$4,184.22		\$4,163.92		\$63,028.03	\$3.11
66.	Northwest	218	71	32.5	\$13,953.14	5,321	2.61	\$763.65		\$1,184.00		\$15,900.79	\$2.99
67.	Southeast	547	243	44.4	\$44,888.40	16,118	2.77	\$2,637.27	\$600.00	\$1,321.87		\$49,447.54	\$3.07
68.	Southwest	496	216	43.4	\$46,748.84	11,291	4.13	\$698.00	\$28.00	\$548.22	\$60.00	\$48,083.06	\$4.26
69.	Utah	259	153	59.0	\$27,699.40	5,262	5.26	\$2,175.80				\$29,875.20	\$5.68
70.	Vermont	250	116	46.3	\$15,205.78	4,583	3.32	\$2,745.92		\$397.00		\$18,348.70	\$4.00
71.	Virginia	1,188	601	50.5	\$107,157.38	22,318	4.79	\$6,257.53	\$5,551.03	\$1,157.59		\$120,123.53	\$5.38
72.	Western Washington	1,163	542	46.6	\$98,456.22	25,476	3.85	\$3,493.40	\$1,000.00	\$21,212.06	\$369.21	\$124,530.89	\$4.89
73.	West Virginia	297	122	41.1	\$12,760.08	3,337	3.82	\$171.99				\$12,932.07	\$3.88
Wisconsin													
74.	N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	666	259	38.9	\$24,412.54	10,722	2.27	\$989.00	\$275.00	\$800.80	\$35.00	\$26,512.34	\$2.47
75.	South	944	422	44.7	\$50,515.28	17,807	2.84	\$1,278.55	\$107.10	\$935.00	\$62.39	\$52,898.32	\$2.97
76.	Wyoming	103	55	53.4	\$12,953.45	1,880	6.88	\$23.00		\$756.00		\$13,732.45	\$7.30
77.	Puerto Rico	131	67	51.1	\$5,819.00	1,480	3.93	\$75.00				\$5,894.00	\$3.98
78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	499	228	45.7	\$38,398.78	8,121	4.73	\$1,620.08		\$2,598.03	\$81.08	\$42,697.97	\$5.26
79.	B.C./Yukon	732	375	51.2	\$64,201.08	14,261	4.49	\$1,009.42		\$3,489.65	\$421.46	\$69,121.61	\$4.85
80.	Manitoba	149	52	34.9	\$7,864.72	3,966	1.98	\$9.73		\$181.61		\$8,056.06	\$2.03
81.	N.B./P.E.I.	187	86	45.9	\$7,986.14	3,363	2.37	\$31.41				\$8,017.55	\$2.38
82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	242	84	34.7	\$6,951.00	3,168	2.19	\$54.12		\$607.63		\$7,612.75	\$2.40
Ontario													
83.	East	558	236	42.2	\$44,902.16	14,443	3.10	\$816.13		\$7,825.95	\$496.97	\$54,041.21	\$3.74
84.	Northeast	162	62	38.2	\$9,470.38	2,144	4.42	\$212.12	\$764.90	\$2,133.81		\$12,581.21	\$5.87
85.	Northwest	70	18	25.7	\$2,839.03	1,249	2.26		\$40.99	\$1,761.65		\$4,641.67	\$3.72
86.	West	554	187	33.8	\$36,099.11	10,142	3.56	\$111.02		\$8,032.77	\$151.64	\$44,394.54	\$4.38
Quebec (1)													
87.	Southwest	535	350	65.3	\$12,233.62	15,134	0.80	\$581.91		\$24,628.90		\$37,444.43	\$2.47
88.	Southeast	192	125	65.1	\$1,389.20	3,042	0.45	\$22.30		\$16,506.41		\$17,917.91	\$5.89
89.	Northeast	331	183	55.2	\$1,571.63	6,663	0.23	\$129.92		\$35,126.94		\$36,828.49	\$5.53
90.	Northwest	363	319	87.8	\$1,224.57	6,666	0.17	\$200.35		\$29,864.87		\$31,289.79	\$4.69
91.	Saskatchewan	298	121	40.6	\$13,062.32	3,622	3.61	\$410.00	\$50.00	\$3,161.91		\$16,684.23	\$4.61
92.	Washington East	460	153	33.3	\$18,985.04	6,347	2.98	\$51.00		\$3,215.10		\$22,251.14	\$3.51
93.	Central Calif	859	355	41.3	\$70,411.68	22,897	3.07	\$1,602.13		\$284.00	\$163.50	\$72,461.31	\$3.16
	Total U.S./Canada	57,523	25,140	43.7	\$4,419,803.91	1,286,621	3.44	\$189,855.11	\$42,663.92	\$385,363.61	\$9,074.37	\$5,046,760.92	\$3.92
Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings					241,593.40								
Specials					385,363.61								
Total for U.S. & Canada					5,046,760.92								
FOREIGN AND OTHER													
Online Meetings					742.47								
Correctional & Hospital facility groups					203.15								
Foreign					143,532.87								
Internationalists					20.00								
Loners					374.65								
Birds of a Feather													
International Doctors in A.A.													
International Lawyers in A.A.													
Grand Total					\$5,191,634.06								

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 2004-2003 (in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	TOTAL PER CAPITA INCLUDING SPECIALS ETC		
U.S. & Canada 2004	57,523	25,140	43.7%	\$4,419,803.91	1,286,621	\$3.44	\$3.92		
U.S. & Canada 2003	56,904	25,429	44.7%	\$4,381,508.48	1,277,626	\$3.43	\$3.89		
Increase (Decrease)	619	(289)	-1.0%	\$38,295.43	8,995	\$0.01	\$0.03	EST. COST OF SERVICES PER CAPITA	2004 \$5.93
									2003 \$5.55

¹ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per info from areas)

2005 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Jimmy Jack Bailey
Terry Coates
Donald Cusson

*Laurie Emhe
Keith Hashimoto
Chuck Hood
Gail Lee

**Mike Young

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

Finance

Laura Jackson
Gene Kroll
Don Mollins

*Ray Nault
**Dave Pratt
Alan Siebel
Susan Taylor
Jim Whipple

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Policy/Admissions

Dick Donahue
Nancy Gusner
*Marc Jones

**Nancy Kunkel
Randy Magnus
Don Massey
Rondell Miller
Don Myers
Hank Schmitz

Secretary: Valerie O'Neill

Treatment Facilities

Bill Ciccaroni
Gary Gramman
Perry Grosz

Alice Heath
Glenn Harrison
*Bruce Landlot
Patricia Roy
Jack Taylor

Secretary: Irene Kontje

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Amalia Castillo
Cindy Coffelt
Nancy Gusner
Keith Hashimoto
*Randy Magnus

**Don Myers
Ray Nault
Michel Pelletier

Co-Secretaries:
Doug Richardson
Warren Stafford

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Chip Berkley
Amalia Castillo
Walter Covert
Dick Frohock
*Mike McMurtrie
Reiner Rehbein
**Connie Shockey
Terry Whelan

Secretary: Rick Walker

Grapevine

Dick Anderson
Fran Bigras-Galipeau
Robin Fewings

**Regan Gawan
Mike Nelson
Jesse Perry
*Steve Walker
Naomi Zeiller

Secretary: Robin Bromley

Public Information

*Oran Clemons
O'Dell Holloway
Nancy Jensen

Barbara Kelly
Mark Miller
Joyce Pettitt
Nancy Poillucci
**Torv Theisen
Mark Thomas

Secretary: Gayle Solheim Riese

Trustees

*Cindy Coffelt
Liz Croop
John Ferriter
Connie McPherson
Rick Hortsmann
Carl Mizell
Steve Pacheco
Michel Pelletier
Scott Weiss

Secretary: Warren Stafford

Correctional Facilities

**Milton Casey
Paul Coonce
Skip DoMoe
Una Healey
Mike Ohlson
*Jacki Perry
Meri Ray
Pete Roth

Secretary: Mary Clare Lynch

Literature

Brent Brown
Vicki Bunnell
Mark Cruz
Jan Lembke
Lalo Montalvo

*Victor Philips
**Buck Rose
Michael Scott
Debbie Temple

Secretary: Mary Dargan

Report and Charter

Francisco Almada
**Charlie Craven
*Jean Gagner
Catherine Glosser
Madeline Humphreys
Gary Lutz
Jim McDonald
Charles Pederson
Cushing Phillips III

Secretary: Julio Espaillat

³Archives

Terry Coates
*Regan Gawan
**Gary Gramman
Chuck Hood
Don Massey
Don Mollins
Patricia Roy
Susan Taylor

Secretary: Judit Olah

2006 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson
Agenda	Keith Hashimoto, Hawaii
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Dick Frohock, North Carolina
Corrections	Pete Roth, Arkansas
Finance	Susan Taylor, Colorado
Grapevine	Naomi Zeiller, NE Texas
Literature	Vicki Bunnell, Central California
Policy/Admissions	Don Massey, Louisiana
Public Information	Nancy Poillucci, E. Massachusetts
Report and Charter	Cushing Phillips III, Alabama/NW Florida
Treatment Facilities	Bill Ciccaroni, SE New York
Trustees	Scott Weiss, Montana
¹ International Conv./Regional Forums	Nancy Gusner, So. Wisconsin
¹ Archives	Chuck Hood, W. Pennsylvania

Alternate

Gail Lee, Virginia
Chip Berkley, E. Missouri
Mike Ohlson, Utah
Alan Siebel, West Virginia
Francyne Bigras-Galipeau, NE Ontario
Debbie Temple, No. New Jersey
Rondell Miller, W. Missouri
Mark Miller, So. Minnesota
Madeline Humphreys, Central SE Ohio
Jack Taylor, Oklahoma
Steve Pacheco, So. Florida/Bahamas/VI/Antigua
Amalia Castillo, Connecticut
Patricia Roy, SE Quebec

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

⁴The 2005 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 55th General Service Conference.

2005 Trustees' Committees**

Archives

Gary Kluksdahl, *chairperson*
 Chuck Barta
 Bill Clark
 Herb Goodman
 Don Miller
 Mike Perry
 Arnold Ross
 John Skilton
 Judit Olah, *secretary*

Conference

Arnold Ross, *chairperson*
 Bill Clark
 Ron Gauthier
 Dorothy Hurley
 Vince Keefe
 John Koster
 Tom Kraemer
 Dorothy May
 John Skilton
 Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities

Alan Ault, *chairperson*
 Chuck Barta
 Ward Ewing
 Phyllis Halliday
 Gary Kluksdahl
 Tom Kraemer
 *Irene Meisel
 Bob Pelot
 Rick Walker, *secretary* —C.P.C.
 Irene Kontje, *secretary*
 —Treatment Facilities

Corrections

Leonard Blumenthal, *chairperson*
 Alan Ault
 Chuck Barta
 Charlie Bartell
 Paul Cleary
 Murray McIntosh
 Don Miller
 *Bill Noonan
 *Bill Thompson
 Mary Clare Lynch, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Vince Keefe, *chairperson*
 David Every
 Dick Gallagher
 Ron Gauthier
 Herbert Goodman
 Ray Massey
 Arnold Ross
 Jane Sheppard
 Kevin Sunkel
consultant/independent auditor
 Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Murray McIntosh, *chairperson*
 Charles Bartell
 Leonard Blumenthal
 Paul Cleary
 Dorothy Hurley
 Vince Keefe
 John Koster
 Tom Kraemer
 Dorothy May
 Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums

Phyllis Halliday, *chairperson*
 Charles Bartell
 Ward Ewing
 Herbert Goodman
 Ray Massey
 Don Miller
 Bob Pelot
 Mike Perry
 Jane Sheppard
 Doug Richardson, *secretary*
 —International Convention
 Warren Stafford, *secretary*
 —Regional Forums

Literature

Mike Perry, *chairperson*
 Bill Clark
 Paul Cleary
 Dick Gallagher
 Murray McIntosh
 Ray Massey
 Dorothy May
 *Ray Reese
 Jane Sheppard
 Christopher Cavanaugh, *consultant*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
 Mary Dargan, *secretary*

Nominating

John Koster, *chairperson*
 Allen Ault
 Leonard Blumenthal
 David Every
 Phyllis Halliday
 Gary Kluksdahl
 Bob Pelot
 Warren Stafford, *secretary*

Public Information

Bob Pelot, *chairperson*,
 *Martin Clancy
 Ward Ewing
 Dick Gallagher
 Dorothy Hurley
 *Don McGouirk
 Dorothy May
 John Skilton
 Gayle Solheim Riese, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Herbert Goodman, *chairperson*
 Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."



Officers of the General Service Board

Chair
 Elaine McDowell
 First vice-chairperson
 Leonard Blumenthal
 Second vice-chairperson
 Allen Ault
 Secretary
 John Koster
 Treasurer
 Vincent Keefe
 Assistant secretary
 Valerie O'Neill
 Assistant treasurer
 Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers is given on page 42

* Denotes appointed committee members

** Elaine McDowell and Greg Muth are ex officio members of all committees.

2005 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Elaine McDowell, Ph.D. (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Baltimore, MD 21228) was elected chair of the board in April 2001. She has served as a member of the board since 1992. Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to national and international government and professional organizations and published many articles in professional journals. She is a former professor of social work at Morgan State University. For eight years she served as the director of the Center for Substance Abuse Prevention, and was the former acting administrator of the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration under the U.S. Dept. of Health and Human Services.



Allen L. Ault, Ed.D. (College of Justice and Safety, 354 Stratton Bldg., 521 Lancaster Ave., Richmond, KY 40475-3102) was elected a Class A trustee in 2001. Allen is dean of the College of Justice and Safety, University of Eastern Kentucky, Richmond, KY. Prior to this position he served as chief for the National Institute of Corrections in Washington, D.C. During his career, Allen has been a director of corrections for five governors in three states, warden of a maximum security prison, a rehabilitation counselor, director of State Programs for the Mentally Retarded, and president of a national criminal justice consulting firm. Allen chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the Audit, Corrections and Nominating Committees.

Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D. (23205 Hwy 623, Rolly View, Alberta T0C 2K0, Canada) was elected a Class A trustee in 2000. In 1998 Len retired as chief executive officer of the Alberta Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission, where he had worked for 30 years. He remains active in the alcoholism field as speaker, consultant and a resource person. Leonard chairs the Corrections Committee and serves on the International and Nominating Committees. He is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

William D. Clark, M.D. (143 Temple Road, Woolwich, ME 04579) was elected a Class A trustee in 2004. He is a graduate of Harvard University and Harvard Medical School. In July 2004 Bill retired from active patient care, having served as medical director of the Addiction Resource Center and attending physician at Mid Coast Hospital in Brunswick, Maine. Currently, Bill is president of the American Academy on Physician and Patient, whose 400 members strive to make medical care better by improving physicians-patient communication and relationship. Bill teaches at various medical schools and hospitals and presents seminars and programs on alcoholism. He serves on the Archives, Conference and Literature Committees.

Ward B Ewing, D.D. (The General Theological Seminary, 175 Ninth Avenue, New York, NY 10011) was elected a Class A trustee in 2004. Ward is a graduate of the General Theological Seminary, where he is now dean and president. For over 30 years he served as pastor of Episcopal congregations in his native Tennessee, and in Florida, Kentucky and Buffalo, New York. He is involved in community ministries and is the author of several books and articles. Ward serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, International Conventions/Regional Forums, and Public Information committees.

Herbert I. Goodman (5710 Tecumseh Circle, Houston, TX 77057) was elected a Class A trustee in 2003. Herbert holds degrees in chemistry and business from the University of Pittsburgh, Harvard, and the University of Besancon in France. Herbert is CEO of an international corporation involved with petroleum products and energy conservation. He serves on the Audit, Archives, International Conventions/Regional Forums and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Vincent E. Keefe (9889 West 145 St., Orland Park, IL 60462) was elected to the board in April 2002. Vince is a CPA and holds an MBA from the University of Chicago. Now retired, he has been the CEO of a large packaging corporation and currently serves as a director on the boards of seven companies. Vince chairs the Finance and Budgetary Committee and also serves on the Audit, Conference and International Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Charles Barta (1320 43rd St. SE, Cedar Rapids, IA 52403) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 2004. A former Panel 51 delegate, Chuck is active in his region and area and in district correctional and treatment facilities meetings. He currently works in the construction industry as an electrician. Chuck serves on the Archives, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, and Corrections Committees.

Charles Bartell (3935 Lennox Boulevard, New Orleans, LA 70131) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2001. A Panel 45 delegate, he continues to participate in treatment and correctional service in his area. Charlie, whose background is in psychology, is a retired university professor. He serves on the Corrections, International and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

David V. Every (150 Hauoli Street, #203, Wailuku, HI 96793) was elected general service trustee in April 2001. A Panel 41 delegate, David served four years as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. He is the publisher of four local magazines and a partner in an activity and travel booking business. David serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees and chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Richard Gallagher (410 Spring Valley Lane, Altamonte Springs, FL 32714) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2001. A Panel 47 delegate, Dick remains active in his home group and in area activities. A C.P.A. in private practice, he is also involved with various professional organizations. Dick serves on the Audit, Literature, Finance & Budgetary and Public Information Committees.

Ronald Gauthier (81 Lake Drive, South Hamilton, MA 01982) was elected general service trustee in April 2002. A Panel 41

¹Rotating at the close of the 2005 Conference.

delegate from Eastern Massachusetts, he has served as an A.A.W.S. director for the past seven years. His background is in banking and finance; for the past 20 years he has worked as a commercial lender at various banks in the Boston area. Ron serves on the Conference and the Finance & Budgetary Committees, and chairs the A.A.W.S. Board.

Phyllis Halliday (P.O. Box 8277, Lacey, WA 98509) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2002. As a Panel 47 delegate, Phyllis chaired the Conference Committee on Trustees. Her professional background is in human resource management and she is an agency Human Resource director for the state of Washington. Phyllis chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and Nominating Committees. She is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Gary Kluksdahl (11187 Tamarron Place, Parker, CO 80138) was elected Southwest regional trustee in May 2003. A former Panel 43 delegate, Gary is active in local, area and regional A.A. He has been in the oil and gas exploration and production industry for 30 years. Gary chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and Nominating Committees. He is also a director on the A.A.W.S. Board.

John Koster (19 East 65th Street, New York, NY 10021-6587) was elected general service trustee in April 2001. John has been an A.A.W.S. director since 1997. He is an attorney in New York specializing in maritime and international commercial law. John serves as an editor or contributing author to a number of professional publications. John chairs the Nominating Committee, and serves on the Audit and Conference Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Tom Kraemer (Box 121, Vibank, Saskatchewan S0G 4Y0) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 2004. A Panel 48 delegate, Tom has been most recently involved with Regina Intergroup, serving as its treasurer. He has served on a number of other A.A. service committees as well, and has been employed by Canada Post Corp. for over 30 years. Tom serves on the Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and International Committees.

Murray McIntosh (426 Cuyler Street, Thunder Bay, Ontario P7A 1B2, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in May 2003. A Panel 49 delegate from Northwest Ontario, Murray is active in group and area activities. Now retired, he was a professor in human services at a local college. Murray chairs the International Committee and serves on the Literature and Corrections Committees.

Dorothy May (9046 Pine Cone Way, Indianapolis, IN 46268) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2001. Dorothy was a Panel 40 delegate. Her professional background is in education, as teacher, administrator and writer. Dorothy serves on the International, Conference, Literature and Public Information Committees.

Robert Pelot (1020, Louis Ritchie, St-Jérôme, Québec, Canada J5L-1X6) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 2002. Bob, a former Panel 46 delegate, is active in his area with remote communities and in correctional service. Now retired, Robert worked for 25 years for a large corporation in various supervisory positions. Bob chairs the Public Information Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, International

Conventions/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees. He is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Michael D. Perry (11 Mechanic Street, Fair Haven, VT 05743) was elected Northeast regional trustee in May 2003. A Panel 50 delegate, Mike has continued to serve his area as the convention chair on the area committee. He has taught high school biology for over 30 years. Mike chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Archives Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Board.

Arnold L. Ross (227-G East Northern Parkway, Baltimore, MD 21212) became a general service trustee in May 2003, after having served three years as a nontrustee director on the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board. A former Panel 46 delegate, Arnold is chief of financial administration for a nonprofit organization. Arnold chairs the Committee on the Conference, serves on the Archives and Finance & Budgetary Committees and is a director on the Grapevine Board.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2005 Conference

Paul E. Cleary (2963 Butler Street, Oceanside, CA 92054) was elected general service trustee in April 2005. Paul started in service work in young people's groups. As a Panel 42 delegate he chaired the 1993 Conference Literature Committee, has also served as an appointed committee member on the trustees' CPC/TF Committee and was a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board from 2002-2005. A clinical social worker, Paul is currently an account executive for a behavioral healthcare firm.

Howard Lowery (P.O. Box 684, Colombia, MS 39429) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2005. A former Panel 42 delegate, Howard is actively involved in his home group and area A.A. activities. He owns and manages a local retail store.

Raymond Massey (79 Edenwold Place NW, Calgary, AB T3A 3T8, Canada) was elected general service trustee in April 2005. A former Panel 44 delegate, Ray has been involved in Canadian Remote Communities and Young Offenders meetings. Most recently he has served as nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board, this past year as treasurer. During the past year Ray has also served on the Literature, Finance and International Conventions/Regional Forums committees. He owns and operates a Painting and Decorating Contracting business and is a member of the Alberta Apprenticeship & Industry Training Board.

Robert Mayer (413 Wisconsin Avenue, Ontonagon, MI 49953) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2005. A Panel 50 delegate, Bob has been treasurer of the East Central region and is a member of the Areas 74 and 75 Unity Conference Committee. A forester, he is now Forest Fire program manager, Ottawa National Forest.

Dorothy Wilson (2602 Walker Avenue, Indianapolis, IN 46203) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2005. A Panel 44 delegate, Dorothy had remained active in her group, district, area and region. She has worked with children in a variety of educational programs.

Jeanne S. Woodford (782 Rose Drive, Benicia, CA 94510) was elected a Class A trustee in April 2005. Jeanne's background is in criminal justice and she has served in various positions, from correctional counselor to warden, in San Quentin State Prison. She is currently director, California Department of Corrections, Sacramento.

A.A. World Services Directors

Ron Gauthier, *chairperson,*
general service trustee
 Paul Cleary, *director*
 Gary Kluksdahl, *regional trustee*
 John Koster, *general service trustee*

Don Miller, *director*
 Greg Muth, *G.S.O. general manager*
 Robert Pelot, *regional trustee*
 Jane Sheppard, *director*
 Valerie O'Neill, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

David Every, *chairperson,*
general service trustee
 Leonard Blumenthal, *Class A trustee*
 Robin Bromley, *executive editor*
 Phyllis Halliday, *regional trustee*

Dorothy Hurley, *director*
 Raymond Massey, *director*
 Michael Perry, *regional trustee*
 Arnold Ross, *general service trustee*
 John Skilton, *director*

General Service Office Staff

Greg Muth, *general manager*
 Tom Jasper, *senior adviser*
to general manager
 Adrienne Brown
 Mary Dargan
 Julio Espallat
 Irene Kontje

Mary Clare Lynch
 Valerie O'Neill
 Doug Richardson
 Gayle Solheim Riese
 Eva Sanchez
 Warren Stafford
 Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Robin Bromley, *executive editor*
 Maggie Keogh, *GV, director*
of Internet operations

Hernan Mereia, *La Viña editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Daniel Brown, *desktop/web manager*
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr./admin. asst.*
 Shawn Bunkley, *general office clerk*
 Angel Calvillo, *Spanish translator*
 Christopher Cavanaugh, *publications director*
 Sheila Coppin-Thomas, *staff assistant*
 Daniel DeFilippis, *asst. controller/business admin.*
 Joseph Dennen, *staff assistant*
 John DeStefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 John Hackett, *associate editor*
 Karen Hale, *manager, support services*
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
 Maggie Keogh, *GV, director of Internet operations*
 John Kirwin Jr., *A.A. events consultant*
 Fern Leclerc, *French translator*
 Marsha Levine, *GV assoc. editor*
 Pamela Lewis, *staff assistant*
 Donald Meurer, *G.F.O., G.S.O.*
 Eugene O'Brien, *GV controller*
 Judit Olah, *archivist*
 Lise Payette, *French-language editor*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *asst. to Regional Forums coordinator*
 Jeanelle Roman, *staff assistant*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Sharisse Seabury, *staff assistant*
 Frank Segui, *financial secretary*
 Robert Slotterback, *accounting department manager*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Yee Tully, *staff assistant*
 Andre Washington, *purchasing agent*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

Trustees emeritus

Michael Alexander
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
 Gary Glynn

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 55th Conference includes Panel 54 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 55 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	55	Cushing Phillips III 319 S. Capital Parkway Montgomery, AL 36107
Alaska	2	54	*Rick Horstmann 17185 Montana Creek Rd. HC-899, Box 560 H Willow, AK 99688
Arizona	3	54	Regan Gawan 6738 E. Boise St. Mesa, AZ 85205
Arkansas	4	55	Pete Roth 615 N. Pine, #1 Little Rock, AR 72205
California Southern	5	55	Jim Whipple 2580 Morningside St. Pasadena, CA 91107
Central	93	55	Vicki Bunnell Box 5583 Montecito, CA 93150
Northern Coastal	6	55	Rafael (Francisco) Almada Box 553 Soquel, CA 95073
Northern Interior	7	54	Paul Coonce 549 Adams Dr. Chowchilla, CA 93610
San Diego/Imperial	8	54	Marc Jones 6161 El Cajon Blvd., #513 San Diego, CA 92115
Mid-Southern	9	54	Nancy Jensen 832D Ronda Mendoza Laguna Woods, CA 92637
Colorado	10	55	Susan Taylor 116 Brewster Ln. Florence, CO 81226
Connecticut	11	55	Amalia Castillo 103 West Hartford Rd. Newington, CT 06111
Delaware	12	54	Jonathan (Buck) Rose Box 318 Lewes, DE 19958
District of Columbia	13	55	Laura Jackson 29 Franklin St., NE Washington, DC 20002
Florida North	14	55	Michael Scott 3199 Suntree Blvd., #6 Suntree, FL 32955
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I./ Antigua	15	55	Stephen (Steve) Pacheco 24 Palm Haven Dr. Lake Placid, FL 33852
Georgia	16	54	Dick Anderson 4380 Veteran's Memorial Hwy. Lithia Springs, GA 30122-1707
Hawaii	17	55	Keith Hashimoto 232 Thomas St. Wahiawa, HI 96786
Idaho	18	54	Jim McDonald #20 Fourth of July Creek Rd. Northfork, ID 83466

* Alternate delegate was seated.

Dave Madison, delegate, was unable to attend.

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Illinois				Montana	40	55	Scott Weiss 2101 Fairview Pl. Billings, MT 59102
Chicago	19	55	Mark Cruz 5422 N. Menard Chicago, IL 60630	Nebraska	41	54	Connie Shockey 2331 S. Lincoln Ave. York, NE 68467
Northern	20	54	Terrence (Terry) Whelan 1111 Avenue of the Cities, #3C East Moline, IL 61244	Nevada	42	55	Joyce Pettitt Box 612317 South Lake Tahoe, CA 96152
Southern	21	55	Carl Mizell 4352 Bohm School Rd. Edwardsville, IL 62025	New Hampshire	43	54	Catherine Glosser 58 Lower Deerfield Rd. Northwood, NH 03261
Indiana				New Jersey			
Northern	22	55	Meredith (Meri) Ray 604 Anderson Ave. Fort Wayne, IN 46805	Northern	44	55	Debbie Temple 86 Mt. Prospect Ave. Belleville, NJ 07109
Southern	23	54	Gary Gramman 813 N. Emerson Ave. Indianapolis, IN 46219-4335	Southern	45	54	Laurie Emhe 26 Crest Rd. Cape May Courthouse, NJ 08210
Iowa	24	55	Terry Coates 12801 Rte. 52 N Dubuque, IA 52002	New Mexico	46	54	Oran Clemons Box 1981 Mesilla Park, NM 88047
Kansas	25	54	Jimmy Jack Bailey 60456 E. Highway 54 Pratt, KS 67124	New York			
Kentucky	26	54	O'Dell Holloway 8602 Wintergreen Court Louisville, KY 40242-3460	Central	47	55	Elizabeth (Liz) Croop 212 Groton Ave. Cortland, NY 13045
Louisiana	27	55	Donald (Don) Massey 3928 Uri St. Metairie, LA 70002	Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire	48	54	Steven (Steve) Walker 47 Elm St. Cooperstown, NY 13326
Maine	28	54	Mark Thomas 43 Michael's Rd. Wells, ME 04090	Southeast	49	55	William (Bill) Ciccaroni 103 Mt. Joy Ave. Freeport, NY 11520
Maryland	29	54	Nancy Kunkel 7919 Butterfield Dr. Elkridge, MD 21075	Western	50	54	Walter (Walt) Covert, Jr. 37 Gwendolin Ave. Jamestown, NY 14701
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	55	Dick Frohock Box 777 Reidsville, NC 27323-0777
Eastern	30	55	Nancy Poillucci 7 Pinebrook Lane, #1 South Easton, MA 02375	North Dakota	52	55	Michael (Mike) Nelson 4720 County Rd., 15 West Minot, ND 58703
Western	31	54	John Ferriter 72 Congress Ave. Holyoke, MA 01040	Ohio			
Michigan				Central Southeast	53	55	Madeline Humphreys 3405 Wicklow Rd. Columbus, OH 43204
Central	32	55	Jesse Perry 3219 Old Farm Rd. Flint, MI 48507	Northeast	54	55	Alice Heath 6245 New London Rd. Ashtabula, OH 44004
Southeast	33	55	Eugene (Gene) Kroll 2222 W. 11 Mile Rd. Berkley, MI 48072	NW Ohio/SE Mich.	55	54	Alan (Skip) DoMoe 9116 Geiser Rd. Holland, OH 43528
Western	34	54	Michael (Mike) E. Young 504 W. Jefferson St., C-6 Augusta, MI 49012	Southwest	56	54	Henry (Hank) Schmitz 702 Pine Needles Dr. Dayton, OH 45458
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	55	Jack Taylor 17330 N. 129th E. Ave. Collinsville, OK 74021
Northern	35	54	Charles (Charlie) Craven Box 227 Gilbert, MN 55741	Oregon	58	54	Bruce Landolt 56478 Solar Dr. Bend, OR 97707
Southern	36	55	Mark Miller 2815 Zanzibar Lane N. Plymouth, MN 55447	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	54	*Glenn Harrison 1220 Meadowood Rd. Columbia, MS 39429	Eastern	59	55	J. Gary Lutz 2210 13th St. Bethlehem, PA 18020
Missouri				Western	60	55	Charles (Chuck) Hood 611 Water St. Warren, PA 16365-1313
Eastern	38	55	Thomas (Chip) Berkley 19300 Hwy 63S Hartsburg, MO 65039				
Western	39	55	Rondell Miller 1345 E. Burntwood Springfield, MO 65803				

* Alternate delegate was seated.
Elizabeth Kepner, delegate, was unable to attend.

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	54	David (Dave) Pratt 34 Sheila Dr. Charlestown, RI 02813
South Carolina	62	54	Raymond (Ray) Nault 588 Crowe Mountain Rd. Walhalla, SC 29691
South Dakota	63	54	Perry Grosz 1111 Nowlin St., #A Rapid City, SD 57701
Tennessee	64	54	Milton Casey 241 Eastland Ave. Ripley, TN 38063
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	55	Naomi Zeiller 616 Frontier Court Colleyville, TX 76034
<i>Northwest</i>	66	54	Cynthia (Cindy) Coffelt 10655 Islerock Dr. El Paso, TX 79935
<i>Southeast</i>	67	55	Charles Pederson 708 S. Second St. Nederland, TX 77627
<i>Southwest</i>	68	54	Brent Brown 708 Minturn Ln. Austin, TX 78748-6567
Utah	69	55	Michael (Mike) Ohlson Box 701045 West Valley City, UT 84170
Vermont	70	54	Jacquelyn (Jacki) Perry 11 Mechanic St. Fair Haven, VT 05743
Virginia	71	55	Gail Lee 706 Maupin Pl. Williamsburg, VA 23185
Washington <i>State East</i>	92	54	Michael (Mike) McMurtrie 4428 Sunny Creek Dr. Spokane, WA 99224
<i>Western</i>	72	55	Richard (Dick) Donahue 12 Bellwether Way, #110 Bellingham, WA 98225
West Virginia	73	55	Alan (Al) Siebel 2010 S. Seventh St. Ironton, OH 45638
Wisconsin <i>No. WI/ Up. Pen. MI</i>	74	54	Torvin (Torv) Theisen 805 Houghton St. Ontonagon, MI 49953
<i>Southern</i>	75	55	Nancy Gusner 4204 Jerome St. Madison, WI 53716
Wyoming	76	54	Don Myers Box 53 Burns, WY 82053
Puerto Rico	77	54	Eladio (Lalo) Montalvo Box 1600, Suite 1009 Cidra, PR 00739

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	54	Victor (Vic) Phillips Box 4164 Olds, AB T4H 1P7
B.C./Yukon	79	55	Connie McPherson 2615 Keats Ave. Campbell River, BC V9H 1R8
Manitoba	80	54	Robin Fewings 162 Parkville Dr. Winnipeg, MB R2M 2J1
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	54	Don Mollins 111 Route 133 Shediac Cape, NB E4P 3C8
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	82	55	*Una Healey 101 Elizabeth Dr. Gander, NL A1V 1G8
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	55	Barbara (Barb) Kelly 752 Skyline Rd. RR #1 Oakwood, ON KOM 2M0
<i>Northeast</i>	84	55	Francyn (Fran) Bigras-Galipeau c/o Trendsetter 109 Elm St. Sudbury, ON P3C 1T4
<i>Northwest</i>	85	55	Reiner Rehbein Box 781 Keewatin, ON P0X 1C0
<i>Western</i>	86	54	Jan Lembke 7951 Cairns Blvd. Invercairn Beach, R.R. #5 Forest, ON N0N 1J0
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	54	Jean Gagner 327, rue Moquin Longueuil, PQ J4L 4V9
<i>Southeast</i>	88	55	Patricia Roy 771, 25e Avenue St-Proper, PQ G0M 1Y0
<i>Northeast</i>	89	55	Michel Pelletier 585 Bon Pasteur, Apt. 201 Québec, PQ G1R 5J2
<i>Northwest</i>	90	54	Donald Cusson 520, Grande Allée Terrebonne, PQ J6W 4S9
Saskatchewan	91	54	Randall (Randy) Magnus 411 6th St. East Saskatoon, SK S7H 1B7

